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Monthly incentive for ASHA workers hiked to ₹6,000

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Cabinet on Tuesday approved doubling the fixed monthly incentive for Accredited Social Health Activists (ASHA) workers from ₹3,000 to ₹6,000, in a move that will benefit 6,725 workers engaged in the city's primary healthcare network.

The revised incentive will apply to all ASHA workers currently working in Delhi, while other incentives, including the travel allowances available to them when sent for special missions outside Delhi, will continue unchanged. Generally, each ASHA worker is associated with around 2,000 people or 400 families.

"ASHA workers are an important link in Delhi's primary healthcare system. They visit households to provide health-related information, encourage families to get vaccinated and assist with services related to the



care of pregnant women and new mothers," the chief minister Rekha Gupta said after the cabinet meeting.

They also play an important role in Health and Nutrition Days, health awareness programmes, surveys and community meetings.

During the COVID-19 pandemic, ASHA workers also provided important healthcare services. She added that ASHA workers

provided important healthcare services during the Covid pandemic. The chief minister said the increase in the monthly incentive was an important step towards recognising ASHA workers' contribution and ensuring their financial security.

It would boost their enthusiasm for their work and help them continue their services. It would also contribute to strengthening primary

healthcare services and promoting women's economic empowerment.

"The increase in their monthly incentive would help them carry out their responsibilities with greater enthusiasm and dedication. It would boost their morale, strengthen continuity in their services and help make primary healthcare services in Delhi more effective," she added.

Speaker chairs Commonwealth workshop

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta chaired a Commonwealth workshop on inclusivity in resource-constrained parliaments at the 69th Commonwealth Parliamentary Conference in Cape Town on Monday, saying capacity may vary across legislatures but democratic dignity cannot.

The Joint Network Workshop on "Delivering Inclusivity Measures in Capacity Strained Parliaments" featured Yukon Legislative Assembly Speaker Yvonne Clarke, Turks and Caicos Islands MP Akiera Missick, and Trinidad and Tobago House Clerk Brian



Bernard Caesar, discussing how legislatures with limited resources could advance gender sensitivity, disability inclusion and accessibility.

Gupta noted women held only 27.5 percent of seats in national parliaments as of January 2026, with roughly one-fifth of Speakers being women. Citing WHO data that 1.3 billion people experi-

ence significant disability, he said representation alone was insufficient without leadership access, procedural support and independent participation for all members.

Highlighting India's experience, Gupta referenced the Constitution's 106th Amendment providing one-third reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and state assem-

blies, noting nearly 1.4 million women constitute 46 percent of Panchayat Raj representatives, with Bihar's 50 percent reservation across all tiers.

On technology, Gupta cited the National e-Vidhan Application, BHASHINI, and Delhi Assembly's own AI-enabled research tool Vidhan Saathi, while cautioning that digitisation must not create new forms of exclusion through inaccessible platforms. Gupta proposed periodic inclusion audits, measurable common indicators and shared institutional resources across Commonwealth parliaments, referencing the National Legislative Index, originally conceived by the Delhi Assembly, as a benchmark framework.

DDA holds stakeholder consultations on master plan 2047

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Development Authority held its fourth and fifth rounds of stakeholder consultations on the Master Plan for Delhi 2047.

The DDA engaged Resident Welfare Associations, Cooperative Group Housing Societies and leading industry bodies to discuss redevelopment of ageing housing societies and provisions for industrial promotion. The consultations, held in line with directions from Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, are aimed at ensuring MPD 2047 translates into tangible, long-term benefits for Delhi residents.

The fourth consultation, held Monday, focused on redevelopment of group housing and existing residential societies.

DDA officials briefed RWA and CGHS representatives on the policy framework for ageing neighbourhoods and older housing societies, particularly those more than 50 years old or structurally unsafe. Officials outlined key



planning provisions under MPD 2047, including Transit-Oriented Development, FAR and incentivised FAR, and rationalisation of density restrictions, all aimed at facilitating planned redevelopment and better land utilisation.

The discussion also covered amalgamation of adjoining plots, road networks, parking facilities, open spaces, sustainable development and waste management.

DDA officials explained that the redevelopment framework seeks to enable more dwelling units, increased open spaces and improved parking, while

ensuring safer living conditions in existing residential areas.

Residential representatives raised concerns and suggestions during the session, including calls for enhanced permissible FAR, a single-window system for approvals across multiple agencies, and structural safety audits of older buildings to assess their suitability for redevelopment.

The fifth consultation, held Tuesday, brought together representatives from major industry and commerce bodies, including the Confederation of Indian Industry, Federation of Indian Chambers of

Commerce and Industry, PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry, ASSOCHAM, and the Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation.

Discussions at this session centred on measures for promoting industry under MPD 2047, including provisions relating to allocation of DDA land to the private sector and the Institutional Social Responsibility framework. DDA officials briefed participants on the relevant provisions and the framework envisaged for facilitating industrial development in the capital.

Across both consultations, DDA officials addressed stakeholder queries and provided clarifications on various provisions of the Master Plan, while participants shared their views, suggestions and feedback on implementation.

DDA also informed participants about a time-bound grievance redressal mechanism being put in place to address concerns raised by housing societies undertaking redevelopment.

Panel to build portal for PG registration

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Education and Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood chaired the first meeting of a 20-member High-Powered Committee on Student Accommodation and Safety on Tuesday, with the panel deciding to develop a central portal within 15 days for PG owners to register their facilities, detailing building age, structure size and fire safety measures.

The committee was constituted by the Lieutenant Governor to review and address the acute shortage, safety standards and regulation of student housing across the capital.

Chaired by Sood, the panel is tasked with providing overarching policy direction, ensuring coordination between agencies, and submitting its final recommendations within 60 days.



The committee brings together senior civic and administrative officials, including the Chief Secretary of Delhi, the Delhi Police Commissioner, the MCD

Commissioner, the NDMC Chairperson and the DDA Vice-Chairperson, along with secretaries from the Home, Revenue, Health, Urban Development, Law and PWD departments, and the Chief Fire Officer. Vice-Chancellors of Delhi University, GGSIPU, Ambedkar University Delhi, NSUT and DTU are also part of the panel, with the Principal Secretary or Secretary of Education serving as Member Secretary.

According to its terms of reference, the committee will focus on five key areas. The first involves assessing the gap between university hostel capacity and student inflow, while exploring higher Floor Area Ratio permissions to allow on-campus expansion.

The second involves identifying under-utilised Government or DDA properties, such as vacant housing in Narela, for conversion into hostels with adequate public transport connectivity.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
AMM/EMU/GZB acting for and on behalf of President of India Invites E-Tender against Tender No. 46265433 The details are as under.

1.	Name of work	PINION 20 TEETH FOR T M C 1005/4303 DVL/CZ Drawing no. BHEL CAT. NO.14391628002 OR CGL DRG. NO. CGM/306209 MATERIAL CODE 767041418. Specification RDSO Spec. C-K303
2.	Approx. cost of work	Rs. 5664000/-
3.	Quantity	240 nos
4.	Last Date & Time of Submission of tender bid of tender	10.10.2026 (11:00 Hrs.)
5.	Date & Time of opening of tender document	10.10.2026 (11:00 Hrs.)
6.	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

Note: (i) The tenderers must be registered on the Indian Railways E-Procurement System (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in. (ii) Please refer to the tender document for all terms and conditions. (iii) No manual offers are acceptable. **NIT No.46265433 Date: 12.09.2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE
317726

LOST & FOUND
I, Jagdish Kumar S/o Sadhu Ram Sharma R/o EA-26, Inderpuri, Central Delhi have lost my original factory documents 1. Allotment Letter, 2. Possession letter, 3. Lease deed 4 transfer deed and all other original factory related documents of factory No. F-71, sec-11, Noida, U.P. finder contact above address.

NOTICE
Smt. Nirmal Devi V/S
M/s D.D. Infrastructure (A Division of D.D. Industries Ltd.) F-1/9, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase-I, New Delhi-110029 M/s D.D. Through its Authorised Representative, Mr. Mohinder Sikri, Marketing Co-ordinator, M/s D.D. Infrastructure, (A Division of D.D. Industries Ltd.) F-1/9, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase-I, New Delhi-110029
This is to inform you that aforementioned case has been noted for hearing on 17.09.2026 for purpose of further proceed-ings. You are directed to attend the sitting of the Commission at 10:30 A.M. to the aforesaid date along with your pleading/evidence in the form of the affidavit, if not fixed earlier for the final hearing.
For President CDRC-X

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given on behalf of Mr. Mohit Raghu to inform to the public at large that Mrs. Usha Devi alias Usha is the owner of the Plot area measuring 393.12 sq. yds., out of Kharsa No-910/2(10-8), Situated In The Residential Colony Known As Khandsia Within M.C Area Gurugram Tehsil And Dist. Gurgaon Haryana vide Transfer Deed dated 24.02.2025 executed by Mr. Mohit Raghu and Ms. Jyoti Raghu, vide Regd. Document No. 16163, Book No.1, on this dated 24.02.2025 SRO-Kadipur and same to be mortgage from Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Ltd., Branch-Noida. To comply the requirements of BANK/NBCF, we give this public notice that if any Person having any type of claim/right/interest/creating mortgage over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within 7 days from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc. Lucern Legal LLP B-93B, Second Floor, Opp. SBI Bank Sector 2 Noida, UP-201301 Contact#0120-4269379

PUBLIC NOTICE
Reg: Property bearing No. W/2-N-217, area measuring 42 sq. yds., part of Kharsa No. 21/241, Situated in the area of village Khayala and the colony known as Vishnu Garden, New Delhi; hereinafter referred to as "said property".
Be it known to all that our clients, Nasir Ahmad & Junaid Alam (hereinafter called the "Purchasers") intend to purchase the said property from Smt. Urusa Jabi (hereinafter called the "Seller") who owned the said property vide a regd. Sale Deed dated 07/12/2018, Document No. 13841. It has been further informed that initially, Sh. Babu Ram owned the said property vide Sale Deed dated 11/10/1965 and further sold to Smt. Ranjit Kaur vide a POA basis on 22/08/1986. After the death of Smt. Ranjit Kaur on 06/03/2015 and her husband also expired on 19/03/1997 leaving behind the following legal heirs namely Smt. Amarjeet Kaur, Smt. Nirmal Jee Kaur, Smt. Sarbjee Kaur, Sh. Jarnail Singh & Sh. Santokh Singh. Out of five legal heirs four of them have relinquished their respective shares in favour of Sh. Santokh Singh vide Relinquishment Deed dated 13/09/2017. Thereafter, Sh. Santokh Singh gifted the said property to Smt. Kamaljeet Kaur vide a Gift Deed dated 09/03/2018 and further transferred to Miss. Asai Kaur Chadha vide a Sale Deed dated 27/04/2018 and finally to the seller vide a Sale Deed dated 07/12/2018. The seller has also informed the purchasers that the said property is not mortgaged anywhere and there is no charge or dispute or any litigation pending regarding the said property. Any person including Banks, Financial Institutions, relatives having any claim, right, Registered AD Post, to the undersigned at the address mentioned herein below within 07 days of publication of this notice and in the event of no response having been received to the notice, the title of the seller to the said property shall be deemed to be clear of any charge or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever and any subsequent claim shall not bind our clients/Purchasers, in any manner whatsoever.
Shivkant Arora, Advocate M/s Intellectual Law Offices A-74, LGF, Defence Colony, New Delhi -110024

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given on behalf of Mr. Mohit Raghu to inform to the public at large that Mrs. Usha Devi alias Usha is the owner of the Plot area measuring 393.12 sq. yds., out of Kharsa No-910/2(10-8), Situated In The Residential Colony Known As Khandsia Within M.C Area Gurugram Tehsil And Dist. Gurgaon Haryana vide Transfer Deed dated 24.02.2025 executed by Mr. Mohit Raghu and Ms. Jyoti Raghu, vide Regd. Document No. 16163, Book No.1, on this dated 24.02.2025 SRO-Kadipur and same to be mortgage from Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Ltd., Branch-Noida. To comply the requirements of BANK/NBCF, we give this public notice that if any Person having any type of claim/right/interest/creating mortgage over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within 7 days from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc. Lucern Legal LLP B-93B, Second Floor, Opp. SBI Bank Sector 2 Noida, UP-201301 Contact#0120-4269379

PUBLIC NOTICE
Mr. Karan Gosain has approached ICICI Bank Ltd., Rohini, Delhi. (Bank) to avail a loan for purchase of Entire Basement & Ground Floor of Property No. 276, (250 sq. yds.), Block-E, Greater Kailash-II, New Delhi from Mrs. Hema Saxena, who has represented that she is the sole & absolute owner of the said property having inherited by Will dated 08.07.2015 (Doc-687) of her late husband Mr. Anand Prakash Saxena, who was owner vide Regd. Memorandum of Family Settlement dated 08.07.2015. If anybody, person, body corporate has any right, lien or claim whatsoever on the said property by way of inheritance, mortgage, sale or otherwise, then he/she/it may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 07 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim or objection shall be entertained thereafter and Bank shall proceed to advance the loan on mortgaging of the said property.
Amrit Kumar, Advocate Narang & Associates D-28, Jangpura Extension, New Delhi-110014.

SHUBHAM HOUSING DEVELOPMENT FINANCE CO. LTD.
CIN: U65921DL2010PLC199469 | Tel: +91 124 4212531 | www.shubham.co
Corporate Office: Shubham House, 425, Udyog Vihar, Phase IV, Gurugram-122015
Regd. Office: 608-608, 6th Floor, Block-C Ansal Imperial Tower, Community Centre, Naraina Vihar, New Delhi-110028

NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that the Branch 2nd Floor, Shop No. 12, Kharsa No. 120/121/22, B Sadan, Tajpur Road, B Sadan, New Delhi -110044, will be closed operationally w.e.f. the close of office hours on 15 Dec. 2026 for the want of some better opportunities. However, Company shall continue to render its services to its customers from B-1/E9, 2nd Floor, Mohan Co-operative Industrial Estate, Mathura Road, New Delhi - 110044, Should any member of public has further query(ies) in the matter hereof, he/she may please contact us at our customer care, details whereof can be accessed at www.shubham.co
For and on behalf of the Shubham Housing Development Finance Company Ltd. Sd/-
Place :- Gurugram, Date :- 15-09-2026 Sanjay Chaturvedi, MD

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given on behalf of Mr. Mohit Raghu to inform to the public at large that Mrs. Usha Devi alias Usha is the owner of the Plot area measuring 393.12 sq. yds., out of Kharsa No-910/2(10-8), Situated In The Residential Colony Known As Khandsia Within M.C Area Gurugram Tehsil And Dist. Gurgaon Haryana vide Transfer Deed dated 24.02.2025 executed by Mr. Mohit Raghu and Ms. Jyoti Raghu, vide Regd. Document No. 16163, Book No.1, on this dated 24.02.2025 SRO-Kadipur and same to be mortgage from Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Ltd., Branch-Noida. To comply the requirements of BANK/NBCF, we give this public notice that if any Person having any type of claim/right/interest/creating mortgage over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within 7 days from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc. Lucern Legal LLP B-93B, Second Floor, Opp. SBI Bank Sector 2 Noida, UP-201301 Contact#0120-4269379

NOTICE
Phone: 2467670
2467671
Email: drabhatshad@rediffmail.com
DEBTS RECOVERY APPELLATE TRIBUNAL, ALLAHABAD
Ministry of Finance, Govt. of India
First Floor, E-10 B Building, BSNL Premises, Patrika Marg, Civil Lines Prayagraj 211001
(Summons to the parties through publication under section 18 of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 as amended up to date)
Appeal Dy. No. 94 of 2026 DINESH KUMAR JINDAL
Vs. ... Appellant
BANK OF BARODA & ORS ... Respondent
To, SHANKI S/O JUGENDRA CHAUDHARY R/O SHAPUR VILHAR COLONY MURADNAGAR, GHAZIABAD - 201206
NOTICE
Take Notice that the appellant has filed an appeal against the order dated 05/01/2026 passed in Case No. SA.1144 of 2025 by the Debts Recovery Tribunal at Lucknow and the above mentioned appeal has been listed for appearance and further proceedings before the Appellate Tribunal at Allahabad on 23/10/2026 at 11:00 AM. You may appear before this Appellate Tribunal on the date fixed herein in person or through a legal practitioner duly appointed by you for this purpose.
Take notice that in default of your appearance on the date fixed, the appeal will be heard ex-parte.
Place: Prayagraj REGISTRAR DRAT Allahabad

SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd.
Corporate Off.: 503 & 504, 5th Floor, G-Block, Inspire BKC, BKC Main Road, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400051
Regd. Off.: Commerce IT Park, Tower B, 1st Floor, No. 111, Mount Poonamallee Road, Porur, Chennai - 600116, TN

POSSESSION NOTICE FOR IMMOVABLE PROPERTY [(Appendix IV) Rule 8(1)]
WHEREAS the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd. a Housing Finance Company [duly registered with National Housing Bank (Fully Owned by RBI)] (hereinafter referred to as "SMHFC") under Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002), and in exercise of the powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued Demand Notice dated mentioned under Section 13(2) of the said Act calling upon you being the borrowers (names mentioned below) to repay the amount mentioned in the said notice and interest thereon within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrowers mentioned herein below having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrowers mentioned herein below and to the public in general that the undersigned has Taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on me under sub-section (4) of Section 13 of the Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrowers mentioned here in above in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with said property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of "SMHFC" for an amount as mentioned herein under and interest thereon.

Sl. No.	Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) LAN	Description of Secured Assets (Immovable Property)	Demand Notice Date & Amount	Date of Possession
1.	1. Lan :- 616539511823909 1. Sushila Poooran Singh W/o. Poooran Singh 2. Poooran Singh S/o. Padam Singh	Part Of Plot No. 27 On Kharsa No. 233, Area Measuring 43.41 Sq.mtrs Situated At Krishan Vihar Colony Palikhera Mathura Uttar Pradesh East :- Plot No. 26, West :- Rest Part Of Plot No. 27, North :- Land Of Mahaveer, South :- Road 18 Feet Wide	23.06.2026 Rs. 2,22,386.51/- (Rs. Eight Lakh Twenty Two Thousand Three Hundred Eighty Six & Paise Fifty One Only) as on 16.06.2026	11.09.2026

Place : Mathura, Uttar Pradesh
Date : 11.09.2026

Sd/-
Authorized Officer,
SMFG INDIA HOME FINANCE CO. LTD.

SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd.
Corporate Off.: 503 & 504, 5th Floor, G-Block, Inspire BKC, BKC Main Road, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400051
Regd. Off.: Commerce IT Park, Tower B, 1st Floor, No. 111, Mount Poonamallee Road, Porur, Chennai - 600116, TN

SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES
E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE OF 30 DAYS FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE ASSETS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 READ WITH PROVISION TO RULE 8(6) OF THE SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002. NOTICE is hereby given to the Public in General and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below listed immovable properties ("Secured Assets") mortgaged / charged to the Secured Creditor, the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd. (hereinafter referred to as SMHFC) ("Secured Creditor"), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" on the date and time mentioned herein below, for recovery of the dues mentioned herein below and further interest and other expenses thereon till date of realization, due to SMHFC Secured Creditor from the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) LAN	Description of the Properties	Reserve Price Earnest Money Deposit	Date & Time of E-Auction	Date of EMD Submission
1.	LAN :- 610839211418946 1. Nadeem Saif, S/o. Haji Mohd. Umar Saif 2. Arshi, W/o. Nadeem Saif	A Residential House, Nagar Nigam No. 237, Present No. 421/A, Measuring 100 Sq. Yards Or 83.61 Sq. Mtrs Situated At Noor Nagar, Tehsil & Dist. Meerut. East :- Wall Of House Thereafter House of Smt. Suman; West :- Wall & Door Of House Thereafter 12 Wide Road; North :- Wall & Door Of House Thereafter 16 Wide Road; South :- Wall Of House Thereafter House Of Smt. Savitri	Rs. 28,80,000/- Rs. 2,88,000/-	27.10.2026 at 11.00 a. m. to 01.00 p. m.	26.10.2026

Details terms and conditions of the sale are as below and the details are also provided in our/secured creditor's website at the following link website address (<https://BidDeal.in> and <https://www.grihashakti.com/pdf/E-Auction.pdf>) The Interested Bidders can also contact :
Contact : Pankaj Kumar, Mob. : 7380950199, E-mail : Pankaj.Kumar30@grihashakti.com, Mr. Niloy Dey, on his Mob. 8655619157, E-mail : Niloy.Dey@grihashakti.com

Place : Meerut, Uttar Pradesh
Date : 14.09.2026

Sd/-
Authorized Officer,
SMFG INDIA HOME FINANCE CO. LTD.

NOTICE
Locker Hired by MR. MANJIT SINGH GILL & HAREEN GILL having address at A-8/11 SECOND FLOOR VASANT VIHAR with KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK Situated at NO-2 GROUND FLOOR VASANT VIHAR NEW DELHI-110057 remains un-operated from last 3 years & 6 Months and the rent due for the last 3 years.

NOTICE
Locker Hired by MR. MANJIT SINGH GILL & HAREEN GILL having address at A-8/11 SECOND FLOOR VASANT VIHAR with KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK Situated at NO-2 GROUND FLOOR VASANT VIHAR NEW DELHI-110057 remains un-operated from last 3 years & 6 Months and the rent due for the last 3 years.

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NOTICE
Locker Hired by MRS. REENA ARORA having address at R-825 R BLOCK NEW RAJINDER NAGAR NEW DELHI with KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK Situated at NO-2 GROUND FLOOR VASANT VIHAR NEW DELHI-110057 remains un-operated from last 4 years & 11 Months and the rent due for the last 3 years.

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NOTICE
Locker Hired by MRS. TARA TAMANG having address at HOUSE NO 351 NAVJIVAN BUDDH VIHAR TAIMOOR NAGAR NEAR BY GURDWARA 20 NEW FRIENDS COLONY NEW DELHI 110065 with KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK Situated at NO-2 GROUND FLOOR VASANT VIHAR NEW DELHI-110057 remains un-operated from last 4 years and the rent due for the last 3 years.

NOTICE
Locker Hired by MRS. TARA TAMANG having address at HOUSE NO 351 NAVJIVAN BUDDH VIHAR TAIMOOR NAGAR NEAR BY GURDWARA 20 NEW FRIENDS COLONY NEW DELHI 110065 with KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK Situated at NO-2 GROUND FLOOR VASANT VIHAR NEW DELHI-110057 remains un-operated from last 4 years and the rent due for the last 3 years.

NOTICE
Locker Hired by MRS. TARA TAMANG having address at HOUSE NO 351 NAVJIVAN BUDDH VIHAR TAIMOOR NAGAR NEAR BY GURDWARA 20 NEW FRIENDS COLONY NEW DELHI 110065 with KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK Situated at NO-2 GROUND FLOOR VASANT VIHAR NEW DELHI-110057 remains un-operated from last 4 years and the rent due for the last 3 years.

NOTICE
Locker Hired by MR. BANDHANA CHADHA & SALONI CHADHA having address at H.NO-455 CIVIL LINES MORADABAD U.P. with KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK Situated at NO-2 GROUND FLOOR VASANT VIHAR NEW DELHI-110057 remains un-operated from last 6 years & 11 Months and the rent due for the last 3 years.

NOTICE
Locker Hired by MR. BANDHANA CHADHA & SALONI CHADHA having address at H.NO-455 CIVIL LINES MORADABAD U.P. with KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK Situated at NO-2 GROUND FLOOR VASANT VIHAR NEW DELHI-110057 remains un-operated from last 6 years & 11 Months and the rent due for the last 3 years.

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Woman gets ₹200 crore extortion call from Goldy Brar, case filed

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

It took less than a minute on WhatsApp, a foreign number and four words, “Goldy Brar speaking, I want,” to turn an ordinary night in Delhi’s Civil Lines into what police now call the highest extortion demand ever reported in the national Capital. A 50-year-old woman living in the Civil Lines area of north Delhi, who owns ancestral property there, received the call at around 10.44 pm on September 7.

The caller, phoning from a foreign number, introduced himself as Canada-based gangster Goldy Brar and claimed to have complete information

about her before demanding ₹200 crore, according to police sources. The caller allegedly threatened to kill the woman and her husband if the money was not paid.

The woman initially dismissed the call, but after receiving a second threatening call, she approached Civil Lines police station. Following a preliminary inquiry, police registered a case on September 10 under Sections 351(4), 308(4) and 61(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, provisions relating to criminal intimidation, extortion and related offences. Delhi Police said it has not yet established whether the caller was genuinely connected to Brar or

had simply invoked the gangster’s name to issue the threat.

“Police are probing the matter from all angles and have not yet established whether the threat was actually issued by gangster Goldy Brar or whether someone used his name in connection with a personal or property-related dispute,” police said.

District police and the Delhi Police Special Cell are jointly investigating the case, with efforts underway to trace the foreign number, establish the caller’s identity and determine the motive behind the demand. Investigators are examining technical evidence linked to the WhatsApp call and the number used.



Police are also looking into whether the threat has any connection to the woman’s ancestral property in Civil Lines or stems from a personal dispute unrelated to any organised crime network, sources said. Police said the woman has a family dispute following the death of her father-in-law, and the circumstances surrounding the alleged extortion call are being examined in this context.

Police are trying to ascertain the identity of the caller, the motive behind the call and whether the caller had any links with Brar. The ₹200 crore figure marks a significant escalation compared to previous extortion demands

reported in Delhi, which have typically ranged from a few lakhs to a few crores, making this case an outlier in both scale and the audacity of the name attached to it.

Goldy Brar, wanted by Indian agencies in connection with several high-profile crimes, has repeatedly had his name invoked in extortion calls made to businessmen, celebrities and now, in this case, an ordinary property owner, across the country in recent years, a pattern that has made it increasingly difficult for police to distinguish genuine threats linked to organised crime networks from opportunistic callers exploiting a name that instantly signals danger.

Gym owner held for attempt to murder after ramming woman biker

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Gurugram/New Delhi

A 33-year-old gym owner accused of ramming his speeding car into a woman biker, knocking her off and sending her skidding down a road, was arrested on Tuesday on charges of attempt to murder and stalking following a two-day search, police said. Kalyan Bainsla and a cousin, who were together on Sunday when the collision took place on Gurugram’s Golf Course Road, were nabbed from Rajgarh in Rajasthan, a short distance from Gurugram.

The police said Bainsla passed indecent comments against 27-year-old biker Shivani Chauhan, who shared a video of the dramatic hit-and-run, which raised concerns over rash driving, harassment and the vulnerability of women and two-wheeler riders.

After his arrest, he also tried to escape custody on the pretext of urinating, fell, and got hurt, they said. He



Woman biker Shivani Chauhan, who identifies herself as Sia, speaks to the media following a video surfaced on social media showing her riding a bike after a speeding car allegedly hit her, knocking her off the bike and dragging it for several metres at Gurugram’s Golf Course Road in New Delhi on Tuesday

was given first aid at a hospital. Bainsla has been accused of grazing Chauhan, who was riding an Aprilia ₹457, at speed in his Maruti Suzuki Ciaz, coming from behind.

The police have impounded the car, registered in the name of an acquaintance, and detained Bainsla’s cousin, Lovneesh, who was with him in the car at the time of the incident.

Addressing the media here,

Gurugram DCP (East) Sandeep Kumar said the victim claimed that Bainsla hurled a slur at her before the incident and tried to kill her. “It can be clearly seen that he deliberately hit (the biker) from the side after an argument... the intent was to kill the victim. The victim has also told the police that the intention was to kill her,” he said.

Gurugram Police Commissioner Sibash Kabiraj

said he was booked under an attempt-to-murder charge after a scrutiny of Instagram videos and CCTV footage.

Earlier, after giving an interview to the media, Bainsla switched off his mobile phone and absconded. Three teams constituted to track him nabbed him in Rajasthan.

According to the police, on September 14, a female biker shared a video on Instagram showing that she had been struck by a car on Golf Course Road the previous morning. The Gurugram Police tried to contact the victim, but as there was no formal complaint, it filed a suo motu case at the Sector-56 Police Station, the officer said. Following Bainsla’s arrest, the biker, who identifies herself as ‘Siya’ on Instagram, joined the police investigation.

On her complaint, the police added Section 109 (attempt to murder), Section 78 (physical and digital stalking), and Section 79 (acts against modesty of a woman) of the BNS to the FIR, the DCP said.

Zoo caretaker injured after monkey escapes enclosure, attacks staff

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A Delhi Zoo caretaker suffered multiple injuries, including a severed finger and deep bites on both legs, after a monkey escaped its enclosure and attacked the employee inside the staff gallery. A visitor was also injured in the attack, according to a zoo staffer. The incident occurred on Monday morning, when caretaker Alok entered the gallery, a space located outside the animal enclosures and used by caretakers and other zoo staff.

Alok said the monkey (bonnet macaque species) came out of its enclosure on Sunday night after its gate was allegedly not locked properly and entered the caretaker gallery. The bonnet macaque is a brownish monkey commonly found in southern India and is known for its agility and strong bite.

“The monkey was already there when I entered the caretaker gallery. Before I could do anything or call anyone, it attacked me. There were also a few visitors in the area at the time,” Alok



(Left to right) A monkey is seen in an enclosure after he attacked and an injured zoo-keeper of National Zoological Park after he was attacked by a monkey in New Delhi

said. He alleged that the monkey subsequently attacked a visitor as well.

“It ran out and attacked one of the visitors and bit him on the thigh,” he said. The zoo director did not respond to the allegations despite attempts to contact him. Alok alleged that the enclosure’s locking mechanism was faulty and could not be secured properly, allowing the monkey to escape.

“The monkeys tend to come out (of the enclosure) because of this,” he said.

He further alleged that the animal section in-charge did not regularly visit the

enclosure to check on the animals and claimed that no range officer was present when the attack took place.

“At the time of the attack, there was no range officer there,” he added. The incident triggered panic among visitors, who raised an alarm after noticing the attack, following which zoo officials took the injured caretaker to Dr Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital for treatment, he said.

Delhi Zoo Director Sanjeet Kumar said that detailed assessment and enquiry into the circumstances leading to biting incident is being

undertaken. “Necessary strengthening of corrective and preventive measures including measures related to enclosure access, cleaning protocol, staff safety and animal handling will be implemented to prevent recurrence of such incident,” Kumar said. He added that worker is recovering and discharged from hospital.

According to Zoo staffer, the same monkey had attacked another staff member in December 2025, leaving him with multiple injuries. The latest incident has once again raised concerns over the safety of zoo staff who work closely with animals and the adequacy of safety arrangements around animal enclosures.

In April 2025, a zookeeper trained to handle herbivores was assigned the responsibility of taking care of a leopard and suffered multiple injuries after an attack. Zoo staffers have previously raised concerns about manpower shortages and the allocation of duties involving animals outside their usual areas of expertise.



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार



NATIONAL HEALTH MISSION
राष्ट्रीय स्वास्थ्य मिशन



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

दिल्ली सरकार द्वारा आयोजित

महा रक्तदान शिविर

आइए, अधिक से अधिक संख्या में रक्तदान करें
और मानव कल्याण, जीवन कल्याण के इस पुनीत कार्य में सहभागी बनें।

17 सितंबर 2026

⌚

मुबह 08:00 बजे से शाम 5:00 बजे तक

📍

त्यागराज स्टेडियम, नई दिल्ली



DIP/Shabdarth/Display/088/26-27

IN FOCUS



Police personnel use water canons on Congress leaders and workers as they stage a protest demanding the removal of Finance Minister Harpal Singh Cheema over the alleged suicide of a man in Chandigarh on Tuesday

PTI

CM Naidu sets 2029 target for permanent houses

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Amaravati

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu on Tuesday directed officials to implement "Housing for All" programme on a saturation basis with the objective of providing a permanent house to every eligible family in the State by 2029.

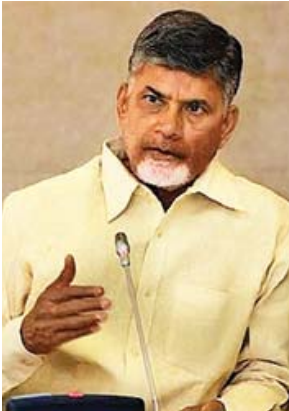
The Chief Minister instructed officials to complete 5.52 lakh houses by March 2027, said an official release.

"Naidu directed officials to implement the Housing for All programme on a saturation basis, with the objective of providing a permanent house to every eligible family in the state by 2029," it said.

During a review meeting, the CM instructed officials to ground all housing projects to be taken up under various schemes, including Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Gramin (PMAY-G) and PM Janman by next month. He instructed officials to construct 1.5 lakh houses in urban areas, and complete over two lakh houses by December 2026 and another 2.74 lakh houses by March 2027 to make them ready for housewarming ceremonies.

Meanwhile, officials apprised the CM of the 18.72 lakh houses that had been sanctioned in the state under PMAY 1.0, PMAY 2.0 and PM Janman, out of which 13.2 lakh houses have been completed so far.

Under the Andhra Pradesh Housing Corporation, construction of 11.31 lakh houses, out of



a total 16.11 lakh houses has been completed and under Andhra Pradesh Township and Infrastrucure Development Corporation (AP TIDCO) 1.88 lakh houses out of 2.61 lakh houses have been completed, officials said

The CM directed officials to ensure the sanction of 75,000 new houses by December 2027 and bring another 1.5 lakh houses into the pipeline.

Officials were asked to coordinate with the Union Ministries of Rural Development and Housing & Urban Affairs to secure the required allocations.

Further, Naidu directed officials to identify the actual demand among families having no housing sites by integrating data from various departments.

Likewise, the CM instructed officials to publish preliminary beneficiary lists at the village and ward secretariat level, invite objections, resolve them transparently and then finalise the beneficiary lists.

Bishnoi aide deported, arrested

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi/Chandigarh

The Punjab Police's Anti-Gangster Task Force (AGTF) on Tuesday arrested a member of the notorious Lawrence Bishnoi gang at Indira Gandhi International Airport following his deportation from Canada. Karamveer Singh, also known as Karamveer Deo is a close associate of a jailed gangster and helped Anmol Bishnoi by providing support and a hiding place in the US, said Gaurav Yadav, Director General of Punjab Police. Anmol, Bishnoi's younger brother, was arrested by the National Investigation Agency (NIA) after being deported from the US in November 2025. He had been on the run since 2022.

While investigating Anmol's network overseas, police found Karamveer involvement. On 3 September 2026, the AGTF issued a Look Out Circular for Singh. Security agencies were then alerted to his return. When his flight from Canada landed in New Delhi, an AGTF team arrested him at the airport.

Yadav said that Singh has a history of crimes, including murder, attempted murder, robbery, extortion, and



Punjab Police Anti-Gangster Task Force personnel with Karamveer Singh following his deportation from Canada, at Indira Gandhi International Airport in New Delhi

PTI

offences under the Arms Act. "Further investigation is underway to reveal his wider criminal network and activities," the DGP said. Investigators will also look into his links to international gangs and his role in other crimes.

Karamveer was charged in Punjab in 2012 for shooting a political figure. He spent several years in prison, was released on

bail in 2019 after his father died, and then left India while the case was still pending. Investigators have identified three main areas to pursue. Firstly, they will investigate the claim that Karamveer offered accommodation and logistical assistance to Anmol in the US and will examine how this support was arranged. Secondly, they will study the previ-

ous cases, including the circumstances under which Singh left India and then stayed abroad. Thirdly, they will trace Singh's associates, the flow of money, and any other role he may have played in offences connected to the Bishnoi network.

Police said they produce Singh in court and keep questioning him while he is in custody.

Delhi Police busts pan-India matrimonial cyber fraud

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Police has busted a pan-India matrimonial cyber fraud racket allegedly run from Agra by a 29-year-old practicing advocate, who used fake profiles, staged conversations with women posing as prospective brides and multiple payment demands to dupe men seeking marriage.

Amit Kumar allegedly operated a fake matchmaking service under the name "Shaadi Partner" and deliberately capped the fraud at Rs 15,000 per victim, a strategy police said was aimed at discouraging complaints.

The firm was also registered under the MSME and UP Labour Department, while banking channels and SIM cards were procured in its name, Deputy Commissioner of Police (Central) Rohit Rajbir said.

Police registered an FIR after a complainant alleged that he was lured through a website and cheated of Rs 15,000 on the pretext of registration, profile access, activation and contact

unlocking charges.

Investigation into the complaint led police to a current account registered in the name of "MS Shaadi Partner Com", into which the money had been deposited. Analysis of the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (NCRP) database showed that the account was linked to six complaints from different parts of the country involving a similar modus operandi, police said.

A police team raided a fully operational call centre at an apartment in Agra on September 4 and arrested a 44-year-old woman who was the proprietor of the firm on paper. Eight female tele-callers were also apprehended, officials said.

During interrogation, the woman allegedly disclosed Kumar's role in the operation. According to police, Kumar had created a layered arrangement to distance himself from the alleged fraud. He allegedly floated the proprietorship firm "M/s Shaadi Partner Com" in the woman's name and executed a franchise



agreement with Netnexis Solutions (OPC) Pvt Ltd.

Kumar allegedly portrayed himself as the firm's "legal advisor", allowing him to claim that he was merely providing legal services and was not responsible for the call centre's operations, police said. After learning about the raid, Kumar switched off his mobile phones and went underground, police said. Technical surveillance helped investigators track him to Agra.

He was intercepted in the Kala Kunj area of Agra on September 8 while travelling in an SUV, police said. Kumar showed his UP State Bar Council credentials and claimed he was only a legal counsel. However, investigators confronted him with digital evidence allegedly linking him to the operation, following which he was arrested, they said.

Police said the syndicate had been operating for

around a year and specifically targeted men seeking brides. The accused allegedly sourced contact numbers of matrimonial seekers from its website as well as matchmaking pages, groups and comments on social media.

Female tele-callers contacted the men and assessed their financial background before sending them photographs of women sourced from the

internet as prospective brides. Once a victim showed interest, the callers allegedly demanded money in stages under different heads, including registration, file activation, security deposits and membership packages ranging from Rs 2,500 to Rs 15,000.

To make the operation appear genuine, dummy profiles of clients were allegedly created on the website, and screenshots were sent to them. When a victim wanted to speak to a woman whose photograph had been shown to him, another female employee allegedly posed as the prospective bride during conference calls, police said. The women would speak to victims for several days before rejecting the proposed alliance on pretexts such as "Manglik dosh", family disapproval or the woman having been engaged elsewhere.

If the victims sought more matches, the callers allegedly provided details of other families whose profiles were already available on the portal.

FROM PAGE - 1

UPI over ₹2,000 gets 0.4% MDR

Essential and thin-margin sectors — railways, telecom, insurance, fuel and agricultural inputs — will pay a flat MDR of ₹5 per transaction above ₹2,000, intended to keep costs predictable for critical services; these categories account for nearly 17 per cent of P2M transaction volume but roughly 46 per cent of P2M transaction value.

The same flat-fee treatment extends to Government utility bill collection (electricity, water, piped gas) and educational fee payments such as school tuition and university fees above ₹2,000, both similarly exempted below that threshold.

Payments into mutual funds, securities and through stockbrokers and dealers will attract a lighter 0.02 per cent MDR, capped at ₹300 — a rate designed to keep the cost of investing low and encourage retail participation in formal financial markets.

The charges so collected will be distributed among the firms facilitating the transactions and are being introduced to bolster investment into infrastructure resilience, innovation, cybersecurity and customer service, the National Payments Corporation of India said.

The government has also moved to prevent the new charges from being quietly passed on to consumers: UPI app providers are barred from levying platform fees or hidden charges, and banks have been directed to ensure merchants do not pass MDR costs on to customers.

Small merchants remain the most protected category. Vendors receiving up to Rs 1 lakh a month via UPI QR codes — classified under a Person-to-Person-Merchant (P2PM) framework — will continue to pay zero MDR on all transactions, with no requirement to register for GST or upgrade existing QR infrastructure.

Acquiring banks will track inward payments via a velocity check, and merchants exceeding ₹1 lakh a month for three consecutive months move into the standard P2M category. Zero MDR under this framework also extends to rural and semi-urban QR payments, an area the government has flagged as a core policy priority.

India calls Pakistan's Masood Azhar reward...

In 2019, the United Nations Security Council designated Azhar as a global terrorist. Islamabad has maintained that Azhar is no longer in Pakistan and has said that he fled to Afghanistan. In 2021, Pakistan's Federal Investigation Agency (FIA) announced a reward of PKR 50 lakh for information that could lead to his arrest.

India has repeatedly called for Azhar to be brought to justice, while his whereabouts and alleged continued presence in the region have remained a source of friction in bilateral relations.

The latest Pakistani announcement is unlikely to ease tensions between the two countries. New Delhi's position remains that Pakistan's commitment to combating terrorism should be measured by arrests, prosecutions and the dismantling of terrorist networks, rather than by public announcements.

BJP predicts record win in Nandigram bypolls

He had won from both Nandigram and Bhawanipore in south Kolkata where he had defeated Mamata Banerjee. Adhikari preferred to retain the Bhawanipore seat after becoming the CM.

Apart from Nandigram, by-elections will also be held for Rejinagar seat in Muslim dominated Murshidabad district. Rejinagar fell vacant after sitting MLA Humayun Kabir vacated the seat. Kabir too had won both from Rejinagar and Bharatpur and preferred to leave the former seat nominating his son Ghulam Nabi Azad. The BJP fielded Shakharav Sarkar, the district party president of Murshidabad from Rejinagar, while the TMC fielded Rabiul Islam a party veteran.

Vowing to fulfil all the promises he had made in the past, Adhikari asked the Muslim community to decide as to which party they would like to favour. "It is for the Muslims to decide which party they want to support ... October 6 (election date) will be your test whether you will want to be with the Government and work with the CM in the development of the State or choose something else," he said. Iterating that Chandranath was murdered because he had bravely sided with him, Adhikari said that justice would be done to one and all. Rath

"The BJP workers who had suffered endless atrocities too would get justice," he said adding the Government would look into the false cases that had been slapped on many party men during the TMC regime.

Adhikari's claim comes on a day when the BJP national president Nitin Navin arrived in Bengal to supervise the organisational preparedness of the party ahead of the by-elections.

Meta opens direct route to I4C on CSAM

"We are committed to working with the Government to make sure that those who commit these crimes are held accountable and to strengthen our efforts to combat this harm jointly, Meta will now report child safety issues directly to the cybercrime portal run by I4C," a spokesperson for the company said. Meta is the first major global technology company to promise a direct reporting route to Indian law enforcement.

Until now, the company mostly sent CSAM reports through the US-based National Centre for Missing and Exploited Children. Indian authorities have criticised this process for adding extra steps between the platforms and local investigators. Government sources said that children's online safety is a "fundamental principle" for any social media platform in India and called it "non-negotiable". Sources cautioned that the Government will act against platforms that do not take proactive measures to protect children online. They said the Union Government is still in contact with other platforms to ensure they identify and remove such content themselves. The officials referred to Meta's commitment as an initial step toward making platforms safer for children, while stressing that much more remains to be done. This announcement follows several months of closer scrutiny. The Government has sent notices to Meta about how it handles harmful and illegal content, including CSAM and deepfakes, and had recently summoned the company's top executives to India.

In July, following a *BBC Eye* investigation into paid advertisements on Instagram used to promote and access CSAM, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

sent a notice to Meta.

The ministry instructed Instagram to switch off those advertisements and asked for a full explanation. It said it had held several rounds of talks with Meta's top executives and made it clear that such content cannot benefit from safe-harbour protection. The National Human Rights Commission separately directed Delhi Police to investigate whether Meta had complied with mandatory reporting obligations under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, and issued a follow-up notice in early August seeking action-taken reports from MeitY, police authorities and Meta.

This month, the National Commission for the Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) summoned the head of Meta India as part of an investigation into advertisements allegedly linked to CSAM.

The I4C, set up by the Ministry of Home Affairs, runs the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, which focuses on crimes against women and children. It has also set up the Sahyog portal so content takedown requests can go directly to the right platforms. Intermediaries have been told to appoint nodal officers to report cases of child sexual abuse material and to use artificial intelligence tools to find and remove such content. With direct reporting to the I4C portal, Indian authorities can now get child safety cases without first going through an overseas group. Officials say this change is meant to speed up investigations and make enforcement stronger against those who produce, share, or benefit from this material.

After Satya Niketan tragedy, Delhi plans...

The CM added that the hostel facility will be for students of both the genders.

The Government is also framing a policy to ensure proper accommodation facilities for students who come to Delhi in large numbers every year, said the CM. The Government will also conduct a survey of colleges that have sufficient space for hostel construction. The process of constructing hostels will be expedited after suitable locations are identified.

The CM said hostel construction was under way or had been proposed at several institutions,

including Ambedkar University, Dhirpur, GB Pant Engineering College and Polytechnic, Indira Gandhi Hospital and Medical College, and Delhi Sports University.

The issue of lack of proper hostel facilities for the students in Delhi has come under sharper focus in the wake of the PG building collapse incident in Satya Niketan in South Delhi campus that left seven persons, including five students, dead. Laks of students are forced to live in unsafe buildings at PG hubs across the national Capital, paying high rents and poor amenities.

Delhi University has only 7,224 official hostel beds: 3,688 in college hostels for undergraduate students and 3,536 in non-college DU hostels for postgraduate students. Another 863 beds are to be added in the next year in hostels that are under construction in four colleges — Hindu, Hansraj, Ramjas and Kalindi colleges.

The CM underlined that it's important to fulfil the requirements of hostels for colleges and universities if Delhi has to emerge as a bigger education hub of the country.

Laks of students reach Delhi for admissions to various institutions but fail to get hostel facilities, she said.

Delhi Education and Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood also chaired the first meeting of a 20-member High-Powered Committee on Student Accommodation and Safety on Tuesday, with the panel deciding to develop a central portal within 15 days for PG owners to register their facilities, detailing building age, structure size and fire safety measures. The committee was constituted by the Lieutenant Governor to review and address the acute shortage, safety standards and regulation of student housing across the capital.

Welcoming the decision, the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) said the move would help address the shortage of safe and affordable accommodation in the national capital "Providing adequate and safe hostel facilities for students in Delhi has been a long-standing demand of ABVP," Delhi State Secretary Sarthak Sharma said.

He said increasing the number of hostels and ensuring safer residential facilities was also part of ABVP's manifesto for the upcoming Delhi University Students' Union elections.

BJP rejects Congress claims on UPI fee, calls it misleading

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The BJP on Tuesday accused the Congress of spreading false information about transaction charges and repeated that the Government had already clarified that no merchant discount rate (MDR) charges would be applied to consumers.

The BJP responded after the Congress criticised the Centre's notification about UPI transactions. Congress leader Rahul Gandhi said the notification could allow fees for these transactions and accused Prime Minister

Narendra Modi of giving in to outside pressure.

Pradeep Bhandari, a BJP spokesperson, said the Congress's statements were misleading. "The Congress is once again disseminating false information; 96 per cent of UPI merchant (P2M) transactions are worth ₹2,000 or less and are entirely free of charges. RuPay debit card payments are also free of charge. Consumers do not have to pay any transaction fee, and P2P UPI transactions remain completely free," he wrote on X.

The BJP leader also said the Government has made it



BJP spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari

clear that MDR charges will not be imposed on consumers. The Government notice instructs banks and payment system providers not to charge fees for Unified Payments Interface (UPI)

transactions of ₹2,000 or for payments made using RuPay debit cards.

The notification does not say whether charges will apply to transactions over ₹2,000, which is the amount

relevant for merchant payments. So far, no charges have been applied to UPI transactions, regardless of the amount.

A panel made up of representatives from banks, service providers, and associations will decide what charges, if any, will apply to merchants for UPI transactions over ₹2,000. The UPI & Services Steering Committee has 22 members, including the Indian Banks' Association (IBA) and the Payments Council of India (PCI). The Congress has raised concerns about the Government's notification, saying it could lead

to user fees.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said the Modi Government's "loot" has now reached UPI.

In a post on X in Hindi, Kharge quoted the finance minister as recently saying in Parliament that no tax or charge would be imposed on UPI. He added that some reports suggest ₹25 could be collected on a ₹5,000 transaction and up to ₹50 on a ₹10,000 transaction, and asked if this was true.

Amit Malviya of the BJP called the Congress's claims "completely false" and said no Government order says

₹25 should be charged on a ₹5,000 payment or ₹50 on a ₹10,000 payment.

He wrote on X that the notification from September 14 only clarified the 'zero-charge protection' for UPI and RuPay transactions up to ₹2,000, and that no 0.5 per cent charge has been imposed on UPI payments over ₹2,000. For UPI users, person-to-person UPI transactions will remain free no matter how much money is involved. As he added, the Government has made it clear that even if a merchant discount rate is introduced in the future, it will

apply to particular merchant transactions, not to the consumer.

Malviya said the ₹25 and ₹50 figures mentioned by the Congress are "made-up calculations based on a hypothetical rate of 0.5 per cent", providing incentives to the payment ecosystem to keep UPI free. Between FY22 and FY24, the Government provided incentives amounting to ₹1,389 crore, ₹2,210 crore, and ₹3,631 crore, respectively. Incentive support of ₹2,196.21 crore was provided for 2025-26, and ₹2,000 crore has been budgeted for FY27," he said.

India-US joint military exercise gets underway

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A joint military exercise — 'Yudh Abhyas' — involving the troops of Indian and US armies, which seeks to bolster interoperability among the two forces and address emerging challenges while further strengthening the bilateral defence partnership, kicked off on Tuesday.

The opening ceremony of the 22nd edition of the exercise was held at Auli Foreign Training Node in Uttarakhand. The exercise is simultaneously being conducted at Auli and Mahajan Field Firing Range in Rajasthan, the Indian defence ministry said.

"The exercise is aimed at enhancing the joint military capability of both armies for employment of Integrated Battle Groups in mountainous and semi-mountainous terrain, with emphasis on infantry-dominated operations. It will strengthen inter-



Representative image

operability, facilitate exchanges of best operational practices and strengthen joint planning and execution," it said in a statement.

Maj Gen Amaresh Gunjan, General Officer Commanding, 14 Infantry Division and Col Benjamin Jackman, Commander, 1st Infantry Brigade Combat Team, 11th Airborne Division, US Army, addressed the participating contingents comprising 600 personnel from each side, the ministry said.

Technology infusion will form a key focus area. The training will include the

employment of drones and autonomous systems for surveillance and reconnaissance, as well as demonstration of contemporary weapon systems, which will be undertaken at Mahajan Field Firing Ranges, officials said.

"Subject matter experts from both the armies will also exchange views on emerging technologies and developments in multi-domain warfare," it said.

The exercise provides an opportunity for both the armies to share tactics, techniques and procedures; and enhance their ability to

undertake coordinated military operations across varied terrain and operational environment.

The US Embassy in India, in a post on X on Tuesday, said, "The 22nd edition of Exercise Yudh Abhyas is underway! Over the next two weeks, US and Indian soldiers will train together, sharing skills, building readiness, and improving collaboration between our forces. Through field training, live-fire exercises, and the exchange of expertise and experiences, Yudh Abhyas 2026 aims to strengthen interoperability among our forces and address emerging challenges while further strengthening the US-India defense partnership."

US Ambassador Sergio Gor sharing the post, said, "Over the next two weeks, US and Indian soldiers will train together, sharing skills, building readiness, and improving collaboration between our forces."

Disha Salian FIR plot to tarnish Thackerays: Raut

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Sanjay Raut on Tuesday alleged that the CBI's first information report (FIR) in the Disha Salian death case is a political conspiracy orchestrated by the Centre to tarnish the Thackeray family's reputation.

Speaking to reporters, the Rajya Sabha MP pointed out that Mumbai police had already probed the matter thoroughly and cleared Sena (UBT) leader Aaditya Thackeray of any link to the former celebrity manager's death in June 2020.

The CBI has registered an FIR in connection with the death of Salian, former manager of late actor Sushant Singh Rajput, naming no accused in compliance with Bombay High Court directives on a petition filed by her father.

"The way the matter was taken to court, which gave an



Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Sanjay Raut

order (to hand over the case to CBI), is a conspiracy. It has specifically said to conduct a CBI probe but does not name anyone. Yet names are being taken in the media," the Sena (UBT) leader said.

He claimed the CBI probe is being weaponised to target Aaditya Thackeray, who has been attacking the Devendra Fadnavis-led Maharashtra Government on various public issues.

He also termed it an attempt to divert attention from Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange's agitation or put pressure on the Shiv

Sena (UBT) to support the delimitation bill in Parliament.

On September 2, the Bombay High Court ordered a CBI probe into Salian's death while pulling up the Mumbai Police for failing to register an FIR for six years, observing that its investigation raises more questions than answers.

"This is a political conspiracy by Delhi to tarnish the image of the Thackeray family, which enjoys a place in the hearts of people," Raut added.

He also alleged that the FIR

is being selectively leaked to the media, citing that of the 16 pages, only one has been shared.

Raut accused the Centre of earlier starting a campaign against Congress leader Sonia Gandhi, the DMK, Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister Chandrababu Naidu, former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee and former Odisha Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik.

"The same people have started a campaign against the Thackeray family because of the ongoing Supreme Court case on the bow and arrow party symbol (allotted to Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena)," he said.

The case has reached a turning point and "someone" is scared, he claimed. "If the judgement is given in an impartial way, Maharashtra politics will change, and the Thackeray family will again occupy the centre stage," Raut added.

Bihar floods: Rahul urges Govt to carry out relief, rescue operations

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In the wake of devastating floods in Bihar, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday urged the Government and the administration to carry out relief and rescue operations with full promptness and ensure that essential aid reaches the affected families as soon as possible.

The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha also appealed to Congress workers to step forward and provide all possible assistance to the affected people.

"The loss of lives due to the devastating floods in Bihar is extremely heartbreaking. I express my deepest condolences to the families who have lost their loved ones in this disaster. My sympathies are with all those affected by this tragedy," Gandhi said in a post in Hindi on X.

"I appeal to Congress workers to step forward and provide all possible assistance to the affected people. At the same time, I expect the



Government and administration to carry out relief and rescue operations with full promptness and ensure that essential aid reaches the affected families as soon as possible," Gandhi said.

Nearly 50 lakh people in 15 districts of Bihar have been affected by floods as heavy rain over the past few days further swelled rivers already flowing above their danger marks, officials said on Monday.

The State has recorded 112.7 mm of rain so far in September, around six per cent above normal, the local weather office said.

An official said incessant rain in the catchment areas of rivers flowing from Nepal into Bihar, coupled with heavy rainfall, has caused several rivers and streams to flow above their danger marks.

According to the Disaster Management Department, 49.67 lakh people in 15 districts have been affected by floods.

The affected districts are Patna, Bhojpur, Saran, Vaishali, Bhagalpur, Begusarai, Buxar, Samastipur, Munger, Katihar, Lakhisarai, Khagaria, Purnea, Madhepura and Araria.

Pension Sakhis to spread financial literacy among rural households, MoU signed

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

To bring pension awareness and retirement security to rural households, the Department of Rural Development (DoRD) and the (PFRDA) on Tuesday signed an MoU to create and support a community-based outreach mechanism of 'Pension Sakhis' across rural India.

The MoU was signed by DoRD Joint Secretary Amit Shukla and PFRDA Executive Director Sumeet Kaur Kapoor in the presence of Rohit Kansal, secretary, DoRD, the Rural Development ministry said in a statement.

It said the partnership seeks to leverage the extensive network created under the Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM), including its Banking Correspondent (BC) Sakhis, to spread pension awareness, financial literacy, enrolment and post-enrolment support



among rural households.

The initiative will seek to use the strength of the women-led Self Help Groups (SHG) institutional architecture, wherein Pension Sakhis will act as community-level facilitators, particularly reaching SHG members, rural women, Lakhpati Didis and other rural participants. They will support households with information on pension and retirement planning, facilitate enrolment, and provide assistance in understanding pension-related services. Speaking on the occa-

sion, Kansal said that rural households participating in the SHG movement have distinctive savings patterns, livelihood cycles and risk profiles, and that social security must therefore become an important part of the Mission's larger objective of sustainable prosperity.

He emphasised that "social security is not only about protection against vulnerability; it is also about giving households the confidence and resilience to pursue sustained economic advancement."

The Rural Development

secretary highlighted the importance of ensuring that rural citizens receive transparent information on pension awareness and financial literacy, so that they can make informed choices about their long-term financial security.

The Ministry added that the collaboration will also strengthen monitoring of outreach and enrolment through digital dashboards and mobile- and web-based solutions, including the Department's own system, enabling the participating institutions to track progress and identify gaps in coverage.

Community-level outreach will be supported by appropriate digital systems for monitoring and service delivery.

"The initiative marks an important evolution in the role of the Mission's community cadres — from facilitating access to banking and livelihoods to helping rural households build long-term financial security and resilience," the Ministry said.

4 KILLED AFTER REFRIGERATOR EXPLODES IN KARNATAKA

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Belagavi (Karnataka)

Four women members of a family were killed and two others were seriously injured after a refrigerator reportedly exploded at their house early Tuesday, police said.

The incident occurred in Chavat Galli, they said.

The deceased were identified as Ganga Damone (25), Sharada Dhamone (45), Priya Dhamone (28) and Bharati Dhamone (50), police said.

Gajanan Dhamone (65) and his son Roshan Dhamone (21) sustained serious injuries in the incident and were rushed to a hospital, where they are undergoing treatment, they said.

According to police, preliminary information revealed that the fire reportedly broke out after a refrigerator exploded inside the house. The flames quickly spread throughout the premises, trapping the occupants inside. The victims were unable to escape, resulting in the tragic incident.

Will keep raising corruption issues: Kumaraswamy

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Hassan (Karnataka)

Claiming efforts were on to "intimidate and silence" him, Union Minister HD Kumaraswamy said on Tuesday that attempts to tarnish his family's image would not silence him from raising issues of alleged corruption and irregularities in Karnataka.

He claimed that with the sole intention of suppressing his fight against irregularities under the Congress Government, fresh allegations against his nephew and former MP Prajwal Revanna, who is serving a life sentence in a rape case, is being pushed to the forefront, and it is being used to malign his family.

The JD(S) leader further asserted that he would continue to bring alleged scams before the people with documentary evidence. He also indicated that he will release the expose around the Vijayadashami festival next month.

Further pointing out that when the Congress Government came to power, he had displayed a pen drive in front of Vidhana Soudha claiming it contained evidence relating to bribery and conversations regarding money collection related to transfers, Kumaraswamy said, "The information in that pen drive related to the corruption of the present Chief Minister," i.e. DK Shivakumar.

In response, Shivakumar told reporters, "Let anyone say whatever they want, discuss whatever they want, and release whatever



Union Minister HD Kumaraswamy

they want. Who can stop them."

Kumaraswamy's comments have come amid much curiosity in political circles about the "expose" he would make in the coming days, as ahead of leaving for a trip abroad recently, he had warned about his exposure creating political "turmoil."

"Before leaving for the United States recently, I had raised several issues, including the KPSC, Bidadi Township and NICE scams. These allegations have shaken certain people at their very foundation. That is why attempts are now being made to bring up jail-related issues to silence our family," Kumaraswamy alleged.

CRPF revokes suspension of senior DIG-rank officer

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The CRPF on Tuesday revoked the about three-month old suspension of a senior DIG-rank officer who was charged with sharing social media content that allegedly sought a "change" in the Government during the passage of the 2026 CAPF bill, officials said. They told media that the order issued by the headquarters of the paramilitary force stated that the suspension of Deputy Inspector General (DIG) Bidhan Chandra Patra was being revoked with "immediate effect".

The order was issued almost 20 days after the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) considered the "merits" of the case and directed the CRPF on August 27 to withdraw the suspension. It added that the period of the suspension, from June 18, will be "regularised" after finalisation of



the pending inquiry against the officer. The highly decorated DIG is a 1994-batch CRPF cadre officer. He returned to the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) in April after completing a deputation posting with the federal counter-terrorist commando force NSG.

Patra was suspended under relevant clauses of the CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965.

The charges against him included alleged sharing of audio-visual and pictorial content on social media platforms that allegedly called for "changing" the country's lawfully elected Government during the passage of the Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Bill 2026.

CBI books Arunachal environmental activist over alleged illegal foreign contributions under FCRA

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The CBI has booked Arunachal environmental activist and lawyer Bhanu Tatak for allegedly receiving ₹20.94 lakh in foreign funds without registration or prior permission under the FCRA. The agency alleged the money was used to "organise and sustain" protests against two hydropower projects in the state.

There was no immediate response available from Bhanu Tatak to the allegations.

The FIR, registered on August 20 by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) Economic Offences-II branch in Delhi, names Tatak and unknown persons under sections 11(1), 17, 19 and 35 of the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act, 2010.

It is alleged that Bhanu Tatak maintained a savings bank account with the State Bank of India, Roing, and during 2022 to 2025,



₹20,94,088 was received in the account through forex transactions without obtaining requisite prior permission under the FCRA from the competent authority, the Ministry of Home Affairs, the FIR said.

A preliminary enquiry had alleged that Tatak, Legal Advisor of the Siang Indigenous Farmers Forum (SIFF) and Coordinator of Dibang Resistance (DR), received foreign contributions directly into her personal savings bank account without obtaining mandatory certification of registration under the FCRA.

The preliminary enquiry alleged that the funds were "being utilised to organise and sustain anti-dam protests" in Arunachal Pradesh against the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project (SUMP) and Dibang Multipurpose Hydropower Project.

The enquiry said Tatak received the money from foreign entities.

"The purpose of the receipt of funds was undisclosed," the enquiry said, adding that the received funds were predominantly utilised by Tatak through several UPI transactions.

States Focus



MULTILINGUAL CULTURE DOESN'T ALTER MARATHI IDENTITY: CM

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis on Tuesday accused MNS chief Raj Thackeray of “selective listening”, and asserted Union Home Minister Amit Shah had only spoken about the state’s multilingual culture, which doesn’t necessarily alter native identity.

Fadnavis’s comments have come after Thackeray took an indirect jab at Shah’s remark that Maharashtra had the country’s most multilingual culture, with Marathi, Konkani, Gujarati, Sindhi, Hindi, Kannada and Warli among the languages spoken and developed here.

Taking to X, the Maharashtra Navnirman Sena (MNS) chief, without naming Shah directly, posted, “A cow does not die from a crow’s curse”. Speaking to reporters, Fadnavis said that Thackeray should have listened to Shah’s entire address before rushing to criticise it.

“Selective listening, selective speaking and reacting only to selective things is wrong,” he said. (PTI)



FORMER ANDHRA DEPUTY CM SRINIVAS DIES OF HEART ATTACK

Former Andhra Pradesh deputy Chief Minister A Kali Krishna Srinivas, popularly known as Alla Nani, died on Tuesday due to a heart attack, and TDP leaders, including Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu condoled the death. Srinivas was 56.

“The sudden demise of Alla Nani Garu (Kali Krishna Srinivas), former Deputy Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh state, has deeply shocked me. It is heartbreaking that he passed away due to a heart attack at the young age of 56,” CM Naidu said in a post on X. “I express my profound condolences to his family. I pray to God that his soul attains eternal peace,” he added. TDP working president and IT Minister Nara Lokesh, in a post on X, said, “The news of the death of TDP leader and former minister Aalla Nani due to a heart attack has caused profound shock. Paying my respects to the memory of Nani Garu.” (PTI)

Technology key to self-reliant, secure India: Rajnath Singh

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Tuesday said technological leadership will determine strategic advantage in future warfare, asserting that “our imagination of today will become tomorrow’s military capabilities”.

Addressing a DRDO-hosted event here, he said the vision of a Viksit Bharat by 2047 was not just about building an economically strong India but a “technologically self-reliant, socially inclusive, environmentally sustainable, and strategically secure India”. The defence sector is the “cornerstone” of this vision, Singh said.

“By 2047, we have to achieve self-reliance in critical technologies, significant increase in indigenous content, multi-fold growth in defence exports, and we will have to ensure strong presence of India in global supply chain,” he said.

All this cannot be achieved without collaboration, he said, urging greater partnership among all stakeholders in the sector. The DRDO-Industry Synergy Meet — ‘Vimarsh 2026’ — was hosted at the DRDO Bhawan.

Singh said the partnership



between the DRDO and industry should not be limited to production but should extend to research, design, testing, certification and the entire manufacturing value chain.

Along with big industries, MSMEs and start-ups should also be made an integral component of the value chain, he said. The defence minister said emerging technologies, particularly artificial intelligence and drones, would play a crucial role in future warfare and urged the sector to accelerate technological innovation.

“Today, we are seeing how AI can be used to render an image which seems to be of the 80s (referring to the viral ‘in the 80s’ AI-driven trend online). Joy would be when you can present an image of the future 40-50 years

ahead,” Singh said.

He urged stakeholders in the Indian defence sector to work in that direction.

“How we wish to see India in 40-50 years, the imagination itself will give new energy to our enthusiasm,” he said. Companies investing in new and emerging technologies will emerge as technology leaders in the future, Singh said.

“We need to not just imagine the technology of the future, but we need to develop the technology of the future, today. Because, in future warfare, only that country will be able to leverage a strategic advantage, who will lead the technology. And, our imagination of today will become tomorrow’s military capabilities,” he said.

The event was attended by

several senior DRDO officials and representatives of defence industry firms, among others.

Singh said the partnership between DRDO and industry could make India a global hub for defence manufacturing and there was no other option.

Underlining that reforms in the defence sector in the past few decades had been “unprecedented”, he said self-reliance did not merely mean developing machinery, parts or platforms, but “self-reliance should be a mindset”.

The soul, mind, thought and consciousness should all be imbued with the idea of ‘Atmanirbharta’, Singh said, adding, “the country which has its technology, has the power to build its future”.

Singh also praised start-ups and MSMEs, saying they had emerged as new flag-bearers in the defence sector.

To achieve the goal of ‘Atmanirbhara Bharat’, start-ups and MSMEs have important roles to play, he said.

A new wave of defence start-ups was emerging in India, and they are innovative, agile and disrupting traditional defence models, Singh said.

Congress Punjab factions vow to fight Assembly polls together



Charanjit Singh Channi, Amrinder Singh Raja Warring

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chandigarh

Senior leaders of the Punjab Congress’ feuding factions on Tuesday put up a show of unity, vowing to fight together in the presence of newly appointed party in-charge Sachin Pilot.

During the protest led by Pilot against Finance Minister Harpal Singh Cheema, demanding his removal over the alleged suicide of a Dalit man in Sangrur, former chief minister Charanjit Singh Channi said, “We will fight together”.

Punjab Congress chief Amrinder Singh Raja Warring also called Channi and other leaders his ‘pagg da lar’ (the fold of his turban).

There have been reports of an internal feud within the party since Warring was retained as the state unit chief, while Channi was appointed its campaign committee’s chairperson on July 1. Opposing the move, Channi’s supporters sought his removal from the position.

This was Pilot’s first visit to Punjab since being appointed as the State’s general secretary in-charge. Pilot replaced former Chhattisgarh chief minister Bhupesh Baghel, who will now look after Assam.

During the protest, Channi and Warring sat on either side of Pilot and were seen conversing with each other.

Channi’s supporters demanded that he be the chief minister for the 2027 Assembly elections and accused Baghel, who was replaced by Pilot, of “favouring” Warring.

Channi and former deputy chief minister Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa had not been attending Warring-led party’s events since July.

During his address at the protest, Channi, who is also the Jalandhar MP, referred to the appointment of Pilot as the party’s in-charge of Punjab as “a new hope”.

“Pilot ji, wherever you see, there are only Congress workers here. For this, I congratulate you. We will fight together, we will die for the people of Punjab, we will move forward for the people of Punjab, we will get justice for Punjab. Kejriwal and company, these ‘Kaaale Angreaz,’ we will send them out of Punjab,” he said as he targeted the AAP Government and Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann over various issues.

He accused the chief minister of corruption and unleashing atrocities on Dalits.

“We will take revenge from you one day, remember this,” he said on the suicide of Gulzar Singh.

Leader of Opposition Partap Singh Bajwa said that when they visit villages, people would tell them they want the Congress to win, but when its leaders come together.

“See, all are together today,” he said while pointing towards all state leaders sharing the stage during the protest.

Hailing Pilot’s recent statement that the Punjab assembly elections will be fought “without” any chief ministerial face, Bajwa said, “It will be fought under the leadership of Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and Mallikarjun Kharge.”

Chhattisgarh Govt should ask Union Govt to cancel Tara coal block auction: Ex-CM Baghel

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Raipur

Congress leader Bhupesh Baghel on Tuesday said the BJP Government in Chhattisgarh should ask the Union Government to cancel the auction of the Tara coal block in Hasdeo-Arand region as it would adversely affect forests and tribal communities.

Addressing a press conference here, the former chief minister said that the Centre had excluded 40 coal blocks, including Tara, from the auction process in 2023 following a request from the then Congress Government.

But the Vishnu Deo Sai Government



wrote to the Union Coal Ministry on December 11, 2025, recommending the auction of the block, he claimed.

“The State Government should tell the people on whose instructions and on what basis it wrote to the Centre....It should apologise to the people and

request the Centre to cancel the auction,” Baghel said.

The Tara block is spread over nearly 5,000 acres, of which more than 4,000 acres are covered by dense forests, he claimed.

“Hasdeo and the Bango dam are lifelines of this region. If mining takes place here, lakhs of trees will be felled and the environment will be adversely affected,” Baghel said.

The Congress Government had protected around 1,950 sqkm of forest land for Lemru Elephant Reserve, he said, claiming that mining could affect elephant corridors and pose a threat to wildlife.

Karnataka CM asks people to be mentally prepared for drought

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bengaluru

Flagging drought and a looming shortage of drinking water and electricity in the State, Karnataka Chief Minister DK Shivakumar on Tuesday said people should be “mentally prepared”.

Speaking to reporters, he highlighted the State’s declining rainfall and the Government’s ongoing management measures and also urged legislators not to panic. He advised political parties against exploiting the situation.

“Rainfall is declining too much. But I am requesting there is no need for MLAs to be anxious. There is no point in holding protests for political purposes. The Government is more concerned than you. Some people and opposition parties are trying to use this situation politically,” Shivakumar said in response to a question.



Karnataka Chief Minister DK Shivakumar

The State Government was preparing a report on the drought situation and stressed that it should be accurate when the Union Government conducts its assessment.

“Studies have been completed in some areas and reports have come, while reports for the remaining areas are being prepared. The Meteorological Department had predicted rainfall for a week, but only some areas received limited rain and it was not as much

as expected,” he said.

Stating that there is a drought situation, the CM said State is also witnessing electricity-related problems and preparations are under way to ensure drinking water supply. “People should be mentally prepared. Arrangements are being made for drinking water supply. A special session of State legislature has been convened for this purpose and to discuss farmers’ issues. A Cabinet meeting is being held in Mangaluru this week,” he said.

DMK leaders A Raja, Sekar Babu booked for remarks against TN CM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chennai

Police have registered cases under various legal provisions against senior DMK leaders A Raja and PK Sekar Babu over alleged defamatory remarks against Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay during recent party demonstrations, an official said on Tuesday.

In addition to DMK deputy general secretary Raja and former minister Babu, cases were registered against party MLA Vasantham Karthikeyan for allegedly making defamatory remarks on September 12.

The official confirmed that a case has been registered at BI North Beach Police Station against the DMK’s Harbour MLA and Chennai East district secretary Babu following a complaint that he had made derogatory remarks against the chief minister during the party’s protest.

Saidapet police booked a case against Raja under seven sections based on a complaint lodged by TVK functionary Karthik that Raja made derogatory remarks against the chief minister and Energy Resources and Law Minister R Nirmal Kumar during the protest condemning the chief minister’s speech in the Assembly.



DMK leaders A Raja and PK Sekar Babu

“I will face the case,” Raja said when reporters sought for his comments. “I am also like you. I learnt about the case only now,” he said when pressed.

While speaking at the protest in Saidapet here, Raja made personal remarks questioning the parentage of Kumar.

Daring the ruling TVK to book a case against him, Raja had said even the Congress and BJP leaders had accepted party president MK Stalin’s contribution and his arrest under MISA during the Emergency.

Raja also made a scathing attack on CM Vijay for his jaw gesture and asked if he joined politics to shake his “hand and leg.” He said the CM had no answers to any one of the

questions posed by his party.

The Kallakurichi police registered a case against the Rishivandhiyam legislator Vasantham Karthikeyan for making derogatory remarks against Vijay.

The DMK had organised statewide protests targeting the chief minister’s remarks on Stalin’s detention under MISA during the Emergency.

While making corruption allegations against the DMK in the recently concluded Assembly session, Vijay commented on Stalin’s arrest under the Maintenance of Internal Security Act during the Emergency and made jaw gestures that were spontaneously opposed by the DMK members in the House.

Later, Kumar justified the CM’s

remarks in the Assembly, directly disputing the long-standing narrative that the DMK chief was arrested under the stringent MISA during the 1975–77 Emergency.

Speaking to reporters in Madurai following an inspection of the preparations for the Meenakshi Amman Temple consecration ceremony, the minister asserted that no official detention order copy existed to substantiate Stalin’s claims of being a MISA detainee.

“No detention copy, no MISA arrest,” Kumar had said, accusing the opposition DMK of overreacting and attempting to project Stalin as a political martyr based on unverified historical claims.

“The fundamental question is whether he was detained under MISA or not,” Kumar stated.

“If anyone is arrested under such an act, there will always be a formal detention order copy. Does Stalin or the DMK have that detention copy? He will end up being the only martyr without one,” the minister had said.

Meanwhile, the DMK members led by former State minister MRK Panneerselvam lodged a complaint with Assembly Speaker JCD Prabhakar seeking action against Kumar.

KDA to organise protest march on September 20 in Kargil over Ladakh demands, Leh violence

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kargil

The Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) on Monday announced a major protest rally in Kargil on September 20 to demand justice for the four people killed in police firing in Leh last year and protest what it termed the central Government’s lack of “seriousness and sincerity” in talks on Ladakh’s demands.

The KDA also rejected as inadequate the compensation announced by the Lieutenant Governor recently for the victims of the September 24 violence in Leh and demanded higher restitution for those killed and injured. It also sought the withdrawal, in one go, of all



People protest over the Statehood demand and the inclusion of Ladakh under the Sixth Schedule in Leh

cases registered against those arrested in the aftermath of the violence.

The KDA and the Leh Apex Body (LAB) have been jointly spearheading an agitation since Ladakh was granted Union Territory status in August 2019, pressing for

various demands including statehood and extension of the Sixth Schedule of the Constitution to the region. The two groups have held several rounds of talks with the Centre since 2021.

They described the latest round of talks on September

9 in Delhi as “unproductive” and warned of fresh agitation.

Defending the stand taken by the agitating groups, KDA co-chairman Asgar Ali Karbalai said they had expected the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) to present a concrete draft on the proposed UT-level legislative, governance and financial structure, but no such proposal was placed before them.

“At that meeting, no new or inclusive proposal was presented. The same things that happened in the sub-committee meeting on May 22 were repeated,” Karbalai, flanked by other members of the grouping including co-chairman Sajjad Kargili, told a press conference.

7,350 pilgrims rescued from landslide-hit Kedarnath

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Dehradun/Rudraprayag

A day after 7,200 pilgrims were evacuated from the landslide-affected Kedarnath trek route in Uttarakhand’s Rudraprayag district, another 150 people were brought to safety by rescue teams on Tuesday, according to the State Emergency Operation Centre (SEOC).

According to the latest SEOC report, the pilgrims returning from Kedarnath Dham were safely evacuated from Chirbasa by 10:15 am. With this, a total of 7,350 pilgrims have been safely guided across the route, while the work to clear debris remains underway to resume the Kedarnath pilgrimage, which was halted two days ago.

The SEOC stated that by



Rescue and disaster management personnel clear debris and boulders to restore the damaged Kedarnath pedestrian trek route following a landslide near Chirbasa helipad, in Rudraprayag district, Uttarakhand on Tuesday

Monday evening, 7,200 pilgrims and 1,200 mules had been safely evacuated from the landslide-affected area.

Repair work is being fast-

tracked on the route-damaged on Sunday by falling boulders, stones, and debris near the Chirbasa helipad, located approxi-

mately 2.5 kilometres above Gaurikund.

According to the police, labourers are working on a war footing to reopen the path, with safety measures overseen by personnel from the police, the Public Works Department (PWD), and the District Disaster Relief Force.

However, pilgrims intending to visit Kedarnath will have to wait, as they will only be allowed to proceed once the debris has been cleared from the route. Pilgrims travelling on foot to Kedarnath have been stranded at Sonprayag and Gaurikund since Sunday.

The police have appealed to the pilgrims to remain patient until the route is fully restored and to adhere to the guidelines issued by the police and the administration.

Six States sign MoU for ₹15,624 crore Kishau dam project

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ News Service

In a significant diplomatic and financial victory for Himachal Pradesh, a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was signed in the National Capital on Tuesday among six northern States to implement the long-pending ₹15,624 crore Kishau Multi-Purpose Project.

The deal, signed in the presence of Union Home Minister Amit Shah, effectively ends an eight-year deadlock over cost-sharing mechanisms for the 422 MW project on the Tons River, bordering Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh.

Under the newly agreed terms, Himachal Pradesh successfully shifted a financial burden of nearly ₹2,000 crore



Union Home Minister Amit Shah with Union Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil and Chief Ministers Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu (Himachal), Nayab Saini (Haryana), Pushkar Singh Dhimi (Uttarakhand), Yogi Adityanath (UP), Rekha Gupta (Delhi) and Bhajan Lal Sharma (Rajasthan) after the MoU signing PIONEER PHOTO

for its power component onto the primary water-beneficiary States — Delhi, Haryana, and Rajasthan. The MoU was signed by

Union Jal Shakti Minister CR Patil alongside Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Thakur Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu, Haryana Chief Minister Nayab

Singh Saini, Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhimi, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha

Gupta, and Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma. In a statement issued by the Chief Ministers' Office, Delhi will receive an addition-

al 109.9 million cubic metres (MCM) of water following the Kishau Multipurpose Project agreement. The Delhi Cabinet passed a resolution thanking Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Union Jal Shakti Minister CR Patil for finalising the long-pending water project.

"At the Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the project was described as a solution to an issue that had remained unresolved for years. The Cabinet also appreciated the cooperation extended by the central Government and the states involved in reaching the agreement," it said.

The Chief Minister said the Kishau project would provide significant support in meeting Delhi's drinking water

requirements while also helping improve the environmental flow of the Yamuna. She said water shortage remained one of Delhi's major challenges, and progress on the project would strengthen the capital's water security by making additional raw water available during periods of low availability.

The Chief Minister said the project's significance extended beyond the additional water allocated to Delhi, noting that it would also help improve the Yamuna's environmental flow, an important factor for the river's rejuvenation and conservation.

Addressing the media after the signing, Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhu highlighted that his Government took a firm stance during high-level negotiations, refus-

ing to accept the ₹800 crore State share that the previous regime had agreed to pay.

"The local population in our State will face displacement and bear the environmental impact of this project. It was entirely unfair to burden Himachal Pradesh financially when our contribution to the nation's energy and water security is paramount," Sukhu stated.

Furthermore, Himachal Pradesh is set to receive 1,000 million units of power annually once the project is operational, generating over ₹1,000 crore in annual revenue for the State exchequer. Senior state officials, including Chief Secretary KK Pant and Additional Chief Secretary RD Nazeem, accompanied the Chief Minister at the signing ceremony.

Bring UCC directly to Parliament: Omar challenges BJP

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Tuesday challenged the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party-led Government at the Centre to introduce the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) bill directly in Parliament rather than using a State-by-State "backdoor route".

Omar also reminded them that several National Democratic Alliance (NDA) allies were "opposed to the idea of the UCC".

Omar was commenting in response to Home Minister Amit Shah's statement to introduce UCC in all 21 BJP-NDA-ruled States before the 2029 Lok Sabha elections.

"If you have the numbers, bring it to Parliament. Why are you doing it separately in different States?" Abdullah said, arguing that the UCC could not be described as universal if it applied only to BJP-ruled States.

"The whole country is not BJP-ruled. There are several States and territories that the BJP does not govern," he said. Abdullah also pointed to dif-



ferences within the BJP-led National Democratic Alliance, saying some of its allies were not in favour of implementing the UCC in their States.

"According to reports, the Janata Dal (United) has directly said that it will not be implemented in Bihar. So if their own allies are not ready for it, how can they say that it should be implemented across the country?" he said. I don't think they will be able to pass this in the Parliament. That is why they are taking the (BJP-ruled States) path," he said. He said a measure of such significance should be decided by Parliament, which rep-

resents the country as a whole.

"Something of this nature should not be decided by individual states. It has to be decided by the country as a whole," Abdullah said. "The country as a whole is represented not in the states but in Parliament. Let the legislation come to Parliament."

Abdullah also questioned why the Government was pursuing the UCC through states while other major legislative proposals had been discussed in the context of Parliament. "So far, whenever they have talked about legislation in Parliament, whether it is One Nation, One Election or reservation, they have not brought it to Parliament," he said. "Now, with this too, they are talking about bringing it to the states. Bring it to Parliament and let us see whether you can pass it."

On reports of a reduction in Chinese deployments along the Line of Actual Control, Abdullah welcomed any move that could reduce tensions along the India-China frontier. "Anything that reduces tensions on the Line of Control or the

Line of Actual Control is a good step, particularly for those people who live close to it," he said.

Abdullah said residents living near the LoC and LAC were particularly affected by tensions and military deployments. "We know how difficult it is for people to live close to the LoC or LAC," he said. "So, if there is any step that reduces deployments along the Line of Actual Control, that is a good step." He said he hoped a similar improvement would eventually take place along the Line of Control.

"Similarly, we hope that, over time, things will get better along the Line of Control as well," he said.

The Chief Minister said the BRICS summit's condemnation of the Pahalgam terror attack was a success of India's foreign policy.

"The fact that Pahalgam itself was condemned (at BRICS summit) is a big thing. Please see how many allies of Pakistan were in that room. Therefore, for even Pahalgam to be mentioned by name, that in itself is a success of our foreign policy," he added.

BJP has no standing to question session length: J&K CM

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

Setting the stage for a political showdown on the floor of the assembly during the upcoming autumn session, scheduled to begin on September 21, Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Tuesday said the BJP has no locus standi to question the duration of the upcoming Assembly session, as the states ruled by the saffron party are known to have even shorter sessions.

Omar reacted strongly to Leader of Opposition Sunil Sharma's accusation that the Government kept the forthcoming Assembly session short as it was not serious about addressing people's issues.

"It is a seven-day session. What is non-serious about that? It would have been non-serious had we fol-



lowed the path shown by the BJP, which convenes one or two-day sessions in States ruled by it. These are people who do not even appear

before Parliament; you barely see them in Parliament," Abdullah told reporters on the sidelines of an official function in Srinagar.

"As for non-serious behaviour, we sit in the Assembly from morning until evening. Not a day goes by when we aren't present in the Assembly. Let others make whatever allegations they want, but the BJP has no standing to level such accusations.

The states ruled by it have even shorter Assembly sessions. "Let them look at Parliament and see who sits there for how long and then come and tell me who takes things seriously and who does not," the chief minister said. He also said BJP leaders put out statements every day, but he has no intention to respond to them on a daily basis.

Haryana Government to install 775 ANPR cameras in 4 NCR districts

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chandigarh

In a major push to curb vehicle emissions and bolster environmental compliance across the National Capital Region (NCR), the Haryana Transport Department will install 775 Automated Number Plate Recognition (ANPR) cameras across four key districts in its first phase.

Announcing the initiative on Tuesday, Haryana Transport Minister Anil Vij stated that the project, estimated to cost ₹1.74 crore, has received formal approval from Chief Minister Nayab



Anil Vij

Singh Saini. The state-of-the-art cameras will be set up primarily at petrol pumps in Gurugram, Faridabad, Sonapat, and Hajjar to identify End-of-Life Vehicles (ELVs).

Under the first phase, Gurugram will see the instal-

lation of 249 cameras, followed by 215 in Sonapat, 195 in Hajjar, and 116 in Faridabad. Though a total of 2,780 ANPR cameras are earmarked for deployment across Haryana, priority is being accorded to these four high-density NCR districts.

The move follows strict directives issued by the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM). Transport Minister Vijemphasised that the state is working on a tight schedule to complete the installation by September 30, 2026.

Starting October 1, 2026, fuel will be strictly denied to

Western Railway to boost security with 753 CCTVs ahead of Ujjain Simhashtha-2028

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Ujjain

The Western Railway's Ratlam division has prepared a comprehensive plan to strengthen security, surveillance, passenger amenities and train operations across the Ujjain rail region ahead of Simhashtha-2028, when the city is expected to witness a massive influx of pilgrims from across the country.

Official sources said, the Signal and Telecommunication Department has planned the installation of 753 CCTV



cameras at eight railway stations in the region. Of these, 217 cameras will be installed at Ujjain railway station alone.

The proposed surveillance network will include 194 4K fixed cameras, 133 pan-tilt-zoom (PTZ) cameras

and 426 full-HD cameras. These cameras will cover platforms, foot overbridges, station premises, entry and exit points, passenger holding areas and other key locations to improve real-time monitoring and crowd management.

A centralised control-cum-CCTV monitoring room will also be set up at Ujjain railway station. The facility will enable integrated surveillance of the station premises, while also supporting coordinated management of passenger information and public announcement systems.

Railway officials said the control room would help authorities and security agencies respond quickly to crowd-related situations and other operational requirements, particularly during peak movement of pilgrims.

The passenger and train information display system, along with the public announcement system, is also being strengthened to ensure that passengers receive timely updates regarding train arrivals, departures, platform changes and other important information.

Bihar Cabinet approves Vishnupad complex, river link



CM Samrat Choudhary

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Patna

The Bihar Government on Tuesday approved ₹3,516.05 crore for the Son-Falgu River Linking Project and to develop the Vishnupad Temple complex in Gayagi on the lines of the Kashi Vishwanath Corridor in Varanasi.

It also accorded approval to a memorandum of understanding (MoU) to be signed between the Civil Aviation Ministry, the Airports Authority of India (AAI), and the state Government to expand air connectivity in the state under the Centre's Modified UDAN Scheme.

According to the state tourism department's proposal that has been approved at the Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary, the estimated cost of the Vishnupad Temple complex development is ₹2,520 crore, while the Son-Falgu River Linking Project is likely to cost ₹996.05 crore.

Under the ₹2,520-crore Vishnupad Temple Complex development plan, the proposed works include development of the temple premises, construction and development of multilevel car parking, an elevated pathway, Manasarovar-Manpur Bridge, ramps, ghats, dormitory and canteen, pedestrian bridge, among others.

The project will be implemented by Bihar Rajya Path Vikas Nigam Ltd (BRPNL), said the tourism department's proposal.

Every year, a large number of Hindus visit the Vishnupad temple during the Pitri Paksha period to perform Pind Daan rituals.

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Chennai

The October 6 by-polls in Tamil Nadu will witness an interesting five-corner contest with the Left parties announcing their candidates for Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly constituencies on Tuesday.

The decision of CPI and CPI(M) has transformed the poll battle into a high-stakes keenly watched contest. They will lock horns with their erstwhile ally - the DMK - and ruling TVK dispensation, to whom the parties are extending external support. Interestingly, Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay led-Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam has named former legislators Maragatham Kumaravel and P



Sathyabama who defected from the AIADMK days after the Assembly election results were announced in May, and joined the TVK. What makes the battle for the ballot more interesting is the CPI and CPI (M) breaking ranks to contest independently against the TVK, DMK and AIADMK in two constituencies reserved for SC, to test their strength.

The CPI (M) and CPI announced they would contest as an independent Left front, breaking away from traditional electoral coalitions, placing them in direct opposition to both the DMK and TVK.

Both the Left parties have fielded a candidate each to the two seats. While the CPI(M) has named P Suganthi for the

Madurantakam (SC) seat, the CPI nominated Lakshmanan for Dharapuram (SC) constituency.

The presence of actor-politician Seeman's Naam Tamilar Katchi candidates K Janaki Raman in Madurantakam and M Karthika in Dharapuram, makes the contest a five-corner one.

Left leaders have stated that the decision to contest independently stems from a desire to demonstrate their electoral strength at the grassroots. They also cited strong reservations over the ruling TVK's choice of candidates especially two former AIADMK legislators who shifted loyalties to the TVK on the day they quit the Dravidian major. The DMK has nominated I Paranthaman

(Madurantakam) and S Suganya (Dharapuram) while the AIADMK heading the NDA has already announced an all-women lineup featuring former MLA Kanitha Sampath, who previously represented the constituency from 2011 to 2016, for Madurantakam, and K Bhanumathi for Dharapuram.

AIADMK leader Agri Krishnamurthy exuded confidence that his party would win the by-elections hands down, arguing that electoral victory was primarily due to the AIADMK party symbol, rather than personal popularity of the candidates.

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami held a meeting of party functionaries ahead of the upcoming by-elect-



Chief Minister Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma inaugurated the newly constructed academic building of Auniati University at Kaliapani in Jorhat PIONEER PHOTO

history of Assamese journalism through Asam Bilasini. He said Satradhikar Sri Sri Dattadeva Goswami established the Dharma Prakash Yantra and published Asam Bilasini in 1871. He described the establishment of a printing press and publication of a newspaper from Majuli during the nineteenth century as a landmark in Assam's journalistic history.

Referring to the vision of the present Satradhikar, Dr Pitambar Deva Goswami, the Chief Minister said Auniati University is an important outcome of his forward looking approach.

He expressed hope that the university would create an environment where modern education and India's civilisational values complement each other.

Dr Sarma said that Indian civilisation continues to shine despite the decline of many other civilisations because it has preserved its values and traditions.

He stressed that modernity and traditional values must move forward together for

the meaningful progress of society.

Satradhikar Dr Pitambar Deva Goswami, Union Minister of State for External Affairs Pabitra Margherita, Minister for Labour Welfare Department Rameswar Teli, MP Kamakhya Prasad Tasa, MLA Rupjyoti Kurmi, Vice Chancellor of Auniati University Prakash Jyoti Barthakur, faculty members, devotees, distinguished guests and students were present at the programme.

Later, the Chief Minister visited Dhekiakhowa Bornamghar and offered prayers. The Chief Minister said the Government would take steps to develop Dhekiakhowa Bornamghar as one of the State's prominent spiritual tourism destinations.

He also announced that necessary measures would be taken for its overall development and to address issues raised by the management committee, including installation of street lights along the approach road.

Editor's
TAKE

SEMICON 2026: India's semiconductor moment

India has made a promising start in semiconductors. Turning that momentum into a globally competitive chip industry will demand patience and precision

When Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurates SEMICON India 2026 on September 17, the fifth edition of this showcase will unfold as the country's most consequential semiconductor gathering yet - with more than 600 exhibitors, roughly 300 from abroad, six country pavilions, a dozen state pavilions and more than 150 speakers, all under the theme "Silicon to Systems". The scale reflects genuine momentum. Whether it reflects genuine readiness is a harder question. The stakes explain the urgency. India's chip consumption, still overwhelmingly met through imports from Taiwan, South Korea, China and the United States, is projected to more than double to around \$155 billion by 2031.

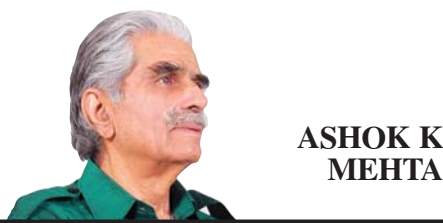
Every smartphone, EV battery system and data-centre server sold in India carries an invisible import bill. Beyond economics, chips sit at the centre of strategic autonomy, defence electronics and a global supply chain actively seeking alternatives to concentration in East Asia, with hundreds of thousands of promised manufacturing jobs riding on the outcome – an opening India cannot afford to squander.

On the credit side, the ledger is genuinely encouraging. The India Semiconductor Mission, backed by \$10 billion since 2021 and expanded through a ₹1.27-lakh-crore ISM 2.0 approved this July, has moved from announcement to execution. A dozen-odd projects worth roughly ₹1.6 lakh crore are underway across seven states; Micron's Sanand packaging plant is already shipping commercial output; and a design ecosystem – hundreds of universities, thousands of trained engineers and dozens of funded start-ups – gives India a genuine head start that most aspiring chip nations lack.

But the structural bottlenecks are real. India still imports over 90 per cent of the equipment and 85-90 per cent of the specialty chemicals and gases that fabs consume. Execution risk is real too: Tata Electronics' flagship Dholera fab, once promised at the 28-nanometre node by December 2026, will now open at a far more mature 90-nanometre process in mid-2028. And talent remains the tightest constraint of all - barely 1 per cent of India's 600,000 annual engineering graduates are fab-ready. None of this makes the dream fanciful; it makes the timeline dishonest when oversold.

Taiwan and South Korea took three decades each to reach the frontier - India's compressed ambitions should learn from that patience, not resent it. Assembly, testing and mature-node manufacturing by 2028 is realistic; leading-edge fabrication remains a 15-year industrial project. What India needs now is infrastructure: sustained, patient capital for the equipment-and-materials layer that ISM 2.0 has only begun funding; a vocational pipeline, distinct from the design courses that already thrive; and anchor demand from government procurement in defence, railways and telecoms to de-risk early output.

SEMICON India 2026 should mark the moment the country stops selling the dream and starts building its unglamorous foundations, layer by layer.



ASHOK K MEHTA

Nepal was recently afflicted by tragic and catastrophic climate events: the 2015 earthquake, the 2023 jajarkot earthquake, and now the glacial outbursts triggering the Rasuwa flash floods. A man-made disaster obliterated Kathmandu's iconic buildings and institutions during the 72-hour Gen Z movement in September 2025. The Rasuwa/Trishuli tragedy of 26 August did not prevent NDTV from holding its conclave the next day, along with prominent Nepali business sponsors such as MAW Enterprises, Fone Pay, Panchkanya, Padma Jyoti and Goldstar - the Maoist-branded footwear of the ten-year civil war - owned by Vidushi Rana, a nominated MP of the ruling Rashtriya Swatantra Party government. She portrayed the business face of Nepal through Goldstar, sharing star billing with three of the RSP's top politicians: President Rabi Lamichhane, Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle and Foreign Minister Shishir Khanel.

How could they be persuaded to attend is a separate story. Never short of words, Shashi Tharoor led the Indian side in an exchange of ideas on India-Nepal relations, sans any real specialists on India and Nepal. As one Nepali filmmaker put it: "The conclave was to facilitate entry into the Nepali market of the owners of NDTV, the Adanis." The human tragedy was ignored.

This social-calendar event robbed the devastating floods of focus, as did the fallout from Indian COAS General Dhiraj Seth's first visit abroad to Nepal the previous week, at a time when Nepal's ex-servicemen (ESM) had launched their first-ever campaign to finally accept Agniveer on Indian terms - limited years of engagement and retention. This landmark about-turn by the ESM was precipitated by the employment drought in the country but went unnoticed in Delhi. It is necessary to recall the events preceding Seth's visit and the actions planned by the ESM to force their campaign to a successful outcome.

On August 15, for the first time ever, ESM and their families gathered outside Pokhara's Rangshala Stadium, sang the Indian national anthem, unfurled the Tricolour and then marched to the Chief District Officer's office, where they submitted a petition urging the Government of Nepal to accept the Agniveer recruitment package as it is. This was preceded by similar campaigns by ESM in Lamjung and Kathmandu. Previous campaigns had been critical of the new recruitment scheme and had sought the restoration of the old terms of recruitment, including pensionary benefits. So, when Seth arrived in Kathmandu to be anointed Honorary General of the Nepal Army -



THE EX-SERVICEMEN ARE LIKELY TO REVIVE THEIR CAMPAIGN SOON, THOUGH THE TRAGIC AFTERMATH OF THE FLASH FLOODS WILL CONTINUE TO HAUNT NEPAL. DUSSEHRA AND TIHAR SOON TO FOLLOW WILL OCCUPY THEIR MINDS AND TIME. INDIA'S BRILLIANT PACKAGE OF RESCUE AND RELIEF HAS IMPRESSED THE NEPALESE, AS IT DID DURING THE 2015 EARTHQUAKE

The writer, a retired Major General, served as Commander, IPKF (South), Sri Lanka, and was a founder member of the Defence Planning Staff, now the Integrated Defence Staff

an honour not even exchanged with Britain (and the British Army), the founding fathers of the 300-year-old Gorkha legacy - the ground was set for him to break the long impasse over recruitment through military diplomacy. But, ironically, this was beyond his remit, his pay grade. Why? Because the Foreign Office will not let generals tread on its territory. Or is it because Agniveer is PM Modi's personal idea and a political matter? Either way, an opportunity was apparently missed by the Army Chief to open the door for a conversation leading to recruitment.

Seth not only met his counterpart, General Ashok Sigdel, but also President Ram Chandra Paudel and Prime Minister Balen Shah, who doubles as Defence Minister. This was when the iron was hot. But Seth was again constrained by his brief and probably by the presence of Indian Ambassador Naveen Shrivastava, who was accompanying him. But unlikely.

Later, during the ESM's massive rally at the Pokhara Indian Pension Camp, which is towered over by the Machapuchare massif, hundreds upon thousands of ESM and their families had gathered to welcome Indian Army Chief General Seth. Being from the Armoured Corps, Seth had probably only read about Gorkha fervour, even in its ESM avatar. Today, he was face-to-face with its awe and aura.

In a ten-minute speech, he said the usual glorious things about India-Nepal relations while remotely inaugurating the Kolhapur polyclinic. India has set up an elaborate network of welfare schemes inside Nepal. A former Indian Gorkha officer present noted that Seth was overwhelmed by the sentiment and affection expressed for India and the Indian Army by ESM. Seth realised that the Gorkha ESM was a strategic asset in a country where anti-India sentiment can spark and spread like wildfire. One classic video of an ex-serviceman telling Seth, "We're ready to join the Indian Army", meaning Agniveer, went viral. It is now known that Seth

did not raise the Agniveer issue with anyone, sticking to his military brief. NDTV's erudite team of anchors did not either, though India-Nepal relations was the theme of the dialogue. They quizzed three top Nepali politicians but did not consider the five-year breach in Gorkha recruitment an issue of concern. Meanwhile, Tharoor was busy excavating the German word 'schadenfreude' with Wagle. Later, he called the flash floods "Nepal drama is continuing", for which he subsequently apologised. A huge backlash followed on social media and will be remembered as anti-Nepal sentiment, thanks to Kathmandu's selective memory. NDTV's failure to raise the strategic fracture in bilateral relations was a missed opportunity. Or was it warped priority?

The ex-servicemen are likely to revive their campaign soon, though the tragic aftermath of the flash floods will continue to haunt Nepal. Dussehra and Tihar soon to follow will occupy their minds and time. India's brilliant package of rescue and relief has impressed the Nepalese, as it did during the 2015 earthquake. Praise for India was resonant everywhere.

The momentum of the 'Accept Agniveer Campaign' launched by ESM recently should not be lost, even though the present Agniveer terms of engagement are iron-clad and unlikely to change despite the chatter. As the ex-servicemen are now prepared to accept it, a conversation needs to start at the diplomatic or political level. A two-thirds-majority government in Nepal has its ego and is unlikely to break the ice; India has a national interest. A key strategic issue has been reduced to 'who will bell the cat'.

In 1959, when I first trekked in Nepal, recruitment to become a soldier was the single biggest craze among the youth. The song that ran across Nepal was: "Chiso pani chara le piye na; Bharti hunu Lalumaya nidhara le diye na" (paraphrased: I went to get recruited, but fate did not allow it). "Daju" (big brother) should help.

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

The Throat That Held the Poison

When the gods and demons churned the cosmic ocean in search of the nectar of immortality, the first thing to emerge was not treasure, but a deadly poison called Halahala, potent enough to destroy all creation.

Terrified, the gods turned to Shiva for help. Without hesitation, he drank the poison himself, but Parvati, sensing the danger, pressed his throat to stop it from descending into his body, leaving it lodged in his throat, which turned blue, earning him the name Neelakantha, the blue-throated one.

Shiva absorbed what would have destroyed the world, and neither discarded it in anger nor let it consume him. He simply held it, transformed by the act, but not destroyed by it.

We often encounter negativity, criticism, conflict, other people's pain, and either pass it forward through anger, or let it poison us internally. Shiva's example offers a third way, absorbing what is difficult without letting it define or destroy us.

Today, when you encounter something toxic, a harsh word, a difficult situation, practice holding it with steadiness, neither passing it on nor letting it consume your peace.

-DAIV



AJIT KUMAR BISHNOI

2ND OPINION

I am determined not to be defeated, feel resigned or fall sick, physically or otherwise. When I learn about people known to me who are suffering helplessly in old age, and not even in old age, I feel saddened. But soon the gloom lifts as I seek guidance and help from my Lord. In this article, I will share my personal experiences as I fight negative feelings, which rear their ugly heads not so infrequently.

The first thing I do when I wake up – yes, at 5 am – is freshen up and pray to my Lord. I have been writing about the large photograph of Lord Krishna in my room; there are eight other photographs of different manifestations of God. Lord Krishna has spoken about this in the Bhagavad Gita, in verse 9.15: "I have faces in all directions, in one form or in many different ways." These are of Lord

We don't have to be so helpless



Ramachandra, Lord Shiva, Lord Narayana, Ma Durga, Lord Narasimha, my Laddu Gopal, Bal Gopal and my beloved Hanumanji.

Just as there are many manifestations of God, there are many prayers too. Some of them are: please give me pure devotion, 'atmabala' (inner strength), freedom from depression, protection, peace and happiness, good sense and sustenance, of course. I am not ashamed to admit that I am very small, but I don't have to be so helpless. I am like a toddler for whom his mother is everything; my Lord is everything to me (7.19). He takes care of me.

And He is available to me 24x7, in not one but nine different forms. There is no loneliness for me. I feel like I am living in a temple – a Sanatana Dharma Mandir in my bedroom. And there is a very responsive God who gives guidance and help in all matters. Isn't God omniscient and omnipotent? Why succumb to negative feelings when you are armed with the 'Narayan Kavach' (the armour provided by God)?

There are solutions to every problem I face. But let me warn readers that these solutions include tough realisations. What has Lord Krishna said about getting nectar in verse 18.37? You have to undergo austerities, which are like poison. I must walk after every meal for five minutes, yes, in my room only. I don't need muscles; I need good health. I need to eat foods that agree with me; they have begun to taste good. I must be useful at all times - that is, I must do what human beings are supposed to do, which is 'seva' (service).

The rewards are many. My Lord has become the 'karta' (doer) in my life; inevitably, 100 per cent success is assured. I just have to focus on my part, which is to remain in the shelter of my Lord and perform all the duties assigned to me as His 'nimitta' (instrument). And, in order not to forget all these things, I have sticky notes everywhere reminding me about what I must do or must not do. Life is blissful (*theek chal rahi hai*).

The writer is a spiritual teacher and columnist

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Time to reform health insurance

The Karnataka High Court's recent ruling directing National Insurance Company Ltd. to reimburse a retired bank officer for cancer treatment injections is a significant victory for policyholders. More importantly, it highlights the rigid and often outdated operational practices of India's health insurance sector.

Medical science has advanced rapidly, and many breakthrough procedures and life-saving treatments no longer require prolonged hospitalisation. Yet insurance providers often rely on literal, outdated interpretations of policy terms to deny claims for day-care treatments. The case is particularly significant because it highlights the hurdles ordinary citizens, especially senior citizens and retirees living on fixed incomes, face when dealing with insurance companies. For a 72-year-old cancer survivor to fight a legal battle through a Permanent Lok Adalat and eventually the High Court merely to secure legitimate reimbursement points to a serious systemic problem.

IRDAI must modernise health insurance guidelines, focusing on medical necessity rather than rigid inpatient-outpatient classifications. Until policies reflect modern medicine, their purpose will remain compromised.

RANGANATHAN SIVAKUMAR | TAMIL NADU

Food menu should not be political

Serving an all-vegetarian spread at a gala dinner hosted for BRICS leaders and delegates has erupted into a political slugfest between the Congress and the BJP. While Rahul Gandhi said that 80 per cent of Indians are non-vegetarians and that Indian food is delicious, Union Minister Kiren Rijiju hit back at the Congress for making politics even out of the food menu. The Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha made the comment a day after an all-vegetarian spread was served at a BRICS Summit gala dinner hosted by the Government. Is this really an important matter to debate? Non-vegetarians can consume vegetarian food, but vegetarians cannot consume non-vegetarian food. It was not a food festival. Vegetarian food is an integral part of Indian cuisine and is considered healthy by many.

There seems to be nothing wrong with the Government serving a vegetarian menu. The Leader of the Opposition has more important issues to raise, including the success of the BRICS Summit and its outcomes.

It has become habitual for Rahul Gandhi to criticise Modi over almost every decision. Such comments only belittle him. There are many pressing issues that deserve attention in a healthy democracy. He should focus more on people's problems than on matters of little consequence.

N R RAMACHANDRAN | CHENNAI

Hindi debate has a long history

Eight women legislators from Kerala's UDF, led by Minister Bindu Krishna, reportedly staged a walkout from the recent "She is a Change Maker" workshop on gender-responsive governance, hosted by the National Commission for Women in Faridabad.

The protest was reportedly prompted by the exclusive use of Hindi during the sessions, the lack of translation facilities and content they considered elementary. Additionally, some legislators from northern states reportedly shouted that Hindi was the national language and that discussions would be held only in Hindi. Such high-handed actions can only foster anti-Hindi sentiment in the South.

The relegation of English to the status of a foreign language and the insistence on studying two native languages under the three-language formula are also perceived by some as a covert attempt to impose Hindi. The Hindi debate is not new. In 1949, Hindi nationalists sought national-language status for Hindi, while non-Hindi representatives opposed its imposition. Hindi was ultimately made the Union's official language alongside English. Today, resentment over English's prominence may persist in the Hindi heartland.

HARIDASAN RAJAN | KERALAM

PICTALK



Tourists take photographs at Jonha Waterfalls, in Ranchi district, Jharkhand

PHOTO: PTI

China after Mao at 50: From revolutionary fire to global power

Fifty years after Mao Zedong's death, China has travelled from revolutionary upheaval to economic and technological power. Its transformation under Deng Xiaoping and beyond has reshaped Asia - and for India, the unresolved border dispute and China's growing regional influence make understanding that journey strategically imperative



SANTHOSH MATHEW

Fifty years after Mao Zedong's death, China stands as one of the most consequential powers of the twenty-first century. The country that once mobilised millions through revolutionary slogans, mass campaigns and ideological

struggle has become a manufacturing giant, a technological competitor and a major force in global geopolitics. The journey from Mao's China to today's China is one of the most remarkable transformations in modern history. It is also a story that carries profound consequences for India.

Mao died on September 9, 1976, leaving behind a country that had experienced both revolutionary triumph and devastating upheaval. His Long March, which began in 1934, had become a foundational legend of the Chinese Communist Party. The arduous retreat of the Red Army across thousands of kilometres helped establish Mao's leadership and became a symbol of revolutionary perseverance. In 1949, Mao proclaimed the establishment of the People's Republic of China from Tiananmen, presenting the communist revolution as the beginning of a new national era. For millions of Chinese, he was the leader who ended the humiliation of foreign domination and unified a fractured nation.

The subsequent decades revealed the enormous costs of revolutionary experimentation. Mao's Great Leap Forward (GLF), launched in 1958, attempted to transform China rapidly from an agrarian society into an industrial power. Communes, collective farming and ambitious production targets were imposed across the country. The campaign produced economic dislocation and contributed to a catastrophic famine in which millions of people died. The state's political structure and the suppression of criticism made it difficult to correct failures in time. The lesson was severe: revolutionary enthusiasm could not substitute for sound economic policy, agricultural productivity and institutional accountability.

The Cultural Revolution, launched in 1966, deepened the turmoil. Mao sought to eliminate alleged bourgeois and counter-revolutionary influences within the Party and society. Students organised as Red Guards, intellectuals were persecuted, institutions were disrupted and political struggles spread throughout the country. The campaign devastated education, culture and administrative stability. Mao's final years were marked by declining health and an intense struggle for succession. After his death, the Gang of Four, led by Jiang Qing along with Zhang Chunqiao, Yao Wenyuan and Wang Hongwen, was arrested in October 1976. Their downfall symbolised the end of the most turbulent phase of Maoist politics.

The decisive change came with Deng Xiaoping and the reform process initiated after 1978. Deng did not reject the Communist Party's political monopoly, but he substantially altered the economic direction of the country. Agricultural reforms, special economic zones, foreign investment, export-led manufacturing and market-oriented policies gradually transformed China. His famous approach - often summarised through the idea that it does not matter whether a cat is black or white as long as it catches mice - captured a pragmatic departure from rigidly ideological economics. China's rise was built not merely on revolutionary memory, but on industrialisation, infrastructure, education, technological development and integration with global markets.

Mao's foreign-policy ideas also remain relevant to understanding China's strategic outlook. His Three Worlds Theory, articulated in the 1970s, divided the international system into the superpowers, the developed countries outside the superpower rivalry, and the developing countries of Asia, Africa and Latin America. China presented itself as part of the developing world and sought solidarity with countries resisting imperialism and hegemonic domination. The theory helped Beijing cultivate ties across the Global South. Contemporary China uses different language, including the Global Development Initiative and South-South cooperation, though the underlying ambition to expand influence among developing countries remains significant.



FOR INDIA, UNDERSTANDING POST-MAO CHINA REQUIRES LOOKING BEYOND SLOGANS AND PERSONALITIES TO THE DEEPER FORCES OF HISTORY, GEOGRAPHY, ECONOMICS AND POWER. THE LONG MARCH EXPLAINS THE ORIGINS OF THE REVOLUTION AND THE GREAT LEAP FORWARD AND CULTURAL REVOLUTION REVEAL ITS HUMAN COSTS

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Another concept associated with Mao's strategic thinking is the Five Finger Theory concerning Tibet. The metaphor described Tibet as the palm of China's hand, with Ladakh, Nepal, Sikkim, Bhutan and the North-East Frontier Agency - now Arunachal Pradesh — portrayed as the five fingers. The precise wording and attribution of this formulation are debated among historians, and it should not be treated as a formal treaty or an unchanging official doctrine. The idea is nevertheless frequently invoked in discussions of China's strategic interest in the Himalayan region. It reflects the importance Beijing has attached to Tibet, borderlands and the surrounding mountain states.

For India, the post-Mao transformation of China has been inseparable from the difficult history of bilateral relations. The early years of the People's Republic generated hopes of Asian solidarity. The slogan "Hindi-Chini Bhai-Bhai" represented the aspiration for cooperation between two ancient civilisations emerging from colonialism. The 1954 Panchsheel Agreement emphasised peaceful coexistence and mutual respect. The optimism collapsed in the 1962 Sino-Indian War, which left a deep strategic and psychological imprint on India. The unresolved boundary question, particularly in the western sector and along the eastern frontier, continues to shape bilateral relations.

China's post-1978 rise altered the balance of power in Asia. Its economic expansion, military modernisation, maritime presence and infrastructure partnerships have increased its influence across South Asia and the Indian Ocean. Projects associated with the Belt and Road Initiative, including the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor, have generated concerns in New Delhi over sovereignty, strategic encirclement and connectivity through contested territories. China's growing relationship with Pakistan and its positions on Jammu and Kashmir add further complexity.

At the same time, India and China remain major trading partners and important participants in multilateral forums such as BRICS, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the G20. Cooperation is possible in climate negotiations, global development, trade and the reform of international institutions. The challenge is to prevent economic interdependence from being overwhelmed by military confrontation and strategic mistrust. The border crisis of 2020 demonstrated how quickly tensions can damage the wider relationship.

Fifty years after Mao, China is no longer simply the revolutionary state he imagined. It is a powerful, technologically ambitious and globally connected nation governed by a Party that continues to invoke his legacy while pursuing policies shaped by pragmatism and national rejuvenation. For India, understanding post-Mao China requires looking beyond slogans and personalities to the deeper forces of history, geography, economics and power. The Long March explains the origins of the revolution; the Great Leap Forward and Cultural Revolution reveal its human costs; Deng's reforms explain the economic transformation; and the continuing border question reminds India that China's revolutionary past remains closely connected to its strategic present.

Satya Niketan: The price of institutional apathy



VK BAHUGUNA

The tragic collapse of a five-storey paying guest (PG) accommodation in Delhi's Satya Niketan - claiming the lives of seven young students and injuring several others — was not an act of God. It reflects institutional manslaughter and is deeply shameful for a country that promises to become a developed nation by 2047.

For hours, as rescue teams pulled crushed bodies and screaming survivors from beneath pulverised concrete, the true culprit remained undisturbed in comfortable municipal offices. This tragedy was not caused merely by ageing brickwork or unseasonal rainfall; it was caused by systemic decay, unchecked corruption and the criminal negligence of civic authorities entrusted with public safety. This writer knows of a well-known case relating to the Prime Minister's UDAY Yojana, under which unauthorised colonies were supposed to be regularised by the DDA. The Assistant Director concerned in East Delhi was allegedly demanding a heavy bribe through his agents to complete the conveyance deed. It was only when this writer approached senior officials on behalf of a helpless victim that the work was completed. The officer concerned was later arrested and suspended. However, the larger question remains: how are civic bodies allowing such lawlessness in the capital city of the country? Satya Niketan, situated adjacent to Delhi University's South Campus, has evolved from a quiet residential neighbourhood into a dense and largely unregulated commercial hub. Driven by an acute shortage of official university accommodation, tens of thousands of young students from outside Delhi are pushed into the hands of a lucrative private PG market. To maximise profits, property owners routinely violate master plans by digging unauthorised basements, removing load-bearing walls and adding illegal upper floors to decades-old foundations designed only for modest family dwellings.

What makes the tragedy unforgivable is its predictability. Satya Niketan has witnessed similar disasters, yet dangerous structures continue to operate despite notices and warnings. Illegal modifications, alleged bribery and inadequate safety measures have become routine, leaving shops and crowded PGs without proper fire safety, structural certificates or emergency exits.

This is happening routinely across Delhi in all kinds of buildings and hotels, endangering the lives of unsuspecting people and reflecting a total collapse of urban governance. The regulatory framework meant to govern private housing in academic hubs has been deliberately ignored because the institutions responsible for oversight have been hollowed out by corruption.

Every administrative body involved operates in silos, passing the buck while illegal construction thrives under their noses. When disaster strikes, junior officials are suspended, a magisterial inquiry is ordered to quell public anger, a few low-level contractors or property owners are arrested, and financial ex gratia is announced to compensate for the loss of human life. Within weeks, the outrage subsides, suspended officials are quietly reinstated, and business as usual resumes over fresh graves. This is the situation across much of India. Such incidents must be treated as structural crimes.

To prevent urban centres from turning into death traps, the Government must immediately implement drastic structural reforms.

First, criminal liability must be fixed for municipal officers. Public accountability laws should be amended so that jurisdictional engineers, inspectors and sanctioning authorities can be held accountable in cases where illegal or unsafe structures collapse due to proven negligence. These officials must face serious legal consequences alongside predatory landlords; only then will enforcement become a reality.

Second, mandatory independent structural audits should be undertaken by qualified structural engineers from reputed technical institutions rather than relying solely on local municipal officials. All commercial PG accommodations and multi-storey facilities operating in high-density educational corridors should be covered.

Any building lacking a digitally verifiable structural fitness certificate should be sealed immediately.

Third, the Government, in tandem with universities, must enact a strict statutory framework for private student accommodation, imposing hard caps on occupancy, mandatory fire exits, structural load limits and the public display of safety clearances outside every premises. Universities cannot remain passive bystanders to a housing crisis that exploits their students.

Authorities must also mandate fast-tracked public-private hostel construction within academic zones to reduce the dangerous dependence on unregulated PG operators. The Ministry of Education should evolve a scheme for this purpose and provide funding and low-interest loans to eligible private agencies.

Student housing also needs effective regulation. Turning Delhi University's residential corridors from dangerous profit centres into accountable student housing requires a coordinated strategy. The university should establish a housing portal to empanel private accommodation providers and allow students to use only approved PGs. Students should be discouraged from taking accommodation in unlisted premises.

Fourth, all records relating to building sanctions, notices, demolition orders and structural safety reports must be digitised and published on a publicly accessible digital map.

Fifth, the Government should enact a Paying Guest Accommodation Regulation and Safety Act, requiring all accommodation providers housing more than four or five students to obtain a formal PG operating licence.

Operating an unapproved PG or violating safety norms should attract heavy financial penalties and criminal liability. Illegal additions to buildings should be sealed forthwith, with water and electricity connections disconnected where legally permissible.

The mandarins occupying positions of authority must remember that the seven young lives lost in Satya Niketan were not victims of bad luck or poor weather; they were victims of an administrative ecosystem that, where corruption and negligence are proven, can place illicit monetary gain above human safety.

If the State continues to respond to structural deaths with temporary committee reports and performative notices, it risks remaining complicit in the next tragedy waiting to happen. The time for bureaucratic compromise is over. Only uncompromising accountability and a drastic regulatory overhaul can restore public faith in urban governance.



The writer is a former IFS officer and Chairman of the Centre for Resource Management

National conference MP's revolt: Will It engulf the Abdullahs?



ANIL ANAND

A new political storm is brewing in the Valley. It is nothing new, as ever since the democratic system came into place seven decades ago, Kashmiris have been accustomed to such developments — sometimes locally created, but most of the time Delhi-engineered. National Conference's young MP, Aga Syed Ruhullah Mehdi, representing the Srinagar Lok Sabha constituency, has revolted against his own party leadership on "ideological grounds", threatening to open a new and sleazy political chapter. As it is, unease has been prevailing in Jammu and Kashmir after the first elections to the demoted Union Territory's Assembly two years ago. No, the outcome of the polls did not bring any instability, as the Farooq Abdullah-led National Conference secured a majority, which it consolidated with the help of the Congress, CPI(M) and other smaller parties. This was despite the BJP's inability to form a government in the Muslim-dominated UT, even after pursuing a full-scale strategy, including the delimitation process, to create tailor-made constituencies and deliver a deft political message.

The young and dynamic Mehdi struck earlier than expected. It must have taken the National Conference patriarch, Farooq Abdullah, by surprise, though he has been accustomed to facing such

political storms, the biggest being the toppling of his majority government in July 1984 by none other than his own brother-in-law, G M Shah.

However, the two situations are incomparable. This is primarily due to a diametrical shift in New Delhi's political contours, with an unprecedented approach by the Central Government under Prime Minister Narendra Modi to not rest until a political goal is achieved — electorally or manipulatively. This is not to suggest that Jammu and Kashmir had been bereft of political machinations before that. The 1984 developments had their roots in a feud within the extended family of Sher-e-Kashmir Sheikh Abdullah over the selection of his heir apparent. Although, in true dynastic terms and giving little regard to democratic values, Farooq Abdullah was the natural choice to step into his illustrious father's shoes, the late Sheikh's old-time associate and close confidant, Mirza Afzal Beg, and his son-in-law, G M Shah, perhaps rightfully expected to be anointed Chief Ministers at different stages. The natural choice, however, fell on Farooq Abdullah.

The context in which young Mehdi has raised a banner of revolt so early in his political life, and immediately after becoming an MP, is entirely different from the Beg-Shah shenanigans. Although the purpose seems similar, Mehdi appears to be frantically searching for an opening to lay claim to a position as a future leader of Kashmir.

Perhaps he knows full well that with the not-so-old Chief Minister Omar Abdullah in the driving seat, he will have to play second fiddle and will have little chance of emerging as a leader in his own



right. More so, the Chief Minister has already started politically grooming his two sons with an eye on the future. Mehdi must have his reasons for taking on his party leadership, but it is hardly the best time, with an aggressive BJP at the Centre eyeing a greater role in the Kashmir Valley. The biggest stumbling block remains the National Conference and its leader, Farooq Abdullah. Though he once had no qualms about shaking hands with the BJP, he now keeps his distance given its hardline Hindutva agenda. How could he ignore the outcome of Mufti Mohammad Sayeed's alliance with the Narendra Modi-Amit Shah dispensation, which led to the PDP's political rout in the Kashmir Valley?

It will be interesting to see how, against this backdrop, Mehdi plans to move forward. It is now a foregone conclusion that he will resign from the Lok Sabha and the National Conference, as he has fixed November 3 — the death anniversary of his father — as the D-day for taking this step, which could have far-reaching consequences both for his

political future and for the National Conference.

He is a young and energetic leader of the Shia community in Srinagar, Budgam and adjoining areas. Although he has publicly shunned talking about his community lineage whenever asked by the media, it seems he has been doing so in order to widen his reach beyond his own community. That is certainly desirable for new-generation leaders: that they rise above the narrow confines of caste, community and religion. But it is a tough act to perform even in the spectrum of 21st-century Indian politics. All eyes, particularly those of the National Conference leadership and the people at large, will be focused on November 3, 2026, when he plans to hold a big public rally to announce his arrival on the political horizon of Kashmir with a new outlook. Will he float a new political party, or what will be his charter for treading a new but murky political path in Kashmir, which has seen many political experiments unfold but very few succeed?

Even Shah, with his image as a good administrator and a no-nonsense person, could survive for only a little over two years, with the same Central Government — the Congress regime — which had installed him as Chief Minister eventually pulling the rug from beneath his feet. How differently will Mehdi emerge in order to erase his National Conference past and create a political niche for himself? This is an important question. Even more important will be whether he pursues a course independent of New Delhi, overtly or covertly, and what will be his *mool-mantra* for survival.

He has differed with the National Conference's

top leadership for reneging on its election manifesto promise to fight for the complete restoration of Article 370, which was diluted following the constitutional changes made on August 5, 2019.

He has argued that, by demanding only the restoration of statehood, the Farooq-Omar duo is "deceiving" the people. Somewhere, he has implicitly accused the duo of going soft on the Centre. His political grandstanding may be driven by an eye on his own political future beyond the shadow of the Abdullahs. He seems genuine in demanding that Chief Minister Omar Abdullah should have directly confronted Prime Minister Modi on the Article 370 issue. This is not to suggest that the Chief Minister has done everything right during his two years in office. The National Conference as an organisation also seems to have become inactive and resigned to its fate. It will be of greater interest to see how big a split Mehdi will be able to cause in the National Conference, which has in the past withstood many a political storm of the same sort. Will the octogenarian Dr Farooq Abdullah, in the twilight of his political innings, be able to overcome this situation as he has done in the past? This will be significant because Mehdi's prime target appears to be Omar Abdullah, thereby setting a clear line of battle. Even if he is unable to cause a significant split in the party, the question arises: will he be able to trigger an ideological schism within the National Conference, which has, to date, survived largely under the protection and patronage of the Abdullahs?

The writer is a political analyst



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Odisha govt rejects Dara’s plea for release from jail

The Odisha government has rejected a plea of Hindutva activist Dara Singh for premature release from prison in the murder of Australian missionary Graham Staines and his two minor sons in Keonjhar in 1999, officials said on Tuesday. Singh, who is serving life imprisonment, had made appeal for his premature release from prison as he had already spent 25 years in jail.

The Supreme Court, which is hearing his plea, had asked the Odisha government to take a decision in this regard.

The Odisha government took the decision at a special meeting of the State Sentence Review Board on August 31, the officials said. The meeting resolved that “in view of certain facts and circumstances, the Board is therefore not inclined to recommend his premature release at this stage”, they added.

Sixty-seven-year-old Singh is currently serving life imprisonment for burning to death Staines (then 58) and his two minor sons -- Philip and Timothy -- when they were sleeping in a station wagon in Keonjhar district in January 1999. He was sentenced to capital punishment by the District and Sessions Judge Court in Bhubaneswar, but later his punishment was converted to a life sentence. Recently, the Supreme Court, while hearing Singh’s petition for release from prison, had asked the Odisha government to take a decision on the matter. The next date of hearing in Supreme on the matter is September 17. (PTI)



Ensure compliance on fitting speed governors in transport vehicles: SC



The Supreme Court on Tuesday asked the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) to ensure due compliance with the rule which mandates the fitting of speed governors in transport vehicles. A bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and K V Viswanathan referred to Rule 118 of the Central Motor Vehicles Rules (CMVR), 1989, which provides for speed governors in notified transport vehicles.

The top court, which is dealing with a matter seeking enforcement of road safety norms, said on May 13 that all manufacturers were duty-bound to fit a speed limiting device (SLD) at the time of manufacture.

It had then asked the Centre to have a meeting with the manufacturers on the issue of fitting SLDs at the time of manufacturing or delivery of transport vehicles.

During the hearing on Tuesday, the bench was informed that the Centre has filed an affidavit stating that a meeting was convened in June in this regard.

“In so far as speed governors are concerned, we are of the view that the Rules, more particularly Rule 118 of the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989, itself mandates fitment of SLD/SLF (speed limiting function) in notified transport vehicles...,” the bench said. “We impress upon the MoRTH to ensure due compliance of Rule 118 referred to above...,” it said. The top court observed that what is important for the Centre as well as the states and Union Territories is to see that when a transport vehicle is sold by a dealer, there has to be some mechanism to ensure that the same is fitted with SLD or SLF. The bench also directed the MoRTH to place on record the report of its interaction with vehicle manufacturers regarding pre-fitting of vehicle location tracking device in public service vehicles.

It also asked all states and Union Territories to file a compliance status report with regard to enforcement of Rule 125H of the CMVR, 1989. Rule 125H requires public service vehicles to have vehicle location tracking device and emergency button. While hearing matter on May 13, the SC termed it “disturbing” that less than one per cent of transport vehicles have vehicle location tracking device. (PTI)

Compelling rape survivor to continue pregnancy impairs right to live with dignity: HC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Ranchi

Compelling a rape survivor to continue with a pregnancy resulting from the crime and fastening the responsibility of motherhood on her against her will would amount to a serious impairment of her right to live with dignity, the Delhi High Court has held.

The court made the observations while allowing a plea on behalf of a 15-year-old rape survivor seeking the termination of her pregnancy, which had exceeded 30 weeks of gestation.

Under Section 3 of the Medical Termination of Pregnancy (MTP) Act, termination of pregnancy beyond 20 weeks and up to 24 weeks is permissible in respect of specified categories of women, subject to the statu-

tory requirements. Terming it an unfortunate and distressing case, Justice Madhu Jain said the fact that the pregnancy had crossed the statutory limit, by itself, could not be viewed in isolation.

“In cases arising out of sexual assault, compelling a survivor to continue with a pregnancy resulting from the assault and thereby fastening upon her the responsibility of motherhood against her will would amount to a serious impairment of her right to live with dignity,” the court said in its September 8 order.

It said that a woman’s right in relation to her body necessarily included the right to decide whether or not she wished to become a mother.

To compel a survivor of sexual assault to carry and deliver a child conceived as a



SC questions pendency before PMLA adjudicating authority

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday sought the details from the Enforcement Directorate on several cases pending before its adjudicating authority with regard to confiscation of assets under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act.

Observing that there has to be application of mind in the adjudication process, a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana questioned the pendency of a large number of cases before the adjudicating authority.

The bench reserved its decision on a batch of petitions which raised the question whether provisional property attachments carried out by the ED under the PMLA can be confirmed by a single member of the

adjudicating authority, without the presence of a judicial member.

During the hearing, the bench asked the counsels appearing for ED, “If there are thousands of matters pending and are to be dealt with within 180 days prescribed under the law, will there be any real application of mind or will it become merely signing on the dotted line?”

The petitioners raised questions over interpretation of section 8 of the PMLA, which governs the adjudication of provisional attachment proceedings.

Senior advocate Vikram Chaudhari, appearing for one of the petitioners, contended that the 2022 verdict in the case of Vijay Madanlal Choudhary that upheld ED’s powers to arrest, stated that the PMLA adjudicating authority must be a three-member body headed by a



district judge.

He said forwarding cases of provisional attachment to an adjudicating authority is a vital function and an independent check on the ED’s powers to provisionally attach property.

Justice Bagchi asked the counsels whether it is their argument that the facet of judicial identity is completely rendered nugatory,

thereby going against the concept of separation of powers.

The petitioners’ counsels argued that the functions of an adjudicating authority under the PMLA require proper application of mind, whereas, on the other hand, such authority is often tasked with examining thousands of matters within a six-month deadline pre-

Court grants three weeks’ interim bail to Hindutva influencer

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A Delhi court on Tuesday granted three weeks’ interim bail to Hindutva influencer Swatantra Bhardwaj in connection with the alleged assault on the father of a student activist during a protest at Jantar Mantar, among other charges, sources said.

The proceedings were held in camera. According to court sources, the additional sessions judge granted three weeks’ interim bail. A detailed order is awaited. Bhardwaj had been remanded to 14 days’ judicial



custody on September 7. Earlier on Monday, the judge had said that the proceedings regarding the bail of the accused would be held in camera. His court staff had then asked media personnel to step outside the court. Later, the court staff said that

the order had been reserved for September 15.

Bhardwaj was detained in Bulandshahr on September 4, hours after the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protested outside the Parliament Street police station demanding his arrest

over the alleged assault. The action followed outrage over an interview in which Bhardwaj claimed he had “cracked the skull” of the student activist’s father during the June 23 protest and escaped arrest because of his political connections.

Bhardwaj was produced at the residence of a judge the next day, who allowed the Delhi Police’s plea seeking a one-day custodial interrogation of the accused. The next day, a magisterial court sent Bhardwaj to one day’s judicial custody. The present court then extended Bhardwaj’s judicial custody till September 21.

Cheque-bounce cases: SC gives Rajpal Yadav last chance of two weeks to deposit ₹2 crore

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday gave the last opportunity of two weeks to actor Rajpal Yadav to come out with a concrete proposal to pay an outstanding amount to a private firm and directed him to deposit ₹2 crore with the apex court registry.

The complainant alleged that, in 2013, Yadav tendered seven cheques of ₹1.05 crore each towards settlement of financial assistance of ₹5 crore to him for a film in 2010. The cheques were dishonoured, the firm further alleged. According to the



complainant, an agreement between the parties in 2012 stated that Yadav, his wife and their company had agreed to repay around ₹11 crore, including interest. A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana

extended his exemption from surrendering till October 5.

On July 10, the Delhi High Court upheld the conviction of Yadav in multiple cheque-bounce cases and sentenced him to three months’ imprisonment. “He is perfect at

doing drama but this court. Earlier orders of the court have not been complied with,” the bench said, adding that Yadav’s conduct does not inspire confidence but a last opportunity will be granted to him.

Appearing for Yadav, senior advocate P S Patwalla sought two weeks to come up with a concrete proposal to pay the outstanding amount and said he will be depositing ₹2 crore to prove his bona fide.

Patwalla said he has spent four-and-a-half months in prison and Yadav’s friends in the entertainment industry have to bail him out.

Regulation of educational institutes: SC issues notice to school education secretary

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday sought a response from the school education secretary in the Ministry of Education on a petition alleging non-compliance of its order to consider a plea seeking directions to regulate all institutions imparting education or religious instruction to children aged below 14.

A bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu issued notice to T K Anil Kumar, Secretary (Department of School

Education and Literacy), Ministry of Education, and sought his reply in four weeks.

The top court was hearing a contempt plea filed by advocate Ashwini Kumar Upadhyay, who alleged that the secretary did not take any action on his representation. On May 11, the top court had directed Upadhyay to make a representation before the Union of India with his plea. The plea, filed through advocate Ashwani Dubey, had sought directions to “take appropriate steps to register, recognise, supervise and monitor all institutions



imparting secular education or religious instructions to children up to the age of 14 years in the spirit of Article 21A read with Article 39(f), 45 and 51-A(k)”. The petition stated that Article 30 does not

grant any special or additional rights to minorities beyond what is already guaranteed under Article 19(1)(g) (right to practice any profession, occupation, trade, or business). “Direct and declare that

Article 30 is a specific reiteration of Article 19(1)(g) and doesn’t confer any additional rights, benefits or privileges than the rights guaranteed to the citizens under Article 19(1)(g),” the plea said.

“Petitioner is filing the Public Interest Litigation under Article 32 for registration, recognition, supervision, and monitoring of all institutions imparting secular or religious education to children up to 14 years in the spirit of Article 21A, 39(f), 45 and 51-A(k).” “Petitioner submits that children are the backbone of the nation’s

growth and are also gullible and naive due to their tender age. Hence, the State has heightened responsibility towards them.

This is an issue of national security as young kids (who) form the future of the nation, can be brainwashed or manipulated in the unregistered institution,” it said. Upadhyay, in his plea, has claimed that he visited several districts along the Uttar Pradesh border, where numerous unregistered and unrecognised institutions were allegedly found operating.

SC asks Delhi Gymkhana Club members to raise takeover concerns before HC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday granted liberty to 11 members of the Delhi Gymkhana Club, who had challenged the Centre’s decision to take over the club’s 27.3-acre premises and the subsequent eviction proceedings, to move the Delhi High Court.

Senior advocate Vikas Singh, appearing for the 11 members, told a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana that a Central government-nominated committee is presently managing the club, and it cannot fight a legal battle with the government. Singh said the govern-



ment-nominated management had overstayed the NCLAT-mandated timeline for elections and restoration of elected control, and it was a mala fide attempt to take over the club. “Here, the lessor and the lessee are both under the control of the government,” he said.

Taking note of the submissions, bench disposed of the plea filed by Vipin Aggarwal and 10 other club members and granted them the liberty to either file a fresh plea in the Delhi High Court or make themselves a party in the pending case related to the eviction proceedings.

International education needs stronger partnerships

THIERRY MATHOU

Ambassador of France to India

For 30 years, international education has largely been shaped by competition. Countries have sought to attract the brightest students, universities have competed for global rankings, and success has often been measured through enrolment numbers and international visibility. But as education becomes increasingly connected to research, innovation and employment, this model no longer tells the whole story.

The relationship between France and India illustrates how this is changing. Student mobility is increasingly supported by academic agreements, research cooperation, institutional partnerships and stronger links with industry. International education is no longer simply about where students choose to study, but about the networks of knowledge, opportunity and collaboration that can be built around them.

The growing movement of Indian students to France reflects this expanding relationship. Indian enrolment in French higher education increased by 17 per cent in a single year, reaching 9,100 students in the 2024-25 academic year. India consequently became the eleventh-largest source country of international students in France, rising from thirteenth place the previous year. Broader visa and residence-permit data, which also include exchange students and shorter programmes, indicate that approximately 12,000 Indian students

were studying in France in 2025.

These figures are significant, but they also represent a growing network of individuals contributing to academic, scientific, cultural and professional ties between the two countries. Every student who studies in France develops knowledge of another academic system and builds relationships that can sustain bilateral cooperation. The partnership between India and France demonstrates how education can serve as a foundation for wider collaboration. Academic exchanges, institutional agreements, research cooperation and student mobility have strengthened ties in education, research, innovation, technology, entrepreneurship and industry.

The India-France Year of Innovation 2026 further reflects this shared ambition, highlighting the growing connections between higher education



Thierry Mathou, Ambassador of France to India, with Indian students

India-France education ties are evolving beyond student mobility, building lasting partnerships across academia, research, innovation, industry and employment

tion, research, entrepreneurship and industry across areas such as aerospace, artificial intelligence, healthcare, sustainable development and energy transition. At the same time, partnerships between Indian institutions and French universities, engineering schools and business schools are creating pathways across a wide range of disciplines. Institutions such as CentraleSupélec, Mines Paris-PSL, IMT Atlantique, ISAE-SUPAERO and ENAC form part of an academic and industrial ecosystem connected to aerospace, advanced engineering and emerging technologies. Business schools including ESSEC, ESCP, and KEDGE contribute to cooperation

in management, entrepreneurship and innovation, while French public universities support partnerships across the sciences, humanities and social sciences.

The objective is not simply to create more opportunities for students to leave one country and study in another. It is to develop deeper institutional relationships through joint programmes, research cooperation, academic exchanges, local engagement and connections with industry. International mobility becomes more valuable when it is embedded within partnerships that continue before, during and after a student's period of study. The presence of French institutions in India reinforces this approach. ESSEC's presence in India, for example, reflects a model in which international institutions engage more closely with local academic, professional and innovation ecosystems. Partnerships between French and Indian institutions similarly create opportunities to combine expertise, develop joint academic pathways and strengthen research cooperation. For

instance, we witnessed the recent inauguration by President Macron and Minister J.P. Nadda of the Franco-Indian Centre for AI in Health, co-chaired by Sorbonne University and AIIMS, that will bring together the best innovation in biotechnologies and healthcare, which is beneficial to both countries, and to the world.

This is also why initiatives that bring students closer to international opportunities are increasingly important. Programmes supported by Campus France and outreach initiatives such as the Choose France Tour 2026 allow students and families to engage directly with institutions, explore academic pathways and obtain guidance on scholarships, visas, accommodation and student life. With representatives from more than 50 French institutions across business, engineering, public universities, arts and design, hospitality and specialised education, the Tour reflects the diversity of the bilateral education ecosystem. More importantly, it creates direct connections between prospective students and the institutions that may become part of their academic and professional journeys.

Initiatives such as Classes Internationales further demonstrate how partnerships can make international education more accessible. The programme combines French-language training with academic preparation before students begin full undergraduate degrees. Involving more than 30 French institutions and providing access to over 200 undergraduate programmes, it creates a structured pathway for students who may not previously have considered studying in France. Yet the value of an education partnership cannot stop at graduation. International mobility and academic cooperation must also connect students to professional opportunities.

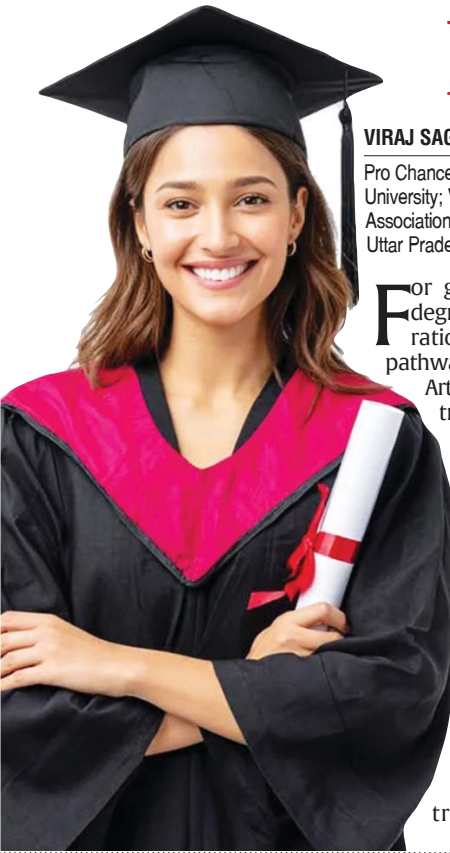
This is where relationships between universities, companies, chambers of commerce and employers become equally important.

The Indo-French Chamber of Commerce and Industry (IFCCI) brings together around 800 members, while more than 570 French companies operating in India are estimated to support close to 500,000 jobs. Initiatives such as the IFCCI Job Fair connect students and graduates with this wider professional ecosystem, demonstrating how the France-India network extends beyond academia into employment, entrepreneurship and industry.

Student mobility creates connections between people. Institutional and research cooperation deepens them. Employability ensures that the skills, knowledge and relationships developed through education contribute to the wider economy and society.

France's ambition to welcome 30,000 Indian students by 2030 should therefore be viewed through this broader lens. It is not simply a numerical target, but an investment in a network of students, institutions, researchers and professionals capable of sustaining cooperation between the two countries over the long term. As international education evolves, success will no longer be measured solely by rankings, recruitment figures or student numbers. The more meaningful question is whether international education creates lasting connections between institutions, research communities, industries and people.

In an increasingly interconnected world, the future of international education will be defined not by who competes most aggressively, but by who builds the strongest partnerships and views international education as an integrative opportunity for all involved parties.



VIRAJ SAGAR DAS

Pro Chancellor, Babu Banarasi Das University; Vice-President, Badminton Association of India; and President, Uttar Pradesh Olympic Association

For generations, a university degree has represented preparation for a profession and a pathway to a stable career. But as Artificial Intelligence begins to transform how industries operate, how professionals work and even how skills are defined, the traditional idea of being "job-ready" is evolving. Today, students need more than knowledge of a discipline; they need the ability to learn continuously, adapt to change and make thoughtful decisions in an increasingly technology-driven world.

Education needs to transcend employment.

The duty of every university is to produce graduates who have professional expertise, curiosity, innovation, ethical sense and are socially impactful in their thinking. This ideology is founded on the principle that a university must train students for life, not merely a profession.

The impact of AI on education is profound, and this transformation will make an indelible impression on us. This is because AI has transcended beyond technology companies or departments of computer science to become more pervasive than healthcare, law, education, management, agriculture, architecture, hospitality, media and almost any other professional area. Therefore, having a basic knowledge of AI is no longer an advantage, but a basic requirement.

In order to respond to this transformation and the growing importance of AI, universities are adapting to modern pedagogy with AI taking centre stage. At BBD University, we have moved beyond treating AI as an elective add-on; nearly 10 per cent of every curriculum across our schools, right from engineering to management to humanities, is now built around AI literacy and application, ensuring that



no student graduates without the fluency that this moment demands. AI is now being incorporated in a way that students of different disciplines can grasp its application in their respective disciplines. These initiatives include AI labs, specialisation programmes like B Tech in Computer Science & Engineering (Generative AI) and MBA in Data Science &

Artificial Intelligence, along with strong industrial partnerships like IBM and HCL GUVI.

Nevertheless, preparing the students for the world of AI would not be another attempt at familiarising them with a bunch of technological skills. Rather, it would mean preparing them to apply judgement about where technology can add value, where human intelligence cannot be replaced and how innovation can be pursued responsibly. As AI becomes more advanced, qualities such as critical thinking, creativity, empathy, collaboration, leadership and ethical decision-making, which are distinctively human, are going to be valued more highly. This is why the university experience must not remain restricted to the classroom and examination hall. There must be spaces for experiential learning, interdisciplinary collaboration, research, entrepreneurship and interaction with industry.

There is also no denying that the future workplace would require professionals who can function beyond the discipline-specific boundary lines. For instance, an engineer would need to know something about

business, a lawyer about AI and cyber law, a manager about data and an educator about the potential of AI in education. Interdisciplinary education therefore becomes crucial for creating professionals who would be versatile enough to cope with these demands of the times. And even within an interdisciplinary curriculum, AI and technological enhancements will lead the way to futuristic education, which will help produce a skilled workforce.

Ultimately, rather than churning out graduates who merely keep up with technology, the ideal outcome of higher education is for graduates who know how to use technology in their favour. The future lies not with those competing against AI, but with those who know how to leverage AI for what it can offer and yet preserve all those qualities that AI cannot bring to the table. While getting a degree is important to get through the doors, what will make all the difference for students is the ability to learn and lead. For every institution of learning, the mission should be to equip the students not only with degrees, but with the tools and the knowledge necessary to prosper in the AI-driven world.

Building healthier academic environments

DEEPPENDRA SHARMA

Dean, School of Business, MIT-WPU

1,000 million individuals on this planet are living with some or other sort of mental disorder. 12,000 million working days are lost in a year due to depression and anxiety-related issues, which tentatively cost ₹100 lakh crore. Welcome to reality!

Today, life has become very demanding for any individual at the professional front, irrespective of the industry in which one works, and academics is no exception to it. Any management faculty member would agree with me that the nature of their work is not as simple as employees in other industries perceive it to be. A management teacher is supposed to deliver lectures (knowledge dissemination), carry out research and publish (knowledge creation), act as a mentor, generate funds through consultancy and training for corporates, develop connections with industry, and the list does not end here. Further, they have to keep themselves abreast of all the changes happening in their field, along with technological advancements, which in itself requires a lot of effort, considering the speed with which the changes are taking place.



Here, one should be mindful that the major responsibilities mentioned above are cerebral in nature, and it is not only the quantity of work but also the nature of the work that demands a lot of physical, emotional and intellectual involvement. Hence, they are in a perpetual working zone, resulting in a negative impact not only on their physical well-being but also on their

emotional as well as mental well-being, consequently affecting the university/institution's performance. Like in any other organisation, in management education as well, a higher degree of work pressure and emotional fatigue results in attrition, job dissatisfaction, poor quality of research output and substandard teaching and learning outcomes.

Management institutes create leaders, teach critical thinking, resilience, teamwork and communication. They teach individuals how to use data to develop their unique insights and take final decisions. All this can be achieved only if the psychological well-being of the faculty is taken care of.

But is the issue related only to an individual's resilience to cope with this counterproductive pressure? Definitely, NO.

There are other institutional issues that need to be taken care of by a c a d e m i c

leaders. Empathetic academic leadership and institutional work culture matter. Academic leaders' intervention can be critical in improving faculty mental health and consequently in improving university effectiveness because only they can create working environments where individuals can perform well without hampering their psychological and mental well-being. They need to develop a culture of congeniality among colleagues, ensure the absence of micromanagement, and provide the resources for research and their development. They should organise mental health training and allocate a reasonable workload in terms of teaching, research and administration. They should have systems and processes for discussing opportunities for individual growth and their career path while appreciating their efforts. They need to develop an environment of trust and not fear, of accountability and not anxiety, of performance and not pressure.

These suggestions are not optional but are inevitable because the success of any institution on a sustainable basis ultimately depends on the faculty who deliver the desired outcomes. Therefore, the future of management education depends not only on how effectively we prepare students for future workplaces, but also on whether we provide a culture to the 'doer' that is conducive to their overall well-being. Let us take care of those who take care of our future leaders.

AI's infrastructure challenge for education

SOUMYATANU MUKHERJEE

Associate Professor of Economics, XLRI Delhi-NCR

The "cloud" may appear weightless and borderless, but artificial intelligence depends on physical infrastructure — powerful computers, chips, energy, cooling systems and networks. For India's education sector, the important question is not simply how much AI infrastructure the country builds, but how effectively that computing capacity reaches universities, researchers and students.

India's AI ambitions are expanding rapidly. Yet the educational value of this expansion will depend on whether universities and research institutions can access the computing resources they need. AI is increasingly becoming part of disciplines ranging from engineering and data science to economics, medicine, agriculture and climate research. For students and researchers, access to advanced computing is becoming as important as access to laboratories and specialised equipment.

This creates an important policy challenge. Large investments in AI infrastructure can strengthen university research, encourage start-ups and support domestic innovation.



But infrastructure alone does not guarantee educational benefits. Without meaningful links with universities, data centres could remain largely focused on commercial workloads, while Indian students and researchers continue to face limited access to high-performance computing.

Public policy should therefore ensure an educational dividend from India's AI investments. A defined share of computing capacity could be made available competitively

to universities, researchers, students and public-interest projects. Such access could support AI research, student projects, fellowships, interdisciplinary programmes and col-

BUILDING AI INFRASTRUCTURE IS ONLY THE BEGINNING; INDIA MUST ENSURE UNIVERSITIES AND STUDENTS BENEFIT THROUGH RESEARCH, SKILLS AND INNOVATION

laborations between academia and industry.

Universities should also become active partners in India's AI expansion. Industry partnerships can help establish shared computing facilities, joint research programmes and specialised AI laboratories. This would allow students to work with real-world systems while enabling companies to benefit from academic research and talent. There is also a wider question of affordability. If access to advanced computing remains concentrated among a small number of institutions, AI could deepen existing inequalities in higher education. Students at well-funded universities would gain opportunities to experiment with sophisticated AI models, while others could remain dependent on limited or outdated resources.

India must therefore think of computing capacity not merely as digital infrastructure, but as educational infrastructure. The success of the country's AI strategy should ultimately be measured by what it creates in classrooms and laboratories — better-trained students, stronger universities, meaningful research and new Indian innovations. India's AI ambition will be credible only when its universities and students can participate in it.



US amendment seeks to name India in Russia sanctions bill

SAGAR KULKARNI
■ Washington

Racing against time, US lawmakers submitted amendments to the Russia sanctions bill, with one seeking to name its top trading partners — including India — in the legislation, and another proposing to scrap the section imposing tariffs altogether.

The Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, passed by the US Senate by an overwhelming 86-11 vote last month, seeks to impose sanctions not only on Russia's leadership and energy sector, but also on the "shadow fleet" of vessels that enable Moscow to evade sanctions on oil deliveries.

The Bill also seeks to authorise President Donald Trump to impose 100 per cent tariffs on Russia's top oil trading partners, including China and India. The bill passed by the US Senate on August 7 does not name



Russia's trading partners, but mentions the five largest importers of oil and gas by volume.

The bill must be passed by the House of Representatives before it is sent to the President for signature. The House has four working days left before it breaks into early recess ahead of the midterm elections on November 3. The amendment moved by Democratic Congressman Steny Hoyer seeks to name China, India, Türkiye, Azerbaijan, Hungary, the Slovak Republic, the UAE, Singapore, Kazakhstan, and the Kyrgyz Republic

as countries eligible for 100 per cent duties. Interestingly, Democratic Congressman Gregory Meeks, who is staunchly opposed to granting more tariff-levying powers to Trump, has moved an amendment to scrap the entire Section 113 that seeks to grant authority to the President to impose broad secondary tariffs on Russia's trading partners.

The amendments to the Russia sanctions act were made public by the House Rules Committee on Monday. Another amendment moved by Meeks seeks to allow the President to waive the sanctions applicable to a foreign person for a period of 90 days, with a provision for renewal for additional periods of 90 days, if it is "vital to the national security of the US." Meeks has also moved an amendment seeking to authorise \$15 billion in direct loans to Ukraine for financing the procurement of defence articles and services. (PTI)

Bangladesh, Pakistan stress diplomacy and regular talks to deepen bilateral relations

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Dhaka

Bangladesh and Pakistan have stressed the need to strengthen parliamentary diplomacy through regular dialogue, exchanges of parliamentary delegations and greater people-to-people contacts to deepen bilateral relations, according to a local media report.

The emphasis came during a meeting between Bangladesh Jatiya Sangsad Deputy Speaker and parliamentary delegation leader Barrister Kayser Kamal and Pakistan National Assembly Speaker Sardar Ayaz Sadiq on Monday in Cape Town, South Africa, on the eve of the opening of the 69th Commonwealth Parliamentary Conference, Bangladesh's state-run BSS



Deputy speaker Barrister Kayser Kamal, leading a Bangladesh's parliamentary delegation, hold a bilateral meeting with Pakistan National Assembly speaker Sardar Ayaz Sadiq in South Africa

news agency reported. The two leaders discussed various issues of mutual interest, BSS reported, citing a press release issued by the Bangladesh parliament secretariat. Kamal invited Sadiq to visit Bangladesh at a mutually convenient time, while the Pakistani National Assembly speaker invited the Speaker

and Deputy Speaker of Bangladesh to visit Pakistan. The meeting was held in a "cordial and friendly atmosphere", with members of the parliamentary delegations of both countries also attending, BSS said. The meeting comes as Dhaka and Islamabad seek to expand bilateral engagement following the fall of

former prime minister Sheikh Hasina's Government in August 2024

Bangladesh, China discuss trade corridor
Bangladesh and China discussed cooperation on a proposed economic corridor linking the country with Myanmar and China, as Chinese Ambassador Yao Wen met Bangladesh's junior foreign minister Shama Obaed Islam, according to a local media report. The meeting took place here on Monday at the minister's office, where the two also discussed infrastructure, energy, human-resource development and economic cooperation, Bangladesh's state-run BSS news agency reported, citing a press release issued by the foreign ministry.

THE KANGRA CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD.

C-29, Community Centre Pankha Road, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058

Phone: 011-25611042, 25611043, 25611044

E-mail: legal@kangrabank.com, legal1@kangrabank.com, Website: www.kangrabank.com

[APPENDIX IV-A] [See proviso to rule 8 (6)]

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of below mentioned Immovable Secured Asset under The Securitisation and Reconstruction of the Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, read with proviso to rule 8 (6) of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the Public in General and in particular to the below mentioned borrower, mortgagor & Surety that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to The Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised officer of The Secured Creditor, will be sold on "AS IS WHERE IS", "AS IS WHAT IS" AND "WHATEVER THERE IS" BASIS THROUGH "SALE BY" e-auction (under SARFAESI Act & Rules, 2002) as per brief particulars given hereunder:-

S. No.	a) Name of Borrower & Surety b) Branch Name	(a) Date of Demand Notice (b) Possession Type/Date (c) Demand Notice Amount.	Description of Property.	Reserve Price	(a) Earnest Money Deposit. (b) Bid Increment amount. (c) Date & Time of Inspection. (a) Last date/Time of EMD & KYC Submission. Date/ Time of E-Auction.
1.	Sh. Gopal Singh S/o Late Sh. Chuni Singh. GP-17/377 (Borrower) And Smt. Jayshree W/o. Sh. Gopal Singh Mortgagor & Surety) Branch : Govindpuri	110019. (a) 14-01-2019 (b) Physical Possession/18-10-2019. (c) Rs.15,40,527/- together with further interest, penal interest and other charges as are applicable in the Loan account from time to time, from 31-12-2018 till the date of payment.	BUILT-UP LOWER GROUND FLOOR ON LEFT SIDE PORTION (ENTRANCE ON PARKING SIDE AND WITHOUT TERRACE RIGHTS), CONSISTING OF ONE HALL ATTACHED TOILET/BATHROOM. MEASURING 62.70 SQ.MTRS. (75 SQ.YDS.) WITH RIGHTS OF ONE COMMON SCOOTER PARKING AT L.G.F. RIGHT SIDE PORTION. ALONG WITH THE PROPERTY NO.RZ-421, GALI NO.8(OLD 58W) TUGHLAKABAD EXTN. COLONY, NEW DELHI-	Rupees Eight Lakh Twenty Thousand Only (Rs. 8,20,000/-)	(a) Rs.82,000 /- (b) Rs.10,000/- (c) 22-09-2026 11.00 am. To 4.00 p.m., (d) 05-10-2026 upto 5:30 p.m. (e) 07-10-2026, 3:00 p.m. To 5:00 p.m.

For detailed Bid/Tender form, terms and conditions of the said sale, please refer to the link provided in THE KANGRA CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD., HEAD OFFICE AT C-29, COMMUNITY CENTRE, PANKHA ROAD, JANAKPURI, NEAR JANAK CINEMA, NEW DELHI-110058, The Secured Creditor Bank's website, i.e., www.kangrabank.com.

The auction will be conducted through the Bank's approved service provider M/s. e-Procurement Technologies Limited (Auction Tiger), and for detailed Bid/Tender form, terms and conditions of the said sale and procedure of submission of Bid/Tender, are available from their website at <https://sarfaesi.auctiontiger.net>.

STATUTORY NOTICE AS PER SECTION 13 (8), RULE 8(6) & RULE 9 (1) OF SARFAESI ACT, 2002

This notice also considered as a notice to the above named borrower & mortgagor in the said case, to pay the dues in full before the date of news paper publications of this sale notice, failing which this floor will be sold on the above mentioned Sale/Auction date. This publication is also 15 day's notice to the above named borrower, mortgagor & Surety.

HARISH SHARMA
AUTHORISED OFFICER
THE KANGRA CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD.
HEAD OFFICE AT C-29, COMMUNITY CENTRE,
PANKHA ROAD, JANAKPURI, NEW DELHI-110058,
PHONE NO. 9013568419, 9013568418.

DATED: 14-09-2026
PLACE : DELHI

South Indian Bank Ltd

Regional Office-Delhi, 3rd Floor, Plot No.21, 211, Pusa Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi -110005

Phone-011 4233 1664/011 4512 8661

Email-roi1008@siib.co.in.

Ref: DEL/CRD/SAR/35/2026-27

Date: 15-09-2026

E - AUCTION SALE NOTICE

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

1. M/s. Shri Gangadas Textile Industries Limited, 7098 Shop no. 1, Jain Market, Guru Nanak Gali, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi- 110 031, Also at: F 224, Focal Point, Phase VIII, Chandigarh Road, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 010, Also at: Ground & First Floor, Property no. 465, Near Sabzi Mandi, Jheel Khurana, Delhi 110 051

2. M/S GG Fabrics under proprietorship of Mr. Nitin Dawar at F 224, Focal Point, Phase VIII, Chandigarh Road, Ludhiana Punjab-141 010

3. Mr. Pankaj Ahuja 4181, 04 Duragpur Halibawal, Kalan, Ludhiana, Punjab-141 001

4. Mrs. Hema Ahuja 4181, 04 Duragpur Halibawal, Kalan, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 001

5. Mr. Rakesh Kumar 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051

6. Mr. Suresh Kumar 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051

7. Mr. Vinay Dawar House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012

8. Mr. Nitin Dawar, House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012 (Personal guarantor and legal heir of late Ramesh Kumar).

9. Mrs. Shivani Kochar, 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051, also at: House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012 (Legal heir of late Ramesh Kumar)

10. Mrs. Savita Dawar, House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012, also at: House 504, Block GX, BRS Nagar Extension, Opposite Verka Milk Plant, Ferozpur Road, Ludhiana-141012, also at: 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower/guarantor/Legal heirs that the below described immovable properties mortgaged to the South Indian Bank Ltd, Branch Vasundhara (Secured Creditor), the Physical Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of The South Indian Bank Limited (Secured Creditor), will be sold on "as is where is" basis, "as is what is" and "whatever there is" condition on 06-10-2026 for recovery of an amount of Rs.16,92,38,143.26/- (Rupees Sixteen Crore Ninety Two Lakh Thirty Eight Thousand One Hundred Forty Three and Twenty Six Paise Only) as on 18-02-2026, with future interest, costs and expenses etc. thereon due to The South Indian Bank Limited, Branch Vasundhara (Secured Creditor), from the above mentioned Borrower(s) and guarantor(s).

Item No.1

Name of Property Owner	Late Mr. Ramesh Kumar (Now represented by legal heirs Mrs. Savita Dawar, Mr. Vinay Dawar, Mr. Nitin Dawar and Mrs. Shivani Kochar), Mr. Rakesh Kumar and Mr. Suresh Kumar
Description of property	All that Part and Parcel of Freehold Residential Property admeasuring 50 square yards out of area measuring 100 sq. yds. out of total area measuring 218 sq. yds. out of Khalsa no. 464/362 along with Residential Buildings constructed upon it bearing no. MPL 783/18-A/5 (old), New No. IX/7172 along with all other constructions, improvements, Easementary Rights existing and appurtenant thereon situated at Gaur Nanak Gali, Gandhi Nagar, Village Seelampur, Illaga Shahdara, Delhi 110 031 owned by Late Ramesh Kumar Dawar (since expired and represented by his legal heirs; Mrs. Savita Dawar, Mr. Vinay Dawar, Mr. Nitin Dawar and Mrs. Shivani Kochar), Mr. Rakesh Kumar and Mr. Suresh Kumar more particularly described under Sale Deed No. 1287 dated 09-05-1989 at SRO -IV, New Delhi/Delhi and Will dated 02-06-1997 bounded on North by Common Passage, South by Other's property, East by Common wall & Shop No.7 and West by common wall and shop No.5
Reserve Price (Item No.1)	Rs. 1,44,50,000/- (Rupees One Crore Forty Four Lakh Fifty Thousand Only)
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (Item No.1)	Rs. 14,45,000/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakhs Forty-Five Thousand Only) EMD shall be deposited on or before 05.10.2026 till 02.00 PM
Bid Increment amount Item No.1	Rs. 10,000/- (Rupees Ten Thousand Only)
Date and time of E-auction Item No.1	06.10.2026 from 11:00 AM to 11:30 AM (with 5 minute unlimited auto extensions till sale is concluded)
Encumbrances known to the Bank (Item No.1)	Nil/Encumbrances from 01.01.2018 to 22.11.2022

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in web portal of South Indian Bank Ltd, (Secured Creditor) website i.e. www.southindianbank.com. Details also available at <https://bankauctions.in>.

For any further clarification with regards to inspection of property, terms and conditions of the e-auction or submission of bids, kindly contact South Indian Bank Ltd on 9037-854-719 (contact number).

Sd/- AUTHORISED OFFICER

सेन्ट्रल बैंक ऑफ इंडिया

Central Bank of India

1911 से आपके लिए "केन्द्रित" "CENTRAL" TO YOU SINCE 1911

Regional Office Delhi (South)

3rd Floor, Sorabji Bhawan, 4/54, D.B. Gupta Road, Karolbagh, New Delhi-110005

PHYSICAL SALE NOTICE

15 DAY'S SALE NOTICE INVITING QUOTATION / REQUEST FOR QUOTATION

The Authorized Officer, Central Bank of India invites sealed quotations for sale of the below mentioned vehicles, to be conducted at 04:00 pm on 06.10.2026 in the office of Central Bank of India, South Extension Part-II Branch.

The vehicles are hypothecated to Central Bank of India, physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of Central Bank of India, for recovery of respective dues from the borrower.

DESCRIPTION OF VEHICLE TO BE HELD ON 06.10.2026 (15 DAY'S NOTICE)

S. No.	Name of Branch	Authorised Officer	Enforcement Agency	Name of the Account	Description of Vehicle & Name of the Owner	Demand Notice Date & Amount Dues (Rs. in Lakhs)	Reserve Price EMD Bid Increase
1.	South Extension New Delhi	Mr. Anupam Gupta Mobile: 9999917125	Sanchar Management Services Pvt. Ltd. Mobile: 9811040603	Amit Dahiya	FOUR WHEELER HONDA JAZZ 1.5VX MT (I-DTEC) (DIESEL) RC No: DL9CAP5014 Year of Manu- 2017 Color- Alabaster Silver	13(2) Notice Date: 18.06.2025 Rs.4,94,574.76 as on 18.06.2025 + Future Interest & Other Charges thereon	₹ 1,00,000.00 ₹ 10,000.00 ₹ 1,000.00
2.	South Extension New Delhi	Mr. Anupam Gupta Mobile: 9999917125	Sanchar Management Services Pvt. Ltd. Mobile: 9811040603	Amit Dahiya	FOUR WHEELER HONDA WR-V 1.5 SMT (I-DTEC) (DIESEL) RC No: DL9CAN7531 Year of Manu- 2017 Color- Alabaster Silver	13(2) Notice Date: 18.06.2025 Rs.4,31,156.10 as on 18.06.2025 + Future Interest & Other Charges thereon	₹ 1,00,000.00 ₹ 10,000.00 ₹ 1,000.00

Detailed Terms & Conditions:

- The sale will be on "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is" basis.
- The quotation price of the respective vehicle must be above the Reserve Price.
- The quotations must be submitted in specified format. Any quotation which is not in the prescribed format or incomplete in any respect is liable to be rejected.
- The rate / quotation should be mentioned in figures as well as in words. In case of ambiguity in ascertain the quoted amount, the amount mentioned in words shall be taken as the quoted amount.
- Sealed quotation with specific vehicle registration no. superscripted on the envelopes has to be submitted by Register Post / Speed Post only. Submission of quotation by Hand delivery, by Courier or by any other means shall not be accepted.
- The sealed quotations must reach the Authorized Officer before 04:00 p.m of 05.10.2026.
- The Quotations will be taken for consideration/ treated as valid, only if EMD amount is deposited for each of the vehicle.
- Payment/ deposit of EMD can be made by way of Demand Draft/NEFT. If EMD is to be deposited through Demand Draft, the same must be drawn in favor of Central Bank of India South Extension Branch. If EMD is to be deposited through NEFT, the payment must be made as per the specification given below; i) Name of the Account: CD Bill Pay Account ii) Account no.: 3525233868 iii) IFSC: CBIN0280976
- If the EMD is deposited through DD, it should be particular of the vehicle for which the EMD is given should be mentioned in the reverse of the DD.
- For every separate quotation, separate payment towards EMD can be made by way of Demand Draft. If a person wants to participate in sale of more than one vehicle, and submits quotations, for each of such quotation, separate payment of EMD shall be made. Clubbing of EMD together is not permissible.
- Received quotations will be opened on 06.10.2026 at 04:00 PM in the office of Authorized Officer at Central Bank of India South Extension Part-II Branch, M-1, South Extension part-II, New Delhi-110049.
- A purchaser selected will have to pay at least 25% of the quoted amount within the next working day from the date of receipt of information about the selection of his quotation as successful quotation. The rest amount has to be paid within a period of 15 days from the date of declaration. Failure of payment in the stipulated manner shall cause cancellation of the quotation and forfeiture of the entire amount already deposited. The purchaser has also to bear and pay the encumbrances if any known to the secured creditor.
- All statutory dues, taxes, registration charges, parking and security charges and transfer expenses shall be borne by the successful bidder.
- Physical possession of the vehicle shall be handed over to the purchaser ONLY when the Purchaser produces sufficient and satisfactory proof of submission of application before RTO for transfer of the vehicle in his name.
- All persons submitting the quotation shall be deemed to have read and understood the conditions of sale and be bound by the conditions.
- For detailed terms and conditions please refer to the link provided in www.centralbank.bank.in

DATE: 15.09.2026

PLACE: NEW DELHI

Authorised Officer,

CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA, RO Delhi (South), New Delhi

Saudi airstrikes leave 3 dead, Houthis claim

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Dubai

A Houthi official said on Tuesday that Saudi warplanes struck Yemen, killing three people, including two children, while Human Rights Watch accused the Houthi rebels of possible war crimes with its attacks on commercial vessels.

The renewed fighting in Yemen is endangering civilians and threatening shipping through the Red Sea, a route that has become more important due to disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz since the US and Israel launched joint strikes against Iran on February 28 to spark the war.

The Associated Press couldn't independently verify the Houthi official's claim. The official didn't say what the Saudi warplanes had targeted. Anees al Asbahi, a spokesperson for the Houthi-run Health Ministry, said in an X post on Tuesday that Saudi airstrikes killed three people, including two children, in Yemen's Taiz province. The Associated Press couldn't independently verify the claim. Al-Asbahi said that two other people were wounded in the strikes.

The escalation comes as the Iran-backed Houthi rebels have seized the strategic islands of Greater and Lesser Hanish in the southern Red Sea, bolstering their ability to control a key maritime shipping route. Iran effectively closed the Strait of Hormuz - through which a fifth of the world's traded oil and gas transits in peacetime - in the opening days of the war. The Saudis have since used

the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, which leads out of the Red Sea, for crude oil exports.

The Houthis' latest seizures, which follow their capture of the Red Sea port of Mokha and a strategic island last week, puts more pressure on Saudi shipments and, in turn, global oil supplies and prices. This could give Iran additional leverage in the war.

New York-based Human Rights Watch said Tuesday that at least three attacks by Houthi rebels against commercial vessels in the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden between July 20 and August 24 could amount to war crimes.

The Houthi attacks against Saudi-linked shipping started in mid-July in the latest flare-up of violence in the Yemen civil war. Niku Jafarnia, a Yemen and Bahrain researcher at Human Rights Watch, said that irrespective of any politics involved, "attacks on civilian crews carried out deliberately or recklessly are war crimes."

सेन्ट्रल बैंक ऑफ इंडिया

Central Bank of India

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SECTOR-24 NOIDA BRANCH, CHAURAMAU, OPP. GOVT. INTER SCHOOL, SECTOR-22, NOIDA, U.P.-201301

POSSESSION NOTICE (For Immovable Property)

[Under Rule 8(1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002]

Whereas, the Authorised officer of the Central Bank of India, Sector-24 Noida Branch under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002, and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (2) and 13 (12) read with the Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002 issued a demand notice dated 04.06.2026 calling upon the Borrower: Mr. Ramesh Chand Gautam S/o Mr. Khem Chand Gautam and Mrs. Neelam Gautam W/o Mr. Ramesh Chand Gautam, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being Rs.15,69,275.66 {(Rupees Fifteen Lakh Sixty Nine Thousand Two Hundred Seventy Five and Paise Sixty Six Only) reduced by the amount subsequently deposited/ recovered from the borrower} (which represents the principal plus interest due as on 30.04.2026), plus interest and other charges from 30.04.2026 to till date within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The Borrower having failed to pay the entire dues of the bank, notice is hereby given to the borrower, the Guarantor and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under section 13 (4) of the said act, read with Rule 8 (4) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rule 2002 on this 10th Day of September 2026.

The Borrower and the Guarantor in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealing with the property will be subject to charge of Central Bank of India, for the amount of Rs.15,69,275.66 {(Rupees Fifteen Lakh Sixty Nine Thousand Two Hundred Seventy Five and Paise Sixty Six Only) reduced by the amount subsequently deposited/ recovered from the borrower} (which represents the principal plus interest due on the 30.04.2026), plus interest and other charges from 30.04.2026.

The borrower's/guarantor's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the SARFAESI Act, in respect of the time available, to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

Flat No. 866, Ground Floor, DDA LIG Flat, New Kondli, East Delhi, Pin - 110096 via Sale Deed No.1287 dated 25/02/2014 - Property owned by Mr. Ramesh Chand Gautam S/o Mr. Khem Chand Gautam and Mrs. Neelam Gautam W/o Mr. Ramesh Chand Gautam. Bounded By: North East: Flat No.-865 North West: Entry of Flat No-863, Entry South East: Open Area South West: Flat No. 86

DATE: 10/09/2026

PLACE: NEW DELHI

(Authorised Officer),

Central Bank of India

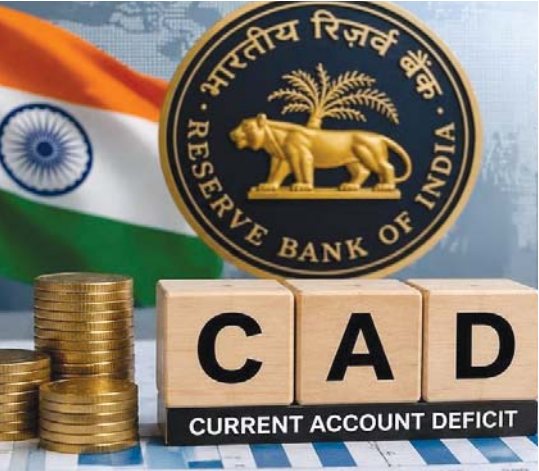


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Current account deficit more than doubles to \$7b in July



India's current account deficit widened to \$7 billion in July from \$3.2 billion a year ago, mainly due to a higher merchandise trade deficit, according to the Reserve Bank data released on Tuesday.

The preliminary data on India's balance of payments (BoP) for July 2026 released by the central bank showed that the merchandise trade deficit rose to \$31.7 billion in July from \$28.2 billion in the same month last year.

Imports increased to \$76.8 billion from \$65.6 billion, while exports rose to \$45.1 billion from \$37.4 billion.

On the other hand, there was improvement in net services surplus, which increased to \$17.6 billion in July from \$16.4 billion in the year-gago month. Services exports stood at \$38.3 billion while imports totalled \$20.6 billion during the month under review.

Net transfers increased to \$13.2 billion in July 2026 from \$12.6 billion, while net income outgo widened to \$6.1 billion from \$4 billion.

The capital account recorded a net inflow of \$27.7 billion in July 2026, sharply higher than \$3.5 billion in the year-gago month. According to the data, net foreign direct investment inflows rose to \$7.3 billion in July from \$4.5 billion a year earlier. Net foreign portfolio investment recorded an inflow of \$4.1 billion against an outflow of \$2.5 billion in July 2025.

The overall balance stood at a surplus of \$20.8 billion in July 2026, compared with \$0.3 billion in the year-gago month.

For the April-July period of 2026-27, the current account deficit stood at \$11.2 billion, compared with \$6.6 billion in the corresponding period of 2025-26.

The capital account recorded a net inflow of \$23.9 billion during April-July 2026, against \$11.4 billion a year earlier.

The overall balance was a surplus of \$12.7 billion, up from \$4.8 billion a year earlier. (PTI)

PUBLIC NOTICE

My Client, Deepak Kumar S/o Narain Dass Permanent R/o C-9/134, Rohini Sector-5, Som Bazar Road, Raja Pur Kalan, Dist-North West, Delhi-110085, Currently Residing at C-10/70, 3rd Floor, Sector-5, Rohini Delhi 110085 (Showned to my both son namely Krishna aged about 18 Years (approx) and Mayank aged about 16 (years) with consent of his mother on account of their repeated assault abusive and aggressive behaviour, behavior, continuous to the life and safety of the complainant, lodging of a false complainant against the complainant, and genuine apprehension of further physical harm, breach of peace and commission of any untoward any kind of incident. Any body deal with them will responsible himself, my client will not be responsible for their any act in future.

Bibhuti Kumar (Advocate) C-9/134, 2nd Floor, Sector-5, Rohini, Delhi-110085



कार्यालय नगर पालिक निगम, (यांत्रिकी शाखा), भोपाल

क्रमांक 326 /चौ.वि./26

नियतिद आरम्भण सूचना

भोपाल, दिनांक 15/09/2026

निम्न कार्य हेतु म.प्र. लोक निर्माण विभाग में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से आनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। विस्तृत विवरण website <https://www.mptenders.gov.in> पर है।

क्र.	निविदा क्र.	कार्य का संक्षिप्त विवरण	अनुमानित लागत (रु.में)	निविदा क्रय करने का अंतिम दिनांक	समय
1.	2026_UAD_525789_2	EMPANELMENT CONTRACT FOR CONSTRUCTION, RESURFACING AND MAINTENANCE WORKS FOR CC ROADS UNDER BHOPAL MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ZONE 01 TO 21	4,23,72,530/-	30-SEP-2026	05:30 P.M

नोट - संशोधन केवल वेबसाइट पर ही देखे जा सकेंगे, समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित नहीं होंगे।

**अधीक्षण यंत्री
नगर निगम भोपाल**

नि.क्र.0722/026/027



कार्यालय नगर पालिक निगम, खण्डवा (म.प्र.) 450001
(जनकार्य एवं उद्यान विभाग)

क्रमांक-1297/जन.वि./ ई-टेण्डरिंग/2026

खण्डवा, दिनांक- 10/09/2026

निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु निविदा ऑनलाईन आमंत्रित की जाती है, उल्लेखित कार्य की निविदा का विस्तृत वेबसाइट <http://www.mptenders.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।

क्र.	ऑन लाईन पोर्टल	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत जी.एस.टी. सहित (लाख में)	धरोहर राशि	निविदा प्रपत्र की राशि	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1.	2026_UAD_535502_1	गीता भवन (सौरकुंज आडिटोरियम) के उन्वयन का कार्य । 5th Call	200.00 Lacs	1,50,000/-	15,000/-	60 दिन

निविदा ऑनलाइन कय एवं प्रस्तुत करने की अंतिम दिनांक :- 26/09/2026 (शाम 5.30 बजे तक)
निविदा खोलने की दिनांक :- 28/09/2026 (प्रातः 10.30 बजे)

निविदा संबंधी समस्त जानकारी वेबसाइट <http://www.mptenders.gov.in> पर देखी जा सकती है। निविदा में यदि किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन किया जाता है तो वह वेबसाइट पर देखा जा सकता है।

**कार्यपालन यंत्री
नगर पालिक निगम, खण्डवा**

India's trade deficit narrows to \$26.86 billion in August

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The country's merchandise exports surged 26.12 per cent to \$43.81 billion in August, driven by a jump in petroleum product shipments, while a dip in gold imports helped narrow the trade deficit to a five-month low of \$26.86 billion.

Imports rose by 14.1 per cent year-on-year to \$70.76 billion in August.

Brent crude oil prices ranged between \$90 and \$94 per barrel during the last month.

The growth in exports in August was the highest since June 2022, when shipments had risen 30.12 per cent.

During April-August this fiscal, exports jumped 17.85 per cent year-on-year to \$215.91 billion, and imports climbed 18.21 per cent to



\$363 billion. Merchandise trade deficit during the first five months of this fiscal widened to \$147.09 billion as compared to \$123.88 billion during April-August 2025-26. In August 2025, the deficit was \$27.22 billion. In July it was \$31.98 billion. The last low was \$20.67 billion in March. India's gold imports dipped to \$2.3 billion in August from

\$5.4 billion in August 2025, registering a decline of 57.7 per cent.

Briefing the media on the data, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal said the good momentum of export growth is continuing and is rather building up also.

He said higher imports during the first five months of 2026-27 are being propelled

NBCC holds 66th annual general meeting

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

NBCC (India) Limited, a Navratna CPSE under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, Government of India, held its 66th Annual General Meeting (AGM) recently through Video conferencing/other audio-visual means.

KP Mahadevaswamy, Chairman & Managing Director, NBCC, chaired the meeting and addressed the shareholders. He also highlighted the Company's strong financial performance, business growth and key achievements during FY 2025-26, while outlining the opportunities being pursued across redevelopment, real estate, institutional infrastructure and international markets.

The AGM was attended by members of the NBCC Board, including Suman Kumar, Director (Commercial), Anjeev Kumar Jain, Director (Finance), Sanjeet, Government Nominee Director, Vishal Puri, Independent Director and Deepti Gambhir, Company Secretary.



During his address, Mahadevaswamy highlighted the Company's robust financial performance during FY 2025-26. NBCC recorded consolidated revenue of ₹13,195.89

crore, registering a growth of 7.52%, while consolidated Profit After Tax (PAT) increased by 33.19% to ₹742.45 crore.

The Company continued to strengthen its position in redevelopment and real estate. In the landmark Amrapali projects, NBCC is executing 38,000 residential units with a sanctioned value of ₹8,598 crore, of which more than 32,550 homes have already been completed and are being handed over.

by strong domestic economic expansion, rising energy requirements and the critical inputs needed to sustain the rapid growth of manufacturing sector. It has pushed the trade deficit also.

The major drivers of trade deficit have been energy items like petroleum, crude and coal, coke and briquettes, and electronic goods.

On the exports front, he said a mix of commodities helped push the growth and that included engineering goods, petroleum products, chemicals and textiles.

"At the same time, major demand has come from the US, EU, BRICS nations and emerging economies. So this also underscores India's expanding global footprint and improves our resilience, diversification and strategic trade integration objectives," he said.

Under Phase-II, the Company is developing additional housing and monetising unused FAR to ensure project sustainability.

NBCC continued to expand its presence in international markets and generated overseas revenue of ₹211.12 crore during the year. A major milestone was the establishment of NBCC Overseas Real Estate LLC in Dubai, making it the first CPSE to enter Dubai's real estate sector.

The Company also strengthened its engagement in Australia, Seychelles, Mauritius and the Maldives. Its flagship social housing project in Hulhumalé, Maldives, reflects NBCC's capability to deliver quality infrastructure while supporting India's growing international partnerships.

Uno Minda Ltd announces projects worth ₹1,415 crore

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Gurugram

Uno Minda Limited, a leading automotive components and systems manufacturer, has announced four capacity expansion and consolidation projects worth a combined ₹1,415 crore, aimed at strengthening its manufacturing base and meeting rising demand from Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs).

The largest of the four is a greenfield aluminium casting facility on Thally

involves setting up a 3.3-million-unit two-wheeler alloy wheel plant in Kharkhoda, Haryana, at an additional capex of ₹155 crore. This includes relocating 2 million units of existing capacity from Supa, Maharashtra, to align production with shifting demand and strengthen the company's presence in North India. Phase 1 is expected to begin production by Q4FY28.

Third, the company will expand its moulding facility in Bangalore, operated



Road in Hosur, Tamil Nadu, entailing an additional capex of ₹510 crore. The company's existing Hosur plant, which supplies casting parts for two-wheelers, four-wheelers and commercial vehicles across both internal combustion engine (ICE) and electric vehicle (EV) platforms, has reached its expansion limits amid strong demand from South Indian OEMs.

The new plant will raise aluminium casting capacity at the location from about 13,000 MT to 34,000 MT at peak, and will be rolled out in phases over three years. Phase 1 production is expected by the fourth quarter of FY28, with existing Hosur operations fully relocated by the first quarter of FY29. The facility will also produce around 1 million high-pressure die-cast two-wheeler alloy wheels annually alongside structural and EV/powertrain components.

The second project

through subsidiary Uno Minda Kyoraku Limited, with an estimated capex of ₹80 crore. Operations are slated to begin by the first quarter of FY28.

The fourth project is a new plant in Chhatrapati S a m b h a j i n a g a r , Maharashtra, under the company's joint venture Toyoda Gosei South India Private Limited, to manufacture interior and exterior parts, airbags, hoses and body sealing systems.

Managing Director Ravi Mehra said the projects reflect the company's approach of investing on the back of firm demand visibility while staying close to customers. Group CFO Sunil Bohra said the expansions, particularly in aluminium casting, address surging OEM demand for lightweighting components driven by the EV and advanced powertrain segments, and are structured for long-term value creation for stakeholders.



Classified

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Kazi Abdur Rouf, Father of- No.15679420H Hav Kazi Kutubuddin, R/o- Vill- Morgram, PO- Sadipur Berugram, Teh- Katwa, Dist- Barddhaman, State- West Bengal, Pin- 713129, have changed my name from Kazi Abdur Rouf to Abdur Rauf Kazi, vide affidavit dated 15/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Asif S/o Nasiruddin Ahmad H.No I-1731 Jahangirpuri Delhi-110033, have changed my name to asif ahmad. Both Asif and Asif Ahmad is same person.

I, have changed my name from "Sanjeev Kumar Tyagi" to "Sanjeev Tyagi" for all future purposes. Sanjeev Tyagi S/o Shri Rameshwar Tyagi R/o H. No. 197, Gali No. 4, Sihani, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201001.

I, Rajesh Kumari W/O Sh Ramesh Chander R/O House No. 71, Gali No-1, Nai Basti, Bankner, Narela Delhi-110040 declare that my True and Correct name is RAJESH KUMARI as per my Aadhar Card No. 4918 8849 7689 but my name has been written as RAJESHWARI DEVI in my husband Discharge Book and my name has been written RAJESH RAMESH PPO Account which is incorrect. The all names RAJESH KUMARI, RAJESHWARI DEVI & RAJESH RAMESH are name of one person and same person.

I, Geeta Sharma W/O Dinesh Chand Sharma R/o H no,836/22, Gali No.-5, Near Khandsa Road, Gandhi Nagar, Gurugram Haryana 122001, do hereby solemnly declare that Geeta Devi Sharma & Geeta Sharma both the name refers to same and one person.

I, Aakash Bhati S/o Mr. Yogesh Kumar Bhati, R/o House No. 26, Village Rustampur, Rabupura Rural, Gautam Buddha Nagar, U.P.-203209, do hereby solemnly affirm that I have changed my name Aakash to Aakash Bhati for all future purposes.

I, No.15170504M Hav (OPR) Maruti Gudami, R/o- VTC- Kamatyanahatti, PO- Mugali, Teh- Chikodi, Dist- Belagavi, Karnataka- 591226, have changed my daughter's name from Ashwini to Ashwini Maruti Gudami, vide affidavit dated 15/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, No.15170504M Hav (OPR) Maruti Gudami, R/o- VTC- Kamatyanahatti, PO- Mugali, Teh- Chikodi, Dist- Belagavi, Karnataka- 591226, have changed my name from Anjee Bunara to Anjee Bunara Anowar, vide affidavit dated 15/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Anjee Bunara, W/o- No.15679420H Hav Kazi Kutubuddin, R/o- Vill- Morgram, PO- Sadipur Berugram, Teh- Katwa, Dist- Barddhaman, State- West Bengal, Pin- 713129, have changed my name from Anjee Bunara to Anjee Bunara Anowar, vide affidavit dated 15/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Savitri Devi, Mother of No.15681021X Hav Satish Chand Solanki, R/o- Vill- Baroda Sadar, PO- Mahuar, Teh- Kiravali, P.S- Malpura, Dist- Agra, U.P.- 283122, have changed my name from Savitri Devi to Shyamvati, vide affidavit dated 15/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Sushila, W/o No.15170504M Hav (OPR) Maruti Gudami, R/o- VTC- Kamatyanahatti, PO- Mugali, Teh- Chikodi, Dist- Belagavi, Karnataka- 591226, have changed my name from Sushila to Sushila Maruti Gudami, vide affidavit dated 15/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

AMM/EMU/GZB acting for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender against Tender No. 46265432 the details are as under:

1	Name of the work	Set of Defferent Modules for Medha EMU Coaches as per Annexure attached.
2	Approx. cost of work	Rs. 77.89,225/-
3	Quantity	01 Set
4	Last Date & Time of Submission of tender bid of tender	10.10.2026 (11:00 Hrs.)
5	Date & Time of Opening of tender document	10.10.2026 (11:00 Hrs.)
6	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

Note: (i) The tenderers must be registered on the Indian Railways E-Procurement System (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in. (ii) Please refer to the tender document for all terms and conditions. (iii) No manual offers are acceptable.

NIT No. – 46265432 Date: 12.09.2026 3179/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

NIT No.	57-2026-27-WV
Name of work with its location	Replacement of Glued Joint & Switch Expansion Joint in the section of SSE/P.Way/HNZM under ADEN/HNZM.
Approx Cost of work	Rs.54999990.88
Earnest Money Deposit	(It should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway Only. Note:- FDR will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter no 201025/CE-1/CT/5/1 dated 31.08.2016) Rs.110000.00
Completion period of Work	09 Months
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15.00 hrs. on 08.10.2026 Opening of tender at 15:00 hrs. On 08.10.2026
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
No. 128-W/280/OET/2026-27/W-V/NIT-57-2026-27 Date : 15.09.2026	3189/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile



**भारतीय विमानपत्तन प्राधिकरण
AIRPORTS AUTHORITY OF INDIA**

Corporate Headquarters, Rajiv Gandhi Bhawan, Safdarjung Airport, New Delhi- 110003

EMPANELMENT OF ARBITRATOR

Airports Authority of India (AAI) invites applications for "Empanelment of Arbitrator for resolution of disputes arising out of legal issues, contract management, infrastructure projects related to AAI."

Form for online application is available on the official website of AAI from **10.09.2026 (09:30 AM) to 09.10.2026 (06:00 PM)**. The applications are invited through online mode only. For Eligibility Criteria and detailed information regarding the empanelment, please visit the Airports Authority of India website at www.aai.aero → **Career** → **Recruitment Dashboard**.

N-02-2026-27 (CC)

CBC 03111/11/0007/2627



RVNL showcases landmark projects at INNOPROM India

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Rail Vikas Nigam Limited (RVNL), a Navratna CPSE under the Ministry of Railways, Government of India showcased its landmark railway and other infrastructure projects, technological capabilities and diverse project portfolio at INNOPROM India 2026, held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, from September 9 to 11, 2026.

Held for the first time in India, INNOPROM India 2026 served as an international industrial trade fair and business platform focused on promoting India-Russia trade, industrial cooperation, technology partnerships and investment.

A major highlight of the three-day exhibition was the visit of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President of the Russian Federation HE Vladimir Putin to the RVNL stall. Saleem Ahmad, CMD, RVNL, welcomed the dignitaries at the stall. It was a proud moment for RVNL.

The RVNL stall showcased, among others, a model of



the Vande Bharat Sleeper train sets, being manufactured in collaboration with a Russian partner. Vande Bharat sleeper train is India's indigenous and modern train set, and RVNL, together with the Russian company TMH, has formed KINET for manufacturing these train sets. This project brings together Indian manufacturing capability and Russian technological expertise and is a fine example of the strong technological partnership between our two

Another major attraction was the model of a Tunnel Boring Machine (TBM) being deployed for the construction of tunnels on the Rishikesh-

Kamaprayag Rail Link Project, one of the country's significant railway infrastructure projects in the challenging Himalayan terrain.

A model of the New Pamban Railway Sea Bridge, India's first Vertical Lift Bridge, highlighted RVNL's work in advanced railway infrastructure and engineering, which was inaugurated by the Prime Minister of India last year. The BharatNet project in Uttar Pradesh, being executed by RVNL, was also showcased through dedicated displays and a video presentation.

The RVNL stall presented the organisation's flagship projects and capabilities

through informative panels, brochures, scale models and audio-visual presentations. RVNL's corporate film highlighting its major projects and activities was screened throughout the exhibition, offering visitors an overview of the organisation's diverse portfolio and project execution capabilities. Information on RVNL and its major projects was also made available through brochures at the stall.

The RVNL stall received an encouraging response throughout the three-day event, with visitors showing keen interest in the projects, technologies and activities on display.

Senior management of RVNL, including MP Singh, Director (Operations), and Amit Tandon, Director (Projects), were among those who visited the stall. Several senior Government officials also visited the RVNL stall. Sanjeev Sharma, GGM (Corporate Coordination), RVNL, played a key role in coordinating, planning and setting up RVNL's stall at the exhibition.

NCC cadets attachment camp begins at military hospital, Zakhama

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kohima

Military Hospital Attachment Camp for National Cadet Corps (NCC) cadets commenced at the Army General Hospital, Zakhama, Kohima district, Nagaland, on 14 September 2026. The 12-day training is scheduled to culminate on 25 Sept 2026. The programme is held periodically, as per the training curriculum of the NCC, to enhance their awareness and practical skills in first aid, basic healthcare, emergency medical response and preventive medicine.

30 cadets, comprising 15 Senior Division (SD) boys and 15 Senior Wing (SW) girls of the NCC Group Kohima, are participating in the training activity.

The camp was inaugurated by the Commanding Officer of the General Hospital. In his inaugural address, he welcomed the cadets and emphasised the importance of military discipline, civic responsibility and basic medical preparedness in disaster management as well as in day-to-day community life. The inaugural session was fol-



lowed by a comprehensive orientation of the hospital and a baseline pre-training assessment to assess the cadets' existing knowledge and awareness.

During the attachment, the cadets will undergo structured, expert-led instructional sessions conducted by specialist medical officers and professionals. The curriculum covers a broad range of subjects, including: Emergency Medicine and Triage; Basic Life Support (BLS), Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation (CPR), management of foreign-body airway

obstruction (choking), shock management and dehydration.

Trauma and Field Care: Fracture stabilisation, application of splints, haemorrhage control, management of animal bites and casualty evacuation procedures.

Preventive and Public Health: Vector-borne diseases, adolescent health, prevention and management of lifestyle disorders, basic anatomy and biomedical waste management.

The programme places particular emphasis on practical learning and hands-on

exposure. Cadets will participate in workstation-based drills using medical mannequins, along with practical training in vital-sign monitoring, injection safety, bandaging and other basic medical procedures.

The attachment camp will culminate on 25 Sept 2026 with a final proficiency assessment, followed by the presentation of certificates to the participating cadets. The assessment will evaluate the skills acquired during the programme and recognise cadets who demonstrate outstanding proficiency.

CISF, IIT Kanpur ink MoUs for cyber, drone security

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) has entered into two institutional partnerships with the Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur (IIT Kanpur) to strengthen its capabilities in cyber security and drone/anti-drone technology for the protection of critical and strategic infrastructure.

The two Memorandum of Understanding (MoUs), signed on 14 September 2026, provide for a six-week cyber security training programme through C3iHub, IIT Kanpur, and collaboration for establishing and developing a Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Drone and Anti-Drone Technology at CISF MPRTC, Behror, Rajasthan. The cyber security MoU was signed between CISF and C3iHub (IHUB NTIHAC Foundation, IIT Kanpur) by Senthil Avoodai Krishna Raj S, IPS, IG/CISF Airport Sector-I and Tanima



Hajra, CEO, C3iHub, in the presence of Professor Surender Baswana, Programme Director, Ras Dwivedi, CTO, Anand Handa, CSO and Ajaya Kumar Misra, CoE.

The Drone & Anti-Drone MoU was signed between C Dhananjaya Naik, DIG/CISF MPRTC, Behror, and Professor Jayandharan G Rao, Dean, R&D, IIT Kanpur, in the presence of Senthil Avoodai Krishna Raj S, Savitri Singh Gill, AIG/NCR Zone (Domain

Lead — Drone & Anti-Drone) and Professor Navroz, Department of Aerospace Engineering, IIT Kanpur.

Under the first MoU, IHUB NTIHAC Foundation (C3iHub) will conduct a six-week residential cyber security training programme under a three-year framework. Under the second MoU, CISF and IIT Kanpur will collaborate under a five-year framework for establishing and developing a Centre of Excellence at MPRTC Behror.

TOLIC (O) Faridabad receives official language honour

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Town Official Language Implementation Committee (Office)-TOLIC (O), Faridabad, operating under the chairmanship of Bhupender Gupta, CMD, NHPC, has been honoured with the 'Best' official language shield and certificate for outstanding work in the implementation of the official language.

The honour was conferred at a ceremony held in Mumbai, Maharashtra, on the occasion of Hindi Day 2026 and the 6th All India Official Language Conference. The ceremony was chaired by Union Minister of Home Affairs and Cooperation, Amit Shah.

Bhupender Gupta, CMD, NHPC and Chairman, TOLIC (O), Faridabad, said, "The honour of the official language becomes meaningful only when Hindi is reflected not only in our thoughts but also in our day-to-day work. Working in Hindi reflects not only our effi-



NHPC CMD Bhupender Gupta

ciency but also our national commitment." He appreciated the contribution of all officers and employees of the member offices associated with TOLIC (O), Faridabad and expressed his gratitude for their efforts towards this achievement.

On behalf of TOLIC (O) Faridabad, the honour was received by Naveen Kumar Jain, executive director (HR), NHPC and Sanjeev Kumar, general manager



(Rajbhasha) and member secretary, TOLIC (O), Faridabad, from Anshuli Arya, secretary, Department of Official Language, Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India.

It is noteworthy that TOLIC (O) Faridabad has been functioning under the chairmanship of NHPC since 2009. At present, the Committee comprises 54 member offices, with coordinated efforts being undertaken for the effective

implementation of the official language policy and promotion of Hindi.

In addition, during the ceremony, TOLIC Reasi, functioning under the chairmanship of NHPC's Salal Power Station, was honoured in the 'Excellent TOLIC' category, while TOLIC Dhemaji, functioning under the chairmanship of NHPC's Subansiri Lower Project, was honoured in the 'Commendable TOLIC' category.

CSKHPKV study highlights climate-smart rice farming

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Palampur

Himachal Pradesh's Farm University, CSKHPKV, and Savannah Seeds, a leader in rice seed technology, today announced results from a multi-year study showing that direct-seeded SAVA-134 FullPage® can help make rice production more climate-smart and resource-efficient.

Compared with conventional transplanted rice systems, the approach reduced methane emissions by nearly 90%, delivered the highest water productivity, improved soil health, and showed the greatest potential for carbon credit generation.



Led by Dr Dhanbir Singh, Assistant Soil Chemist, Department of Soil Science, CSKHPKV, Palampur, and supported by Savannah Seeds, the research compared conventional transplanted rice with direct-seeded rice across multiple growing seasons. The assessment focused on yield, water use, GHG emissions, and soil health.

"This study is a strong example of a public-private partnership working to develop climate-resilient and sustainable farming practices," said Dr Vinod Sharma, Director of Research, and CSKHPKV Palampur.

"Rice farmers are being asked to produce more food with fewer resources while also reducing environmental impacts," said Ajai Rana, CEO & MD Savannah Seeds. "This research demonstrates that innovation in crop genetics and production practices can help achieve both goals."

Sood hails team for zero-defect in BRICS power supply

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Power Minister Ashish Sood congratulated engineers, technicians, and officials for their hard work, which ensured an "uninterrupted, zero-defect power supply" throughout the BRICS Summit in the city.

Sood said there was a multi-layered power system, including an automatic switchover system that used an alternate source for power in just 1.5 seconds. "The BRICS Summit was a matter of immense global pride for India. Under the guidance of the PM Narendra Modi and leadership of CM Rekha Gupta, we left no stone unturned to ensure a world-class experience at Bharat Mandapam," he said. "We deployed more than 100 dedicated personnel on site and backed the venue with an N-2 redundancy, featuring three



independent power sources. We even added a fourth emergency link via DTL's Okhla Grid to safeguard against extreme contingencies," the power minister said. "Also, to eliminate human error, our automatic switchover system was in place to transfer power to an alternate source in just 1.5 seconds. In addition, through our 24x7

SCADA monitoring, we ensured that the event experienced zero power interruptions," he added. BSES power discoms ensured "reliable supply" at Bharat Mandapam and key venues with nearly 140 personnel deployed at key locations, said a discom spokesperson. BSES Rajdhani Power Limited (BRPL) supplied power to Bharat Mandapam,

the conference halls, exhibition halls and other venues within the ITPO complex at Pragati Maidan. It also maintained power supply arrangements at several five-star hotels in south Delhi, including Eros, Crowne Plaza and Hyatt Regency, where delegates from BRICS countries were staying," he said.

Behind the seamless supply was nearly a month of planning, detailed preventive maintenance, multiple power sources, automatic changeover arrangements, real-time SCADA monitoring, he stated.

An important part of the reliability arrangement was the automatic changeover system at the ITPO Grid. If one power source became unavailable, the system was designed to automatically shift the supply to an alternate source in approximately 1.5 seconds, without human intervention, said the BSES spokesperson.

GDA hosts blood donation camp

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Ghaziabad

Various programmes were organised at the Ghaziabad Development Authority (GDA) office on Tuesday on the occasion of Engineers' Day. As per the directions of the vice-chairman of the Authority, a blood donation camp was organised on the office premises, in which officers and employees of the authority enthusiastically participated and voluntarily donated blood.

The blood donation camp witnessed enthusiastic participation from the officers and employees. On the occasion, the participants described blood donation as an important social and humanitarian responsibility and also encouraged others to come forward and donate blood.

On the occasion of Engineers' Day,



engineers and officers of the authority paid their respects to the legendary engineer and Bharat Ratna awardee, Sir Mokshagundam Visvesvaraya, by garlanding his portrait and offering floral tributes. His invaluable contribution to the nation's development and his exemplary standards in the field of engineering were remembered on the occasion.

During the programme, officers and employees of the Authority highlighted the important role of engineering in the planned and sustainable development of any city.

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Notice Inviting Tender

www.verka.coop

Tenders are hereby invited for the purchase and supply of following items:-

Sr. No.	Name of Work/Item	Period/Tentative Qty
1.	For Verka Mohali Dairy a) Contract for hiring Milk Plant for conversion of Milk (01.50 LLPD to 02 LLPD) into ISI Marked Milk Powder in state of Punjab b) Construction of Verka Milkbar of size 10'x10' at various locations under Verka Mohali Dairy. c) Annual rate contract for the purchase of Whey Protein Concentrate 90% (Food grade).	50 No's Annual
2.	For Verka Bathinda Dairy a) DSITC of 125 KVA DG sets. b) Supply of equipments for 6TPD powder plant installed at Verka Bathinda Dairy (Including Design, Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning & Integration with existing setup complete in all respects). c) Hiring of Milk powder plant having spare milk conversion capacity in the range of 1.00 to 2.00 LLPD for conversion of liquid milk into Standard Grade SMP. d) Hiring of vehicles for Sale Depot, Bathinda & Verka Bathinda Dairy for supply of Ghee, Butter, Powder, Paniri, Tetra Pack & Other Products all Punjab & other States for a period of one year. Capacity 1.00 ton, 2.00 ton, 3.00 ton, 4.00 ton, 5.00 ton, 7.00 ton. e) Rate Contract for the supply of advertisement material.	05 No's One complete job Annual/ 01 No. As per requirement One year and extended upto three months
3.	For Verka Patiala Dairy a) Shrink Sleeves b) Hiring of open and refrigerated 03 MT, 4.5 MT, 7.5 MT, 09 MT, 15 MT vehicles for transportation of Plo, Ghee and Cheese etc. for different stations.	Annual One year
4.	For Verka Sangrur Dairy Disposal off the scrap material on annual basis.	
5.	For Verka Hoshiarpur Dairy a) Supply of Rice Husk b) Lifting of rice husk/firewood from the fuel yard to the boiler furnaces/conveyor.	2000 MT N.A.
6.	For Verka Gurdaspur Dairy Hiring of Milk Powder Plant having conversion capacity in the range of 50,000 to 1,50,000 LPD for conversion of liquid milk into standard grade SMP.	50,000 ltr to 1,50,000 ltr per day
7.	For Verka Ludhiana Dairy Hiring of insulated road milk tankers for transportations of milk from Verka Ludhiana Dairy to other sister Unions, Hired Powder Plant (& vice- versa) within and outside states etc. (Capacity - 15 MT-25 MT).	One Job
8.	For Verka Jalandhar Dairy a) Disposal of unserviceable scrap material (one time basis and Annual rate contract). b) Hiring of vehicles for transportation of milk products to different Cities/ Towns of Punjab and other states.	As per Site For entering into annual rate contract
9.	For Verka Amritsar Dairy Hiring of:- i. Milk Powder Plant having spare milk conversion capacity of minimum 1 LLPD to 2 LLPD Spare capacity for conversion of skimmed milk into standard grade Skimmed Milk Powder. ii. Insulated Single Portion road milk tankers (capacity-10000 ltr.) for the transportation of milk from BMC/MCC to Verka Amritsar Dairy.	Annual Two year/ 10 No's
10.	For Verka Cattle feed Plant, Ghania-Ke-Banger Disposal of old bardana jute gunny bags above 50 kg.	One year & Approximately 6 lakh bags
11.	For Verka Cattle feed Plant, Khanna i. Copper Sulphate ii. Sodium Borate iii. Potassium Iodide iv. Beta Carotene v. Zeolite vi. Cobalt Sulphate vii. Manganese Sulphate viii. Ferrous Sulphate ix. Formaldehyde Solution x. By Pass Fat (Quarterly)	Khanna Annual (MTs) GKB Annual (MTs) 2.5 2.5 6 6 1.2 0.2 1.5 0.3 25 23 2.5 0.25 2 3 6 1 50 10 175 150 (03 months) (03 months)

NOTE:

1. For complete details regarding above tender (NTT), please visit our website i.e. www.verka.coop & e Tendering portal i.e. eproc.punjab.gov.in.

2. Corrigendum, if any, will be uploaded on website only.

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No. GM/O&M/Pur/4726

Narmadapuram, Dated : 15.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDERS (TS No.-06)

E-Tender (RCA) are invited from the eligible bidders for carrying out the following work :-

Name of Works	App.Value of Tender (In Cr.) including GST	EMD Fee (In. Rs.)	Tender Fee (In. Rs.)	Tender Sub-mission Last Date & Time	Opening Date of Tender Documents
Empanelment of Agencies for new 33/11kV substation, additional/Augmentation of PTR at existing 33/11 KV S/s, HT Lines, LT Lines, DTR, Service Line, meter related works and any other associated works as per SOR schedules in Narmadapuram Circle of MPMKVVCL	10.00 Cr.	100000/-	(11800 with 18% GST)	14.10.2026 Up to 15.00 Hrs.	15.10.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

Other details, terms and conditions are available on company website : <https://portal.mpcz.in> & <https://mptenders.gov.in> or the under signed office.

M.P. Madhyam/128067/2026

GM (O&M)

A high-angle, wide shot of a Formula 1 race track. Numerous cars are visible, spread out across the track, moving away from the camera. The cars feature various team colors and sponsor logos. The track is bordered by safety barriers and grandstands filled with spectators. The scene is brightly lit, suggesting a sunny day.

(PTI)

A close-up photograph of Lionel Messi celebrating a goal. He is wearing the blue and red striped jersey of the Spanish national team, with the Adidas logo and the Spanish flag on the sleeve. He is holding a white glove to his mouth and looking upwards with a joyful expression. The background is blurred, showing stadium lights and spectators.

(AP)

A collage of four Indian athletes. At the top is a female tennis player wearing glasses and a white shirt with 'HCL' and '2011' logos. Below her is a female basketball player in a blue jersey with 'SAI' and 'INDIA' logos. To the left is a male badminton player in a white shirt. At the bottom is a male tennis player in a blue shirt with an Indian flag patch. The text 'Infospace' is visible at the bottom right.

(PTI)

A photograph of three female athletes standing side-by-side, smiling. They are wearing matching blue polo shirts with white collars and sleeves, featuring the 'YONEX' logo and a circular emblem. The athlete on the left is wearing a gold medal around her neck. The athlete in the center is wearing a yellow wristband. The athlete on the right is wearing a black wristband. They are standing in front of a backdrop that includes the Japanese text 'ホノホン HONOHON' and silhouettes of athletes in various sports.

Marijnje now wants his players to use the disappointment of missing out on a World Cup semifinal as motivation to win the Asian Games gold.

"You don't get to play many World Cups and to come that close to a medal and miss it is disap-



Dr. Anand Kumar

A large crowd of people is gathered for a celebration. In the foreground, several individuals are prominently featured, including a man in a blue shirt waving and a man in a white shirt holding a Kenyan flag. A man in traditional Maasai attire, including a feathered headdress and face paint, is also visible. The crowd is diverse in age and appearance, all showing signs of joy and participation. A large red banner at the top of the frame displays the hashtag '#MagicalKenya' in white text. The background shows a building with a yellow facade and a dark sky.

Coe added World Athletics research had shown Kenya was the most passionate market for track and field among those surveyed. The championships will use a stadium that's already being upgraded for Kenya co-hosting soccer's Africa Cup of Nations next year. (AP)

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12, Death	27, Pin-up	7, In	23, Coward's
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15, Hum	29, R-ustler	12, Dr W-h-o	26, Tu-R-n
17, Tray	30, A-gent	13, Steps	28, Tea
18, Scrape	31, A-side	14, Laker	

19 Grandmother's girl (3)
20 A piano piece? (3)
21 Noted batsman good at making cuts (3)
22 What a brainy women has, if she hasn't
burnt it (3)
23 Quicker to make a fatheaded bloomer
(6)
24 Nominally he's in the bottom class (4)
25 Pull into the river, where there's a lot
of water (6)
26 Suitable, very soft covering of hay (5)
27 Annual interest, one pound! (5)
28 Drink up like a dog, so named (3)
29 The way to make a soft blow hard (4)

Samson, Nitish star as India thrash Afghanistan by 7 wickets to clinch series

AMIT KUMAR DAS
■ New Delhi

Sanju Samson's explosive 57 off 22 balls and Nitish Kumar Reddy's three-wicket haul powered India to a commanding seven-wicket win over Afghanistan in the second T20I here on Tuesday, giving the hosts an unassailable lead in the three-match series.

Reddy returned with figures of 3/24, striking on the first ball of each of his three overs, as the Indian bowlers produced another disciplined show to restrict Afghanistan to 159 for 8.

India conceded just 64 between overs 7-14 to leave the Afghans struggling at 105 for six in 15 overs, as it was Mohammad Nabi (20) and Rashid Khan (28) who added crucial 48 runs off 28 balls to take them to a decent total in the end. Chasing 160, openers Samson and Abhishek Sharma (39) brutalised



India's Sanju Samson celebrates his half century during the second T20I cricket match between India and Afghanistan, in New Delhi on Tuesday

Afghanistan bowlers with sensational hitting, amassing 82-1 in the mandatory powerplay to set the foundation as India eventually romped home in 14.5 overs. If Abhishek was the protagonist in the opening T20, it was the 31-year-old Samson who clobbered seven fours and four maximums en route to his fastest fifty which came off 20 balls, displaying his immaculate timing and rich arsenal of strokes once again.

Afghanistan's ploy to open with spin at both ends backfired as Abhishek blasted Mujeeb Ur Rahman (3/37) for two fours in the first over, before pulling Nabi for a six in the second.

Samson then picked up a four off Azmatullah Omarzai before Abhishek deposited Nabi for his second six in the fourth over as runs came thick and fast.

The Kerala batter exploded in the fifth over as he flicked one off the hips for a six, and pumped one across

cover before hitting another straight back over the bowler's head to rack up 20 runs off Omarzai.

Nabi was next in the firing line as Samson and Abhishek milked him for 27 runs with three sixes and two fours.

In seventh over, Rashid Khan (3/36) dismissed Abhishek, who failed to clear the ropes this time.

With 24,215 crowd in attendance at the Arun Jaitley stadium, Samson completed his fastest T20 fifty with another four off, and then pulled Rashid for another six.

But the wily spinner had the last laugh as Samson went for a lofted drive only to be caught by Nabi.

Ishan Kishan (38 not out off 23) and skipper Shreyas Iyer (11) then came together. An inside hit out over extra cover earned a six for the Indian skipper, but he fell next, with Ibrahim Zadran managing to hold on to a

catch after a fumble at slip as Rashid picked his third wicket.

Earlier, Jasprit Bumrah gave India the perfect start with a first-over maiden, while Arshdeep Singh dismissed Rahmanullah Gurbaz (0) for his second straight duck of the series in the next over. Skipper Ibrahim Zadran (37) then carted the first two deliveries from Bumrah for boundaries, while Arshdeep was next hit for two boundaries by Zadran before Sediqullah Atal (12) glided one fine of the wicket for another four as Afghanistan recovered to 41 for one in the powerplay.

Afghanistan brought up their fifty in the eighth over but Reddy broke the partnership in his first ball after Zadran was holed out to Bishnoi at deep midwicket. Bishnoi then dismissed Atal, who hit straight to Tiлак Varma at long-off, as Afghanistan slipped to 59 for three in the 10th over. (PTI)

WI ODI selection meeting: Will selectors pick Hardik, show faith in Rishabh Pant

KUSHAN SARKAR ■ New Delhi

A white ball lifeline for Rishabh Pant and a possible inclusion of a fit-again Hardik Pandya will be the focal points of discussion when the national selectors pick the ODI and T20I squads for the home series against West Indies here on Wednesday.

India will play three ODIs and five T20Is against the West Indies. While the T20I squad is almost expected to be a mirror image of the Asian Games squad with the matches starting from October 6, the selection committee led by Ajit Agarkar does have a job at hand to pick the 50-over squad from the options available.

Incidentally, Agarkar, who will be in Delhi for the team selection meeting, is likely to have a discussion with "decision makers" in the board on whether he will be given extension till the end of the 2027 ODI World Cup. Pandya's scheduled return to competitive cricket is September 20 as he has already been picked for India A's three-match One Day series against Australia A in Puducherry from October 6. However, the West Indies ODIs start in Thiruvananthapuram from September 27 and it will be up to the selection panel to decide whether Pandya is ready to bowl 10 overs and field for 50 overs straight-away in a full international game.

The lack of seam bowling all-rounders is an issue for selection committee if Pandya is unavailable. The second option Nitish Kumar



Reddy will be in Japan playing the Asian Games during the ODI series. The third and fourth options — Suryansh Shedge and Venkatesh Iyer are currently injured.

Pant's indifferent IPL form saw him lose Test vice-captaincy and also a place in the white ball

sides but with Ishan Kishan in Japan, the flamboyant southpaw might just get a look-in in the squad of 15 with KL Rahul being the first choice ODI keeper. Rahul is also likely to be Shubman Gill's deputy in absence of Shreyas Iyer. In case Pant misses the bus, then selectors will go for Dhruv Jurel and send Pant to lead Rest of India in the Irani Cup.

With Iyer on Asian Games duty, Ruturaj Gaikwad is expected to take the No 4 slot in the line-up after skipper Gill, Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli. Yashasvi Jaiswal will be the reserve opener while reserve middle order batter in all likelihood will be Rajat Patidar.

Both Gaikwad and Patidar are also supposed to play for India A after the West Indies ODIs with the former leading the team. (PTI)

Syndrela Das sets sights on winning Asian Games gold, breaking into top 50



DEVARCHIT VARMA ■ Mumbai

Syndrela Das' rapid rise has met with her call-up to the senior women's side in the Asian Games with the 17-year-old setting sights on winning the gold and breaking into the top 50 "as fast as possible". Currently ranked No. 99 in ITTF women's singles' rankings and world No. 27 in youth girls' singles, Syn-drela heads to the Asian Games in Japan's Aichi-Nagoya with a strong performance in the domestic circuit to showcase her form.

Her title wins in women's singles and U-19 girls' singles at the National Ranking Table Tennis Champion-ships last month certainly put the spotlight on the Kolkata-based Syndrela, whose list of achievements includes defeating Manika Batra in a women's singles game of the Ultimate Table Tennis.

"For the country, of course, I am looking forward to the Asian Games and we would try to clinch the gold, of course. But personally, I would try to get into the top 50 as fast as possible," Syndrela, who played for UTT 2026 finalists Dempo Goa Challengers, told PTI in an exclusive interview.

Safeguarding Asian Games: OCA sets ground rules for conduct, suspension for violators

POONAM MEHRA ■ New Delhi

Inappropriate relationships where "power imbalance or dependency" exists, use of degrading language or being a bystander to instances of harassment have been strictly prohibited in the Olympic Council of Asia's Safeguarding Code of Conduct for athletes and officials at the Asian Games with violations punishable by suspension from the mega-event.

The code of conduct has been circulated to all athletes and officials bound for the Games beginning September 19 in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan and participants



are required to sign and adhere to it.

Softball Association of India President Neetal Narang would be India's Safeguarding Officer during the Games, which is a

mandatory requirement in the contingent staff as per the OCA. The use of social media has also been addressed in the code of conduct with the OCA making it clear that content should be

"respectful, and appropriate" and must not "compromise the dignity or safety of others."

"Breaches of this Code may result in removal of accreditation, suspension or exclusion from the Games, referral to law enforcement authorities, disciplinary action by the OCA, NOC (National Olympic Committee), AINAGOC (Organising Committee), IF/AF (International Federation/Asian Federation), or relevant governing body," the OCA has warned in the communication accessed by PTI.

There is emphasis on maintaining appropriate physical, emotional, and professional

boundaries at all times.

"Communicate respectfully and inclusively, free from harassment, bullying, discrimination, intimidation, abuse, or exploitation. Challenge, intervene where safe, and report any safeguarding concern or inappropriate conduct," the code of conduct states. The OCA made Safeguarding Officers mandatory in 2022 and subsequently, India had one for Youth Asian Games last year with former shot-putter Om Prakash Karhana fulfilling the responsibility.

India will field 501 athletes (267 male and 234 female) and 265 support staff in 36 disciplines

at the Asian Games hoping to better the best ever tally of 106 medals achieved in the previous edition of the Games in Hangzhou. The haul included 28 gold, 38 silver and 40 bronze medals.

"The Indian athletes have been made aware of this code of conduct through workshops and e-mail communication. We are continuing to receive the signed acknowledgments pledging adherence to the code," a well-placed source said.

The OCA Code of Conduct places emphasis on protection of minors who would be competing in the Games. (PTI)

From cricket bat to shotgun: Mairaj's journey

AJAI MASAND ■ New Delhi

There was a time when Mairaj Ahmad Khan dreamed of making it big with a cricket bat. More than three decades later, the 50-year-old is still chasing sporting glory — only now with a shotgun firmly in his grip.

From Khurja in Uttar Pradesh's Bulandshahr district to shooting ranges around the world, Mairaj's journey has taken him places he could never have imagined when he first stepped into the world of sport. At the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games, he will be the second-oldest member of the Indian contingent, behind equestrian Shruti Vora, and will compete at his fourth continental games.

Yet, shooting was never supposed to be his destiny. "I was playing cricket when it all started in 1994," Mairaj recalls.

A left-handed top-order batter



who usually came in at Number 3, he represented Uttar Pradesh in the CK Nayudu and Vinoo Mankad Trophy competitions before joining Jamia Millia Islamia in 1996. He played inter-university cricket and also featured in the Vizzy Trophy.

Among his university team-

mates was a young Virender Sehwal. "I have played with Sehwal and done a lot of nets with him. He played just one match with us because he went on to play for India that year," Mairaj recalled. But while cricket was his passion, shooting was slowly beginning to pull him in.

Guns were not unfamiliar to Mairaj. His family, he says, were zamindars and had always kept firearms. As a youngster, he had also tried air rifle and .22 rifle shooting and even competed in a district-level three-position event in Bulandshahr, where he won ₹30 in prize money.

"I bought a cricket bat with that money," he said laughing.

It was after he moved to Delhi that fate nudged him towards a different sporting path. Mairaj would often spend weekends with a cousin who was a Group Captain in the Indian Air Force and a senior officer with the Air Force Sports Control Board. One day, he noticed his cousin cleaning his gun. "I asked him where he was going. He said there was a competition at the Delhi range... the Nationals at Karni Singh Shooting Range. So I went there out of curiosity," he said. What he saw fascinated him.

Putting setbacks behind, Nisha ready for Asian Games glory

AMANPREET SINGH ■ New Delhi

For years, Nisha Dahia would have this lingering thought after every injury: Why me?

Why did the body give up just when everything seemed to be falling into place? Why did another promising campaign end in disappointment? She no longer asks those questions?

Nisha has learnt to take setbacks in her stride, stopped cribbing about the injuries that have repeatedly interrupted her career, and, most importantly, accepted that an athlete can control the work but not always the outcome.

That change in mindset could prove as important as any technical improvement when Nisha steps on the mat at the Asian Games in the women's 68kg category, carrying the hopes of



finally converting her considerable potential into a major medal. "I used to feel that God was being unfair on me. I used to think, why is this happening to me again and again? But now I don't think like that," Nisha told. "I will get what is written in my fate. I will do my job, work hard and wrestle well. I will do my best."